

*Living A.A.'s Principles
Through Sponsorship*

**THE FIFTY-THIRD ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2003
Final Report*

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



53rd GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

“Living A.A.’s Principles Through Sponsorship”

When the 135 members of A.A.’s General Service Conference met at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan, April 27-May 3, it was the culmination of a year’s work and preparation. The Conference is an ongoing process throughout the year, at the General Service Office and in the constant work of committees—from local areas to the trustees’ committees.

Since the last Conference, trustees and G.S.O. staff members have traveled widely, visiting countries in Africa, as well as Belarus, China, Cuba, Estonia, Poland, Slovakia and Turkey—to name just a handful of the countries where A.A. is flourishing.

In his presentation “New Frontiers,” Bill Archer, G.S.O. staff member on the International assignment, related the story of A.A.’s beginnings in Cameroon, when an alcoholic prison guard awoke from a drunken sleep to find a French-language A.A. pamphlet by his bed. He wrote to G.S.O. Paris

and started an A.A. meeting in that prison. “One of the most challenging frontiers,” Bill said, “is transcending the isolation of the suffering alcoholic.” Frontiers closer to home, he pointed out include “...the Indigenous People of the far north...” Due to the “growing diversity in many of our states and provinces, we all have potential New Frontiers in our own backyard,” he said.

The Conference, which officially opened Sunday afternoon, was chaired by Greg Muth, G.S.O.’s general manager; Elaine McDowell, (nonalcoholic) chair of the General Service Board; Linda Chezem, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; and Mary Pat Yater, delegate chairperson. Warren Stafford, G.S.O. staff member, was Conference secretary.

The Conference welcomed, as special guests and observers, Jim Keeney, general secretary of the General Service Office in

Great Britain, along with Ann Napier, who will succeed Jim when he retires.

Conference members are delegates from the 93 areas in the U.S. and Canada, trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and staff members of the General Service Office and the Grapevine.

The keynote address on the Conference theme, "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship," was given by Class A trustee Linda Chezem. "Sponsorship," said Linda, "can make the printed word come alive. . . . It can help carry the principles of A.A. around the world."

Following the Sunday night opening dinner there was an open A.A. meeting, chaired by David Steiner (New York, Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire). The meeting was led by Walter Norrad (New Brunswick/PEI); speakers were: Denis Vézina (SW Québec), Patty Tennant (South Carolina), Julio Espallat (G.S.O. staff), Jane Sheppard (A.A.W.S. director), and Dorothy May (East Central regional trustee).

Monday morning began a full week. Conference members spent much time discussing matters important to the Fellowship they represent. As a result of their work, committee reports were presented to the entire Conference, beginning Wednesday. Many of the issues discussed resulted in Advisory Actions.

Presentations throughout the week covered: the A.A. Grapevine; Finances; the 17th World Service Meeting; Sponsorship; and Principles. Panel 53 delegates presented their area service highlights; there was one workshop, based on the Conference theme; and several "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions.

Tuesday events included an afternoon trip to the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices for a tour and refreshments. Later that evening there was a Delegates-Only Meeting back at the hotel. Each morning at 7:30 an open A.A. meeting was held.

And, just as in our homegroups, a great many problems were discussed and "solved" every evening at the "meeting after the meeting." By Friday afternoon, when the Serenity Prayer was said in English, French and Spanish, A.A.'s collective group conscience had been expressed, ensuring that the voice of A.A. as a whole would be heard.

We hear many times that "alcoholism is a family disease," thus many delegates were accompanied to New York by spouses, friends or family members—many of them also A.A. members, with a smattering of Al-Anons. A group of New York A.A.s met this special group every morning for a tour of the city. On the agenda this year: Ellis Island, the Statue of Liberty, backstage at Radio City, the Brooklyn Botanic Garden, tours of the "Intrepid" Aircraft Carrier Museum, the United Nations and more. For the Al-Anons there were volunteers to take them to meetings, and from 8:00 to 9:00 in the evenings many hung out in the hospitality suite for an informal meeting and fellowship.

This is the sixth year that Susan Flynn has been coordinating the activities for Conference guests. It is the "most wonderful service experience," Susan feels. Among the many wonderful memories Susan has is running into old friends at the International Convention in Minnesota. And after 9/11 she and her husband Terry (Panel 53 delegate from Southeast New York), received several dozen e-mails, just checking to see if they were alright.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two regional trustees and one trustee-at-large. Michael Perry of Fair Haven, Vermont, becomes the new Northeast regional trustee, replacing Tony Tashner; Gary Kluksdahl from Parker, Colorado, will replace Beth Rabren as the new Southwest regional trustee; and Murray McIntosh of Thunder Bay, Ontario, will follow Alex Palmer as trustee-at-large/Canada.

Delegate chairperson for the 54th Conference will be Mark Greider of Colorado; alternate chairperson is Jim Parili of Eastern Massachusetts.

This year Conference members returned home with several gifts. Monday they received a copy of *Experience, Strength and Hope: Stories From the First Three Editions of Alcoholics Anonymous*, and a new Grapevine CD, "Partners on the Journey" (formerly "Sponsorship" in cassette format). Friday they were presented with a copy of *De las tinieblas hacia la luz*, the stories from the Fourth Edition Big Book in Spanish.

The closing brunch on Saturday morning is always a bitter-sweet time, with promises to keep in touch, picture taking and farewell talks by rotating trustees. Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Linda Chezem said it was not really goodbye, "because bad pennies keep turning up and chickens come home to roost." Her fellow Class A Bob Miller (an Episcopal bishop) remarked that "I deal with religion on a daily basis — but I have to come to New York with you drunks to get my spiritual fix."

For Alex Palmer (trustee-at-large/Canada) rotating was filled with mixed emotions, "like watching your teenage daughter come home at 3:00 a.m. with a Gideon Bible under her arm."

Remembering many of the trustees who came before, Greg Tobin (general service trustee) said, "A.A. taught me to be present for my life."

Beth Rabren (Southwest regional trustee) spoke of the observation of a British religious leader, that three conditions were necessary for a true fellowship: The possession of a common task; the discharge of a common task; and the comradeship and togetherness in the joy of belonging to an organic society and being engaged in a whole-time service. Beth continued by quoting from *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, page 276: "These words have meaning for A.A., I believe, not only as a definition of a true fellowship and of our goals and attitudes but as reminders that A.A. is not a static, passive social organism but, in its largest sense, a dynamic, creative force that releases our latent power to live and act constructively."

Having celebrated 25 years of sobriety the day before, Tony Tashner (Northeast regional trustee) was so overcome that he had a drunk dream and fell out of bed. (Hilary, his wife, Tony said, was no help, "she just laughed.") On a more serious note, Tony spoke about "the simplicity of the whole experience" of serving the Fellowship as trustee. "It is," he said, "still just one alcoholic helping another — just like the first day in detox."

Then it was back to the areas, districts, home groups and the responsibility of carrying A.A.'s message to the isolated and fearful newcomer "...whether across the street or across the planet," as Bill Archer said in his presentation. "Let us all take that subway ride that Ebby took and make that call that Bill W. made from the Mayflower Hotel. Carrying the message is an action that all of us can take."

Greetings from Delegate Chair

Good afternoon, *Buenos Dias, Bonjour* to everyone. It is truly an honor and a privilege for me to be standing before you today at the opening of the 53rd General Service Conference, the theme of which is "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship." My home group is the Millville Group of Alcoholics Anonymous in Hamilton, Ohio, USA. We hold three open meetings each week. Two of these meetings are discussion meetings and the other a Big Book meeting. In our group conscience each month we discuss ways we can better "sponsor" the new person coming into our meetings. Such begins the process of sponsoring — our primary purpose, to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve

sobriety. Sponsorship starts at the group level. After all, you don't usually get a sponsor until you make it to an A.A. meeting.

All of A.A.'s principles are known through the Steps, Traditions and Concepts. Our sponsor helps us to recovery by guiding us to work the Steps of the A.A. program of recovery. Our groups, districts, and areas sponsor us to unity by teaching us, through the Traditions, that we are part of the whole of A.A. And our service sponsors help us to better understand service and the service structure through their example of living and passing on the Twelve Concepts for World Service.

Bill Wilson, in his speech made at a group anniversary the day Dr. Bob died, talked of sponsoring drunks at the Oxford Group when he first attended their meetings, and of how Ebby sponsored him and of how we sponsor each other. I think it's interesting to note that the first piece of literature most of us receive, "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous," defines sponsorship as person-to-person service. And, on page 77 of the Big Book, "Our real purpose is to fit ourselves to be of maximum service to God and the people about us." My dad Joe Buckman recently passed away with 26 years of sobriety. He spoke at a Bardstown, Kentucky, group anniversary meeting on February 14, 2002, and stated that "God helps us sponsor each other." This is my belief—that God talks through people. It is this passing along of the A.A. principles through sponsorship that has created these some "hundred million miracles," of which I am one. And it is our responsibility to "pass it on."

Mary Pat Yater, SW Ohio

Keynote

I am Linda Chezem, a friend of A.A. For the last six years, I have had the joy and privilege of being your trusted servant as a Class A trustee. I am so grateful for the opportunity to welcome you as we begin our General Service Conference work. I look forward to seeing love and service in action. I, as Dr. Bob described in his farewell talk, "get a thrill" out of seeing your faces and smiles before me. What a beautiful sight.

Now is a good time to plant firmly in our minds the Conference theme, "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship," which can serve as a bright star to guide us as we each work on the responsibilities and decisions entrusted to us. Are any of you sufficiently aged to remember the song, "String of Pearls?" It is a lovely song for a big band, or it can be performed with a bit of soul, but it has a beauty that matches its name. To me, it also seems to describe our Conference theme. Each word in the Conference theme this year is a pearl of wisdom and together they create a strand of strength and beauty.

Let's take the first word, *Living*—Yes, A.A. is living and growing around the world. Beyond cultural, religious, political, and geographical tensions, alcoholics are finding recovery in the Fellowship of A.A., and are *living* well with the principles of A.A.

Next, *A.A.*—Alcoholics who have found strength in recovery, through Alcoholics Anonymous, are sharing that recovery in many ways, including sponsorship.

The third word, *Principles*, is a rare word in many areas of

our lives. Nevertheless, it is not as yet extinct. This "pearl" means goals and ideals. Our principles can provide a guiding light for us. With clear and strong principles, we will not become captive to rules and petty regulations. Principles allow us to seek the best ideas in A.A. in ways that include many perspectives and the time to become informed. That freedom is what gives us trust in the Fellowship. It allows us to seek an informed opinion and to act in accordance with our principles.

Next, the word *Through*—Through is not some lowly little preposition in our theme. It conveys a wonderful sense of wholeness. It means "all the way"—as in "all the way through"; it is not just the how or the means by which the principles are carried and protected by sponsorship. Through has the power of a healthy integrity. At every level, in every aspect, in every part, A.A. is still one to one, alcoholic to alcoholic, sharing strength, hope and experience. Yes, all the way through A.A., from the meeting around the corner to the remote meeting, from country to country, Conference to Conference, Panel 1 to Panel 2, and Panel 52 to Panel 53—each sharing and serving the other.

And, now the last word, *Sponsorship*—Well, it really is the best word. You know that sponsorship is that ultimate sharing; when everything else is about to give way, it is the last string to break. Sponsorship is a word of art in A.A. It is not just a *pro forma* position, or the purchase of good will. That digging down into one's self to find something to share that helps someone else see the way that will work for them—that is an act of love. Sometimes I suspect that love is a returning of love previously given—in the sense of "passing it on." I also believe that the willingness to sponsor or to accept sponsoring is a way of expressing a love for the Fellowship. It is an expression of trust in the Fellowship and its principles, as well as trust in each other.

Many aspects of our lives together as members of the Fellowship, and for me as a friend of the Fellowship, would be unbearably chaotic but for the guidance of sponsorship. How does sponsorship work? For me, it worked when someone wrote me a letter of amends and in that letter shared how he got sober. It worked riding in the car with two friends who explained the Fellowship, and their experience, strength and hope as alcoholics, so that I might be a better judge. It continued to work as three friends showed up for breakfast, gave me an *A.A. Service Manual* and asked me to send my résumé to New York. Thank you, Bob, Buck, and Art. I have known that I can turn to these three men and get their best thinking and sharing. I wonder if I am going to have to ask them not to cut me loose just because I am rotating. What do Class A trustees do for sponsorship after they rotate?

I also have realized that sponsorship is a two-way street. The sponsor gains strength, hope and experience as he or she shares. Is this part of what it means when you say you have to give it away to keep it?

The important part of sponsorship is that it passes on the principles in a way that is loving and relevant to the individual. Sponsorship is how we make the printed words, as well as the spoken words in meetings, come home to live with us on a daily basis. I have recently been distressed with people who confuse dialogue with monologue and diatribe. *Dia logos* is about



talking through the meaning or the logic of something, like a problem or issue. It is a flow of meaning, between or among a number of people. With a sponsor, one has the safety to talk through the principles of A.A. and see how they fit into one's life and how they can guide personal and group decisions.

Sponsorship can help carry the principles of A.A. around the world. It can be individual or it can be as big as country to country. This week we will have the opportunity to understand how grand sponsorship is in Alcoholics Anonymous. And we will have the opportunity to pass it on. I wish each of you a wonderful Conference. Now, let us get to work.

Linda Chezem, trustee

Workshop— Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship

Wednesday morning Conference members dividing into 10 groups of 13 to 14 each for workshop discussions. Participants were invited to focus on how the lessons embodied in "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship" are practiced in the categories outlined. Following are questions and a summary of responses from these discussions.

"Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics. It works when other activities fail. This is our *twelfth suggestion*: Carry this message to other alcoholics! You can help when no one else can...."

"Life will take on new meaning. To watch people recover, to see them help others, to watch loneliness vanish, to see a fellowship grow up about you, to have a host of friends – this is an experience you must not miss. We know you will not want to miss it. Frequent contact with newcomers and with each other is the bright spot of our lives." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, page 89)

1. What are the basic responsibilities in a sponsorship relationship?

The basic responsibilities in a sponsorship relationship are to work the Twelve Steps as outlined in *Alcoholics Anonymous*, read the Big Book, the Twelve Traditions, the Twelve Concepts, and other Conference-approved literature. The sponsor may encourage the sponsee to attend meetings, attend the same meetings regularly, find a home group, get into service and attend service events. In addition, the sponsor acts as a spiritual guide, focusing on humility and responsibility, anonymity and responsibility, being available, building trust, being honest, and providing love. Sponsors lead by example; they walk the walk, and share their experience, strength and hope with the sponsee. Sponsors share with their sponsees what was shared with them and they show their sponsees a new way of life by being a friend, letting them be who they are, providing kind, simple and loving guidance, providing reassurance, letting them own their recovery, teaching them how not to react to problems, teaching them how to be accountable and responsible, teaching A.A. etiquette, and teaching them how to live the A.A. principles. Sponsors try to be with the sponsee at every stage of their sobriety, by calling them daily, letting them talk about their problems, letting them proceed at their own pace, letting them know they are not alone, helping them to find a Higher Power, and bringing a Higher Power into the relationship. Sponsors provide additional tools such as phone lists and/or the names of backup sponsors.

In addition, sponsors teach their sponsees principles above personalities, to think for themselves, and that it is okay to make mistakes. They ask the sponsee, "What are you willing to

do to stay sober?" They explain the do's and don'ts, and they look for solutions. It is the sponsor's responsibility to carry the message and not the alcoholic. It is important not to lend a sponsee money or give marital or legal advice.

Instead of looking for a sponsor, it is helpful to 'listen' for one. Look at the door to see who is coming in. It is important that sponsors do a Fifth Step, practice the Eleventh Step, read the sponsorship pamphlet, and follow directions in the Big Book. A sponsee may recognize that their sponsor's answer may not always be the best answer.

Important qualities in a sponsor include being honest, open minded, trustworthy, enthusiastic, a good listener, encouraging, loving and tolerant, firm but loving, using love instead of guilt, able to detach with love, nonjudgmental, able to love no matter how long a sponsee has been sober and/or whether the sponsee drinks or not, open and honest about their own difficulties, and being able to say "I don't know." It is important to be aware of the time commitment a sponsee may need and to understand our personal limits as sponsors.

2. What is service sponsorship? How is it different?

With service we have more tools to stay sober and centered in sobriety. Service teaches us respect for others' opinions. It places principles above personalities, and it encourages participation and responsibility. It helps us to stay connected to A.A. and to get closer to our Higher Power. Service is not a chore but a privilege. It feels good to be trusted to serve and to be a small part of a large whole. Service is one person talking to another, passing on what was freely given. It is a process we use to address the question, "How can this be useful in helping carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic?" Service is not political; rather, it preserves the A.A. message. We move from dealing with internal conflict to dealing with external conflict through the Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts. Service is Twelfth Step work beyond the group level.

Service sponsors teach us about the service structure, provide us with and help us to study *The A.A. Service Manual*, other A.A. literature (e.g. *A.A. Comes of Age*), and pamphlets on the Twelve Traditions and Concepts. They introduce us to the Three Legacies. They are humble mentors who have done service themselves. They make themselves available at service functions, act as a resource to others about service opportunities, and they encourage us to get into service by being an example) of helping others. They are willing to share the principles and they teach us how to keep the connection between service work and helping the drunk who still suffers. Often they are oldtimers or people with a strong grounding in recovery as evidenced by their depth and insight. Service sponsors are flexible, patient, tolerant, loving, and understanding. They are available to explain service positions.

Although everybody can have sobriety, not everyone can or should get involved in general service. Sometimes a member outside of an area is better suited to answer practical questions about service. Sometimes the "collective" wisdom is all we need. Some members had never heard the term "service sponsorship." For others, it evolved as a result of their Twelve Step sponsors not being involved in general service and therefore not having a shared experience to pass on. This prompted them to seek out members who practiced the Traditions and had shared general service experience. Service sponsors show us how the Traditions and Concepts can guide our decisions in service, rather than how the Steps help our recovery. As a mentor for service, service sponsors teach the responsibilities of being guardians of the Traditions and Concepts.

The principles of sponsorship are the same (e.g. honesty,

courage, hope, confidentiality, being able to say "I don't know," leading by example, and letting people make mistakes). Although service sponsorship is different in form (e.g. can be done effectively by phone or e-mail instead of face-to-face), it is not different in spirit. Service sponsorship usually goes after or in conjunction with a recovery sponsor. Service sponsorship starts with trying to be a better person, showing the next person some basic step in the home group, and grows into general service. Sometimes it is better to learn as an alternate before assuming new service responsibilities. The process of rotation in service should not mean abandonment. Rather, after rotating in service, go back to carrying the message. Transmit the responsibility of ownership to new members. Encourage them to seek service opportunities that they are passionate about. And remind them that service alone cannot keep us sober, but recovery, unity and service can.

3. How do A.A.s in your area sponsor professionals?

A.A.s sponsor professionals by contact on an individual basis, by talking with them about their recovery during casual contact, taking them to lunch, and becoming a Twelfth Step referral for their clients.

On a larger scale, A.A.s attend C.P.C. luncheons, have bilingual C.P.C. committees (English and Spanish or English and French), have an institutions weekend with treatment facilities, invite professionals from corrections committees to meet A.A.s and hold a day of sharing for C.P. professionals and C.F. committee chairs.

Professionals and nonalcoholics are invited to conferences and conventions. The message is carried through national level conventions of professionals. Workshops are held for clergy, doctors, nurses and other professionals. Professionals are invited to A.A. workshops at the area and district levels. Some areas put together campaigns aimed at specific professions. Some groups hold workshops or conferences aimed at

specific groups. Panels of professionals share with A.A. members what they need from A.A. Community workshops are held for all professionals. Literature is provided at these gatherings. Class A trustees are invited to these events. As more professionals are educated, they can become Class A trustees. Doctors, nurses, clergy and nonalcoholics are taken to open A.A. meetings.

Literature, such as pamphlets (e.g. "The A.A. Member—Other Medications and Other Drugs") and newsletters (e.g. *About A.A.*), is provided to professionals, including medical schools, hospitals, doctors' offices, and the justice system. Big Books and Grapevine subscriptions are provided to doctors' offices. Old issues of the Grapevine are donated to doctors' offices and waiting rooms, subscriptions of the Grapevine are given to clergy. Big Books in different languages are given to clergy. A.A. literature (e.g. Grapevine subscriptions) is given to E.A.P. offices, health fairs and schools. One area has a competition to see which district can sign up the most professionals to a subscription of *About A.A.* Packets of material are put together for members to leave with their professionals.

More needs to be done to reach outside our Fellowship to our nonalcoholic professional friends. This is very tough to do when activities depend on committee chair rotations from year to year. We need to think more about how to sponsor the professionals. The most attractive way to sponsor professionals is by "living the A.A. principles." Share the First and Twelfth Steps and how your life has grown and changed. Inform them about our Traditions of singleness of purpose, self-support, non-affiliation and anonymity. Professionals seem to be on their own. Therefore, commitment and consistency are necessary and needed. And remember, even if they don't respond, they have still been educated.

We would like to express our gratitude to the Conference for providing such wonderful topics.



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2003 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

1 That the trial period for use of laptops at the General Service Conference be extended through the 54th General Service Conference. At the 54th General Service Conference, with the information provided in the trustees' Conference Committee report on the original two years of the experiment, the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions can address the matter of ongoing usage of laptops at the General Service Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 2 The theme for the 2004 General Service Conference be: "Our Singleness of Purpose — The Cornerstone of A.A."
- 3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2004 General Service Conference:

- a) Our Singleness of Purpose:
 - 1) Our Responsibility to the Newcomer
 - 2) Communicating Our Singleness of Purpose
- b) The Cornerstone of A.A.:
 - 1) Safeguarding Our Unity
 - 2) The Role of the Home Group
 - 3) Traditions Three and Five: Our Members, Our Message

- 4 The following be the workshop topic for the 2004 General Service Conference:

"How is Singleness of Purpose Important to the Individual, Group, District, Area, and G.S.O. and Grapevine Offices?"

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 5 The "Singleness of Purpose" statement in six designated C.P.C. pamphlets ("Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals," "If You are a Professional . . .," and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous") be changed to read:

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings."

- 6 Three changes to the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals" (P-29):

- The sentence on page 14, Number 2, item F, which reads "G.S.O. staff members also have assignments in those fields," be changed to read: "G.S.O. staff members also have rotating assignments in those fields;"
- The sentence on page 15, Number 5, which reads: "If asked, individual members may recommend someone—but with the clear understanding that the reference is strictly personal, *not* made in behalf of A.A.," be changed to read: "If asked, individual members may recommend someone—but with the clear understanding that the reference is strictly personal, *not* made on behalf of A.A."
- The sentence on page 21, Number 19, first paragraph, which reads: "There is no formal relationship at all, any more than there is a structural or official relationship between A.A. and any church, temple, ethical or humanist or agnostic society, or medication centers that a member may attend," be changed to read "There is no formal relationship at all, any more than there is a structural or official relationship between A.A. and any church, temple, ethical or humanist or agnostic society, or meditation centers that a member may attend."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 7 The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities revise the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* by adding/replacing stories to better reflect current experience, and that a draft manuscript or progress report be brought to the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

Note: The committee suggested that stories/sharing of young people and women be included in the revised booklet.

FINANCE

No recommendations.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

- 8 The first paragraph of the description of the Grapevine representative on page 9 of the pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print" be revised to read as follows:

Grapevine and La Viña representatives

"Grapevine representatives (GvRs) and La Viña representatives (RLVs) perform a service for A.A. members, bringing them two vital tools of recovery — the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous and La Viña. GvRs and RLVs are engaged in practical, hands-on work. Their basic job is to make the magazines available to the group, to encourage A.A.s to read them, subscribe to them, and use them in Twelfth Step work."

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

It was recommended that:

¹ Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- 9 Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2005 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

Note: It is estimated that transportation, housing and meal reimbursement will be \$2,500 to \$3,000 for each speaker.

- 10 The under noted three (3) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2015: Atlanta, Indianapolis, Vancouver.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 11 A draft Introduction to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be developed by the General Service Office's Publications Department and reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee and brought back to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for their consideration.

Note: The purpose of adding an Introduction would be to explain the language in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and would include the following information:

- Time and era of publication
- Language as a reflection of the time period
- Reference to the 2002 Conference Advisory Action:
"It was unanimously recommended that the text in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, written by Bill Wilson remain as is recognizing the Fellowship's feeling that Bill's writings be retained as originally published."

This Introduction is to create a unified response to questions regarding specific language, idioms, and historical figures or events from A.A. members, newcomers and nonalcoholics.

- 12 The updated draft manuscript of the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet be approved.

Note: This draft manuscript was not distributed to all Conference members based on the 1993 Additional Committee Consideration of the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee:

"The committee reviewed Conference policy as it relates to restricted or confidential matters, and agreed that restrictions apply only to legal matters that are pending, and to literature/audiovisual projects that are works in progress."

- 13 The following changes to "The A.A. Grapevine" section of "Your A.A. General Service Office" pamphlet be approved:

- a) Replace the second sentence: "Members of the editorial staff are A.A.s; the controller, circulation supervisor, and clerical workers are nonalcoholics" with the sentence "Some of the editorial staff are A.A. members."
- b) Add a third sentence: "Since 1995 the Grapevine has also published La Viña for Spanish-speaking A.A.s."
- c) Replace the last sentence: "All stories submitted are acknowledged with personal letters," with the sentence: "All stories submitted are acknowledged by the Grapevine staff."

- 14 The phrase, "not even your parents," be deleted from the second sentence in the sixth panel of the story "Vinnie" in the pamphlet "Too Young."

- 15 The trustees' Literature Committee initiate a comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, and that the trustees' Literature Committee bring a draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for their consideration. The committee requests that the secretary of the trustees' Literature Committee send a letter to all General Service Conference members requesting suggestions for updates or revisions to this pamphlet.

- 16 The following text changes to add La Viña information to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be approved:

- a) Change "Grapevine Representative" to "Grapevine/La Viña Representative" on the chart on page 24.
- b) Change fourth paragraph title on page 27 from "Grapevine Representative (GvR)" to "Grapevine/La Viña Representative (GvR/RLV)."
- c) Add new third paragraph as follows to the "Grapevine Representative (GvR)" section on page 27:

"La Viña representatives (RLVs) perform the same functions as the GvRs in Spanish-speaking groups and districts where La Viña, the Grapevine's magazine in Spanish, is 'our meeting in print.' Some districts or groups may also combine GvR and RLV functions."

- d) Change address and Grapevine material information on pages 27 and 28 to read:

- "New GvRs and RLVs should send their name, address, group name and group service number to: the Grapevine, 475 Riverside Drive, Room 1040, New York, NY 10115.
- ...and for books, tape cassettes, CDs and other Grapevine items available."

- 17 The updated illustrations and text revisions suggested by the trustees' Literature Committee to reflect contemporary language, clothing and hair styles and to add ethnic and age diversity to the pamphlet "What Happened to Joe..." be approved. All text and illustration changes in the revised pamphlet "What Happened to Joe" are to be reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee prior to publication.

- 18 Based on a suggestion from the trustees' Literature Committee, a draft manuscript of a new comic book format pamphlet which would have current language and updated illustrations to replace the pamphlet 'It Happened to Alice!' be developed and brought back to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for review. The concept for this pamphlet would be based on a single working mother who is involved in a drunk-driving incident, followed by introduction to A.A.

- 19 The development of a Third Edition of the Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, by the trustees' Literature Committee be approved and that a report from the trustees' Literature Committee be brought to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee specifying suggestions for contents, process and story solicitation for the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 20 Jim Keeney, general secretary, G.S.O. Great Britain, and Ann Napier, general secretary elect, G.S.O. Great Britain, be granted permission to attend the 53rd General Service Conference as observers.
- 21 Torvin (Torv) Theisen, alternate delegate, Area 74, No. WI/Upper Peninsula Michigan, be seated as a Conference member at the 53rd General Service Conference because Ted Lapine, the Panel 52 delegate for Area 74, is unable to attend.
- 22 The 56th General Service Conference be held April 23-29, 2006, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 23 The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), "We Know What It's Like," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee be approved.
- 24 The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), "We Know What It's Like," be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local committees, and that information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2004 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.
- 25 The 2004 Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved with the addition of "Skilled Trade" to Question 12: "What is the nature of your employment status now?"
- 26 The General Service Board explore ways that input from the Fellowship regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site may be addressed by a trustees' committee with a relevant Conference committee, and report back to the 2004 Conference Public Information Committee.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 27 The first sentence of the third bullet under "Delegates Duties" in Chapter Six in *The A.A. Service Manual* be replaced with: "Be prepared to attend all area and regional service meetings and assemblies applicable to his/her respective area."
- 28 The following two new bullet points be added as the first and second items under the section titled "Duties" in Chapter Two: The Group

and Its G.S.R. in *The A.A. Service Manual*:

- G.S.R.s attend district meetings
 - They also attend area assemblies
- 29 In *The A.A. Service Manual* the words "to reprint the Steps, Traditions, and/or the Concepts, and" be added to the first sentence in paragraph three under the section "Area Newsletters or Bulletins" in Chapter Four: The Area Assembly and Activities, to read:

"Local A.A. publications are permitted to reprint the Steps, Traditions, and/or the Concepts, and to quote a phrase, sentence or brief paragraph excerpted from A.A. literature such as the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, *The A.A. Service Manual* and Conference-approved pamphlets without a prior, written request to do so."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 30 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2003 (see page 38 for approved slate). The General Service Board will operate with six (rather than seven) Class A trustees between May 2003 and April 2004.
- 31 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in May 2003 (see page 38 for approved slate).
- 32 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the Grapevine Corporate Board in May 2003 (see page 38 for approved slate).



Presentations and Reports

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by a sharing session, was given by Vince Keefe, treasurer of the General Service Board and, chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

My name is Vince Keefe, and I am a grateful nonalcoholic trustee. You have given me a great gift this past year by allowing me to serve the Fellowship as a Class A trustee and, for that, I am most grateful. The truth is that I have already received much more than I have given.

What I would like to do in this presentation is create a broad template, which will serve as one of the focal points as you carry out the important work of this Conference. I realize that Twelfth Step work, not finances, is the primary focus of the Fellowship. At the same time, it is also true that good financial management is an integral part of good stewardship.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, is in the finance section of this Report. I would be remiss if I did not formally acknowledge the outstanding service that Kevin Sunkel, our audit partner, Don Meurer, chief financial officer for your General Service Office, and Bob Slotterback, A.A.W.S. accounting manager and past Grapevine controller, provide to this Fellowship. While they are nonalcoholics, they are clearly alive with the same love of this Fellowship that you have.

My theme for this presentation is one of my favorite sayings, which is "Not to Decide, is to Decide." To me it means that I have two options whenever facing situations that require a decision. I can choose to act, or I can choose to be silent and, in effect, not decide. In both cases, the phrase challenges us to be actively engaged. We should not let inaction be a way of avoiding active participation.

There is good news and more good news to report. The first part of the "good news" is that the financial position of the Fellowship is strong and healthy. We can see this more clearly by looking at an overview of the financial performance of calendar year 2002. Our expectations from a year ago were that the G.S.O. would finish the year with a deficit of \$780,450, that the Grapevine would just about break even, and that La Viña would have a deficit of \$114,777. Instead, the G.S.O. had a surplus of \$5,027 before accounting for the closing costs of SMAA of \$122,320. The net result of the small operating surplus and the SMAA closing costs is a deficit for the year of \$117,291. The Grapevine had a deficit of \$11,797, which includes \$2,260 related to SMAA, and La Viña finished with a smaller deficit of \$103,815. The combined result of the three budgets show that our deficit was \$662,136 less than expected, which is phenomenally good news. One significant benefit of this great performance is that the future need to increase literature prices can be delayed a little longer.

Let's look at the main reasons for our performance coming in so much better than we expected.

The Grapevine: Magazine income and monthly subscriptions were approximately even with the 2001 and 2002

budget. Even though subscription income was flat, the gross profit was ahead of budget by approximately \$36,800. Part of this increase can be attributed to the strong sales of new CDs and *The Language of the Heart/Big Book* package. Approximately \$27,000 is attributed to the lower cost of publishing the magazine. Costs and expenses were \$1,486,500, resulting in an operating loss of \$9,500, compared with an operating loss of \$96,000 in 2001. The Grapevine board and staff have obviously come a long way in managing the overall costs.

La Viña: La Viña is the Spanish-language project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. In 2001, the Conference again approved the General Service Board's recommendation that La Viña continue to be published and funded by the General Service Board. The average monthly subscriptions were 8,999, which is an increase of approximately 4%. This is the fourth consecutive year that La Viña subscriptions have increased. The overall loss for this project in 2002 was \$103,800, approximately \$11,000 less than expected. The General Service Board has invested \$668,118 in La Viña since the inception of the project.

General Service Office: There are two main reasons for the positive results this year. First, voluntary contributions have increased again for the fifth year in a row. This is incredibly good news and should be celebrated throughout the Fellowship. Contributions increased by \$196,000, or 4% over budget and 6.4% over last year. The G.S.O. also received \$107,500 in contributions to the International Fund that is managed on behalf of the World Service Meeting. The total increase in contributions was \$303,800, or 6.4% over budget and 8.7% over last year. I am of the opinion that this is happening because the Fellowship recognizes the great value in the services offered by the General Service Office to assist A.A. members in carrying hope to the next suffering alcoholic.

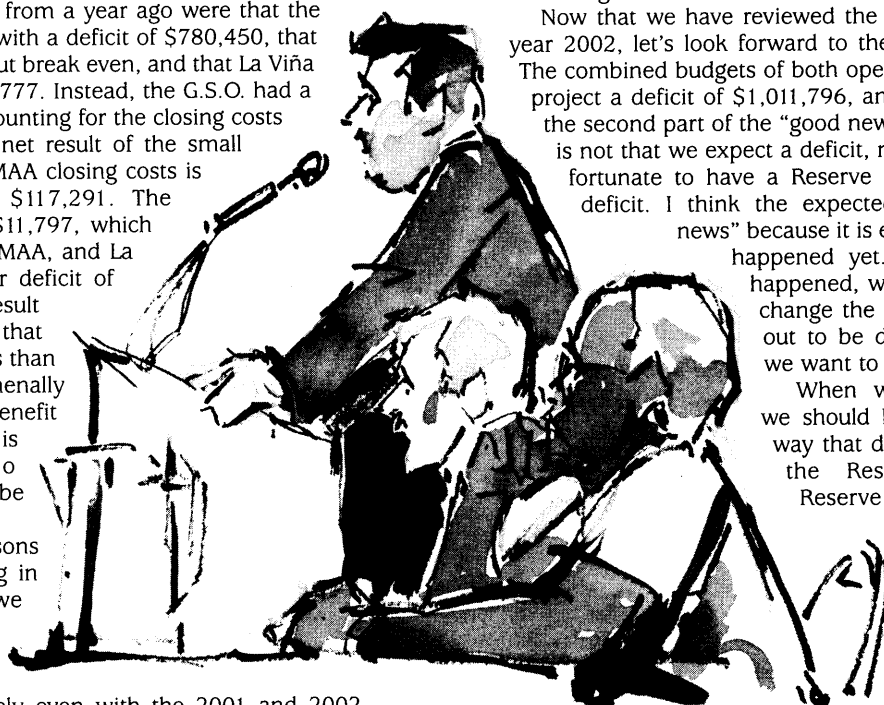
The second principal reason for this outstanding performance is that literature sales were \$1,040,000 greater than budgeted, resulting in gross profit exceeding the budget by \$302,300. The increases of \$303,800 in voluntary contributions and \$302,300 in gross profit from literature sales account for the lion's share of the positive performance. Expenses were very well managed and came in close to the budget.

Now that we have reviewed the final results of the year 2002, let's look forward to the budget for 2003.

The combined budgets of both operating corporations project a deficit of \$1,011,796, and this brings us to the second part of the "good news." The good news is not that we expect a deficit, nor is it that we are fortunate to have a Reserve Fund to cover the deficit. I think the expected deficit is "good news" because it is expected. It has not happened yet. Since it has not happened, we still have time to change the outcome if it turns out to be different than what we want to happen.

When we discuss deficits we should be clear about the way that deficits are linked to the Reserve Fund. The

Reserve Fund was never intended to fund operating losses. The primary purpose for the Reserve Fund is to provide the means to pay for



services in the event of a catastrophe. Having said this we should also note that the General Service Board has, from time to time, authorized withdrawals from the Fund to pay for certain capital projects. This would include projects such as the initial funding of the retirement plan, the moving and refurbishing of the office, and other projects that were considered beyond the scope of our operating budgets. Past Conferences have approved the concept of allowing deficits to be funded by the Reserve Fund, but only as a way to reduce the total Fund balance down to a prudent amount. Once the Fund balance is back to a prudent level the deficits need to be addressed by some other means, such as raising literature prices.

Let's get back to our projections and take a look at the possible outcomes. What if the projections work out as anticipated? I understand that the contributions for the months of January and February 2003 came in below last year levels. And remember that the projected deficit was after an expected increase in contributions of 2 %. This would mean that in the not too distant future we will need to increase literature prices to maintain a prudent Reserve Fund. It would be relatively easy to increase prices, but do you believe it would be the right thing to do? What impact would a price increase have on the Twelfth Step work performed through literature? Normally, when prices are increased the corresponding unit volumes go down. Perhaps we should be striving to find a way to lower rather than increase literature prices?

Another possibility is that contributions increase enough to reduce the expected deficit, thereby avoiding the necessity to increase literature prices. This would be a very positive outcome. And, of course, there is always the option to reduce expenses and, therefore, offset any potential deficits. We all know that this action would decrease the valuable service performed by the G.S.O. Reducing services to the Fellowship makes this choice very undesirable. Or, we could see some combination of these actions taking place. My interest today is not to try and lead anyone to a conclusion. Rather, my goal is to place this important issue before the responsible party, knowing with full confidence that a thoughtful, measured response would be forthcoming. I have learned this past year that responsibility is taken very seriously throughout the Fellowship. And who is the responsible party?

Concept I states that the final responsibility and the ultimate authority for A.A. World Services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship. It makes sense that the "whole Fellowship" should be responsible, since they are the source of contributions and also purchase the majority of our literature. But the "whole Fellowship" is not in the room today. Instead, it is members of the 53rd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous gathered here today.

Concept II describes the "General Service Conference . . . (as) the actual voice and the effective conscience for (the) whole Society." Does this then make you the direct link to the "collective conscience of the whole Fellowship?" If so, what are the next steps that you should be taking—if any?

What is your opinion of the financial choices that lie ahead for the Fellowship? Should you be discussing this with your fellow delegates? Do we know the "collective conscience" of the Fellowship on this most important topic? Does the Fellowship understand the choices? Should they? Should actions be taken this week to encourage this most important conversation throughout the Fellowship?

I encourage you to reflect on these questions and to remember that "Not to decide is to decide!" We should not let inaction become a way of avoiding active participation.

Vincent E. Keefe, treasurer, General Service Board

A.A. GRAPEVINE

The Monday afternoon presentation/discussion session was chaired by Ray Massey, Grapevine director.

The Grapevine: Editorial Process

Please reflect with me on the meaning of some of these words in your life before A.A. and your life today as a member of the 53rd General Service Conference: *sobriety; service; sponsorship; unity; God*. For me, sobriety before the program was dull, square; today it is life; service was what I didn't get in a restaurant or department store, today it's a form of love. As for God, I didn't want to hear that word when I walked into the rooms. Today I strive to live consciously connected to that power. To me it is clear that Bill's words on page 164 of the Big Book are prophetic: "Our book is meant to be suggestive only. We realize we know only a little. God will constantly disclose more to you and to us."

I've been reflecting on these words in the context of what the Grapevine means to us as a Fellowship. The Grapevine is one of the primary tools that our Higher Power is using to "disclose" more to us. In the early days it was responsible for hammering out "on thousands of anvils of group experience" the "Twelve Points to Assure Our Future." These today are the Traditions that comprise our Legacy of Unity. In the pages of the early Grapevine you can track the changes in the meaning of a word like service, our Third Legacy, as well as Bill and Bob's rationale and proposal for the formation of our General Service Conference. We've come a long way, from that booze hound from Brooklyn who met that drunken doctor in Akron, Ohio in 1935, to our 53rd General Service Conference at the Crowne Plaza in New York City. Spiritually, however, we're still back with these two drunks and the man on the bed as we read each new story in this month's issue. From 1944 to 1971, the magazine was the microphone with which Bill addressed an unruly group of sober drunks who didn't want to hear about "those damned Traditions." Without the Traditions and our Legacy of Service, none of us would be here today. That's how much the A.A. Grapevine means to the Fellowship.

Doubtless more will be revealed as a result of the work we are doing here and the joy we're experiencing in sharing one another's presence, ideas and experience. Much like the revelations that took place this morning at our 7:30 A.A. meeting, so the Grapevine as our meeting in print allows our Higher Power to disclose more through us and to us in the pages of this wonderful magazine. The Grapevine's statement of purpose says that it is "the voice of the Alcoholics Anonymous movement." In addition to the Traditions and our Legacy of Service, look at some of the other things that originated with the Grapevine: the Slogans, the Responsibility Statement and the Preamble. Almost every meeting throughout the world starts with the A.A. Preamble. What a marvelous source of unity. Our 70th Anniversary Convention, in 2005, will have as its theme "We Are Responsible."

Another attribute of the Grapevine is that it is a "monthly mirror of A.A. in Action." Sometimes that mirror asks tough questions like: Should we go easy on the God Stuff? and Why are We Anonymous?; Recovery from fear and resentment is not easy in a world at war; A.A. in Cyberspace always seems to cause heated discussion. Sometimes the special section of the magazine is like a Big Book Study: The Jumping Off Place is that loneliness where you can't live with or without alcohol and you will "wish for the end." Perhaps the way we deal with that place is by "Filling the Big Empty." Or maybe it's "About Sex," an area in which "many of us needed an overhauling." In 1947, Bill says some groups talk about a sponsor as the person who gets the

drunk into a hospital and works with him there. In the May 2003 Grapevine we have come full circle to that man on the bed and at the same time offer stories with new experiences of the magic of one alcoholic working with another.

The Grapevine chronicles our history. In our new book coming in June we'll be talking about the major issues that have caused our readers to write letters to the magazine over the years. Look at some of these topics: this problem of God again; sponsorship; exclusiveness; membership; drug addiction and primary purpose. What a worldwide forum for dialogue this magazine has become. As a 68-year-old, Alcoholics Anonymous stands as the powerful recovery program that has transformed the lives of millions of alcoholics. Yet we are young at heart and willing to learn the new insights disclosed to us each day. Take spirituality for example. If you want to know how members of our meeting in print describe the spiritual basis of this program, you'll find it in another new Grapevine collection on the spirituality of alcoholics.

I was at the NERASSA meeting two months ago at a presentation about A.A. in Cyberspace, and the Grapevine October 2002 edition was frequently quoted. The speakers helped me realize that we really have nothing to say about whether our recovery message goes on-line or not. The message is so powerful, the need is so great, that we can say thank God it's unstoppable. Our great service mission is to help the cyberspace alcoholics incorporate the Traditions, the Steps, and Concepts so that our Legacies remain "ever ancient, ever new" — expanding and contracting in the ever changing environment of new communication tools. Where better to share the experience of our message in cyberspace and its relationship to the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts than in our meeting in print.

The A.A. Grapevine is the inclusive voice of Alcoholics Anonymous, allowing all segments of our recovery program to be heard — even in institutions. July of this coming year, we're publishing a special section in the magazine on "Released" and how to stay released. How not to go back into prison according to ex-convicts who have made the transition. This special section will be a compendium of experience, strength and hope on how to stay out of prison and how to become a useful member of society.

More and more cooperation with the trustees' committees, with the Conference committees, with that marvelous structure that all of you are so close to, this is what we need. Let's together explore anew, with fresh eyes, with youthful eyes, with older sparkling eyes, the incredible transformation that is taking place in all our lives. "We realize we know only a little. God will constantly disclose more to you and to us" in this meeting in print, mirror of the Fellowship and voice of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Desmond Towey, Grapevine executive editor

Around the Fellowship

Like most things in A.A., the A.A. Grapevine evolved from an idea, an identified need, and the hard work and perseverance of a few people. By the early 1940s, A.A. was growing fast and there was a need for communication and a feeling of connection. The Big Book had been in print for about five years and approximately 16,000 copies had been sold. As a result of the Jack Alexander article, A.A. membership had increased dramatically from 2,000 to 8,000. There were no means for A.A. members to communicate with each other; groups from one part of the country did not know how other groups conducted business, and there were no A.A. publications besides the Big Book and one or two pamphlets.

To fill this communication vacuum, a couple of local A.A. newsletters were published. Early in 1944, a New York A.A. member, Lois K., obtained one of these newsletters. Lois had a concern about what appeared to be a "lack of understanding" among the New York groups. After reading the newsletters, an idea was born that Lois pitched to Bill Wilson in April 1944. That idea was a magazine that would foster "harmony between groups through knowledge and understanding." ("A.A. Grapevine History," p. 2) After receiving Bill's blessing, Lois gathered five other people and they put together and published in June 1944 the first issue of a magazine entitled The Grapevine. Copies were distributed to the groups in the New York metropolitan area, as well as to every group secretary around the country. In addition, the editors sent a copy to every known A.A. member in the armed services. An entire page, with the heading "Mail Call for All A.A.s in the Armed Forces," was devoted to publishing letters received from such A.A. members. These members began to refer to the Grapevine as their "meeting in print," a designation that has stayed with the magazine ever since. The early Grapevine also reported on such topics as the formation of new groups, "advice" for both groups and newly sober individuals, and suggested healthy alternatives to drinking. In the September 1944 issue, one A.A. suggested that special groups be formed for "older members" — oldtimers with one or two months of sobriety.

In 1946, the Grapevine became one of the two publishing arms of the Alcoholic Foundation. During this incorporation, Bill Wilson summed up his vision of the Grapevine, "The Grapevine will be the Voice of the Alcoholics Anonymous movement. Its editors and staff will be primarily accountable to the A.A. movement as a whole.... Within the bounds of friendliness and good taste, the Grapevine will enjoy perfect freedom of speech on all matters directly pertaining to Alcoholics Anonymous. ... The Grapevine will be a newspaper written by A.A.s and friends of A.A. Like the Alcoholics Anonymous movement it is to mirror, there will be but one central purpose, viz: 'The Grapevine will try to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics and practice the A.A. principles in all its affairs.'" ("A.A. Grapevine History," p. 4.)

To this end, the magazine has fulfilled Bill's vision. Throughout its history the Grapevine has been the forum for new ideas. It was the vehicle by which Bill introduced the Twelve Traditions in a series of articles culminating in April 1946 when the Grapevine published Bill's article "Twelve Points to Assure Our Future." In June 1947, the Grapevine helped clarify what A.A. was all about with the publication of the A.A. Preamble. Through the Grapevine, the Traditions, as well as many other issues, got a thorough airing. Members could now use the magazine to express their ideas, which they did willingly and freely. Although Bill W. contributed heavily, the magazine has always been and will always be primarily the voice of the individual A.A. member. The Grapevine carries the experience, strength, and hope of countless recovering alcoholics. It is one drunk talking to another. In 1995, a Spanish-language magazine, La Viña, was approved for production because a need was identified. La Viña now has a subscription rate of approximately 9,000 per issue.

However, as the old saying goes, "What have you done for me lately?" In an effort to reverse the trend of declining subscriptions, a new executive director was hired in 2001. With that hiring came a new philosophy and enthusiasm for the magazine. The board elected to adopt for itself the Responsibility Declaration that appears in each issue of the Grapevine. That declaration has been adapted to read: "We are responsible — when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, we want a copy of the Grapevine always to be within arms reach. And for that: we are responsible." Aggressive Attraction Strategies were imple-



mented. In an effort to increase interest in the magazine, the Grapevine was redesigned, a new four-color GV catalog and new CDs were produced, a gift edition of *The Best of Bill* was developed and offered to the Fellowship, and the Grapevine Web site was redesigned to stimulate interest and provide much needed services. Keep coming back until you find out what's in store for 2003.

What can you and I do to carry the message and help stimulate interest in the Grapevine. First, we can actively and visibly support the magazine. We, as delegates and staff people, can provide information and support to our area's Grapevine representatives. We can follow Des T.'s example and carry copies of the Grapevine with us wherever we go and talk about it at any opportunity.

There is nothing that says we can't have more than one subscription. Some say individuals should have as many Grapevine subscriptions as we have bathrooms in our residences. Others have as many subscriptions as they are years sober, whereas others give subscriptions to their doctors, lawyers, or clergy. We can write articles. We can encourage others to also contribute. The Grapevine, in addition to being our meeting in print, also makes an excellent Twelfth Step tool.

I have shared what you can do to carry the message. Now what can I do as an A.A. member and a trusted servant? I think the best way is to borrow a few lines from the television show "MASH." In this particular episode Frank Burns has ordered Hawkeye to carry a gun. Hawkeye's response was: "I will not carry a gun, Frank. When I got thrown into this war, I had a clear understanding with the Pentagon: no guns. I'll carry your books, I'll carry a torch, I'll carry a tune, carry on, carry over, carry forward, Cary Grant, cash and carry, 'Carry Me Back to Ol' Virginie,' I'll even hari-kari if you show me how, but I will not carry a gun!"

When I was introduced to the A.A. program, I had a clear understanding with myself: no Grapevine. However, as time went on and I became more enlightened, my philosophy has changed. Now I'll carry the Grapevine, I'll carry subscription blanks; if I could carry a tune I would sing to the high heavens the accolades of the Grapevine; I won't hari-kari, even if you show me how; however, I will carry on, carry over, carry forward the message of the Grapevine. And for that: I am responsible.

Pete Bartlett, Mid-Southern California

A.A. AROUND THE WORLD

Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada, chaired the Monday evening presentation/discussion session.

As trustee-at-large/U.S. I have the pleasure of serving, along with Alex Palmer, as delegate to the World Service Meeting representing the service structure of the U.S. and Canada. The World Service Meeting (WSM) is held every two years, alternating

between New York and another location chosen by the WSM delegates. The 17th World Service Meeting met for five days this past October in Oviedo, Spain. The theme was "The A.A. Message — A Message Without Borders."

I have to confess that I suffered from that Spencerian phenomenon known in the program as "contempt prior to investigation." I thought the ideal of gathering delegates from the various service structures was certainly noble, but served a largely symbolic purpose; that is, it served a *pro forma* attempt at a demonstration of unity, but probably served very little practical purpose. I found instead an active exchange of useful information and cooperation. Listening to the formal presentations provided one with valuable insight and appreciation for our three precious Legacies of Recovery, with its Twelve Steps, Unity, with the Twelve Traditions, and Service, with the Twelve Concepts for World Service.

The free exchange of problems and viable solutions covered at the numerous workshops gave me an increased awareness and appreciation of the scope of our international Fifth Tradition efforts. Each country gave a thorough report of progress in their respective countries. Reports on the Interim and Zonal Service Meetings, which are held in the years the World Service Meeting is not in session, were presented. These Zonal Meetings are comprised of the Asia Oceania Service Meeting, the Meeting of the Americas, the European Service Meeting and, for the first time in 2002, the Eastern European Service Meeting. These may soon to be joined by a Sub-Saharan Meeting.

The World Service Meeting is further divided into four standing committees: Agenda, Literature/Publishing, Working with Others, and Policy/Admissions/Finance. The latter committee, chaired by Alex Palmer, observed that the attendance at the World Service Meeting has remained static in spite of the growth of various service structures through the world. They also suggested that the minimum contribution per delegate be reduced from \$2,800 to \$1,100, hoping to attract newer emerging structures to the meeting. At the same time the more established structures would pay the estimated full cost per delegate based on the preceding meeting costs of approximately \$4,400. This was verified by the delegates and subsequently approved by your General Service Board. The World Service Meeting has a full and useful agenda; one that can enhance our responsibility of sharing our message with the still-suffering alcoholics throughout the world.

I arrived at the Madrid Airport on October 5th and made my way to the departure gate for Oviedo. There I was delighted to see Alex and we were soon joined by Greg Muth. I mention this only because I don't want to leave out an exciting part of our journey. At the Asturias regional airport, the three of us were met by the local hospitality committee, for the 35-mile ride into Oviedo for what I assumed would be a 45-minute trip. It took only 20 minutes. We slowed to 85 mph at a few points of interest, otherwise we traveled at 90-95 mph.

Fortunately the pace slowed down the next day when 41 delegates, representing 29 countries or zones, registered and attended a reception hosted by the local committee. A Red Ball Meeting followed, where the delegates had a chance to break the ice and meet new and old friends. That evening we enjoyed a banquet and the pleasure of an opening address by the nonalcoholic chairman of the Spanish General Service Board.

The next morning Greg Muth opened the meeting with a roll call and orientation session. The keynote address was given by Paul Mc. of Ireland. He pointed out that his small island has two currencies, two governments, two healthcare and legal systems; his hometown is Belfast, Northern Ireland, which has two borders dividing people by religion and politics. But in all of Ireland there is but one A.A. and a message that ignores the borders.

There were a total of 13 special presentations made throughout the five days under six common subjects: "Sponsoring the Newcomer into Service," "Carrying the Message Through Electronic Media," "How Can We Make the A.A. Message Accessible to Individuals with Physical Limitations?," "Sharing the Experience of Sponsoring Other Countries," "How to Carry the Message in a Changing World," and "Sponsorship—Country to Country." Greg presented the report on the International Literature Fund, made a report on "A.A.W.S. Policy on Translation of A.A. Literature." He stressed the importance of protecting the integrity of the message in any translation and the importance of protecting the copyright of A.A. material.

I marveled at the orderly direction of the meeting — everything on time, background material always at the ready, and even an inflatable red ball. This shouldn't have surprised me based on my Conference experience — where you have the competent staff we are blessed with. There in Spain was Valerie, Adrienne, Doug, Bill Archer, and John Kirwin handling matters with the experience, efficiency, tact, love and patience that we in A.A. have come to cherish, respect and honor.

The 17th World Service Meeting wound up with the closing remarks of the second term delegates. Each told of their experience and satisfaction of having the opportunity to serve at the worldwide gathering of A.A. Greg Muth and Gabriel Rodriguez Martinez-Sierra gave the closing remarks. The meeting closed with the recitation of the Serenity Prayer in the 16 languages spoken by those present.

The 18th World Service Meeting will be held in New York City, October 24 — 18, 2004. The theme will be "One Message — Many Languages — One Fellowship."

Charlie Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S.

New Frontiers

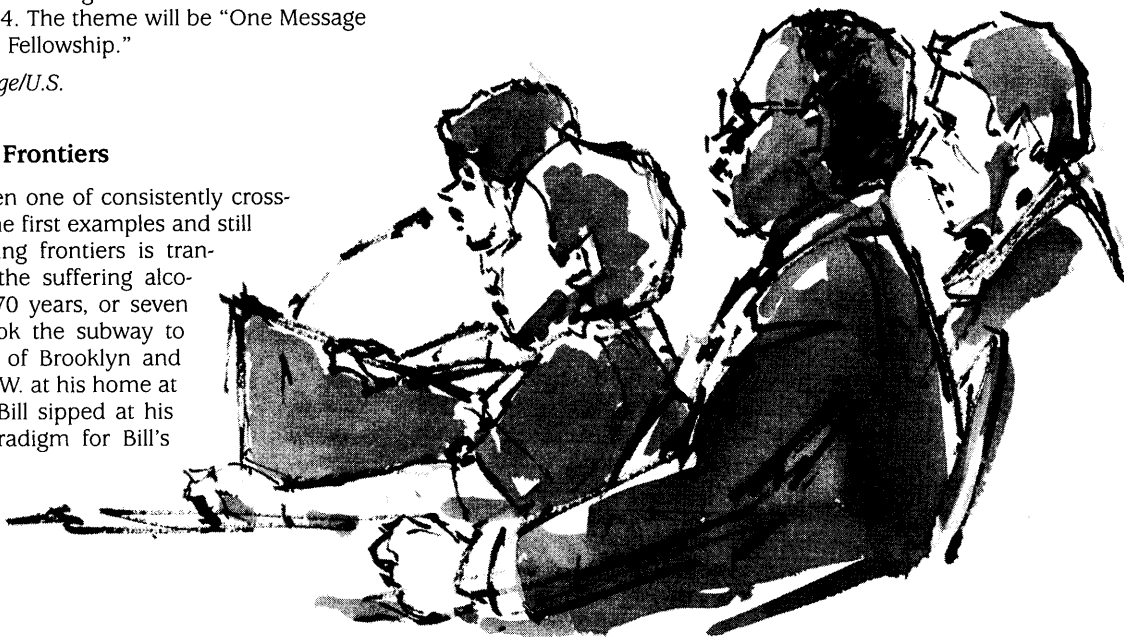
The history of A.A. has been one of consistently crossing new frontiers. One of the first examples and still one of the most challenging frontiers is transcending the isolation of the suffering alcoholic. It has been almost 70 years, or seven decades, since Ebby T. took the subway to that distant outer-borough of Brooklyn and called on his old friend Bill W. at his home at 182 Clinton Street. While Bill sipped at his gin, Ebby became the paradigm for Bill's later actions and the Fellowship's history of Twelfth Step action that has ensured each of our sobrieties and the very life of our Fellowship.

Ebby was laying out the method of how we transcend the alcoholic's frontier of isolation. He was involved in the action of *carrying the message*. It was only through this work that the frontier of isolation was and is able to be crossed.

Since Ebby's visit in the autumn of 1934, Alcoholics Anonymous has faced and crossed many other frontiers. We realized that we needed to have literature to be able to reach more people than we could on a one-to-one or group basis. We wrote a book — *Alcoholics Anonymous* — and we were thus able to not only *carry the message*, but we could *carry or send the book* that contained the message. But, how would A.A. work in the growing number of A.A. communities outside of the New York and Ohio groups? It worked fine because we had produced a book that told our story and these new centers used our stories to guide them to transcend their own frontiers.

We next wondered whether this message would work in other countries and languages and I am greatly relieved that it did. When I was finally ready to hear the message in 1984 it was available in over 600 groups in my hometown of Montreal, Québec. Almost 500 of the groups were French-speaking. I am gratified to share that some of the most important men and women in my sobriety are those members who were able to have received the message in their native language — French. It was proof positive to this alcoholic that our message and literature could transcend those boundaries. It was not only in Canada that the frontiers were crossed. Most English-speaking countries across the world from Europe to the nations fondly know as those "down under" and South Africa all have long histories of A.A. success. Norway was one of the first non-English-speaking countries that had the Fellowship take root, soon followed by our neighbors to the south, Mexico, where A.A. today enjoys an especially vibrant and ever-growing Fellowship.

In the 1980s, A.A. in our Conference structure experienced a period of exponential growth. The same was true for A.A. around the world. In the late 1980s, as Eastern Europe began the long road back from the Soviet experience, the question for A.A. lay in whether A.A. would work for those alcoholics who had lived through a system which seemed antithetical to A.A.'s spiritual principles. Happily our fears were unfounded and the Fellowship is now anchored in Eastern Europe by Poland and Russia. They are both working hard at aiding the development of A.A. from the Baltic to the Balkans. I had the pleasure of vis-



iting both Poland and Russia last year where I witnessed the same hunger and desire for *carrying the message* that was evidenced by our old friend Ebby so many years ago.

I am supposed to be addressing New Frontiers, and I have spent half of my time giving a historical perspective, so I think that I better get to the matter at hand. My two most fascinating experiences in the past year have been to areas of the world where we indeed face New Frontiers.

In September I visited the A.A. communities in Thailand and Hong Kong before joining up with Dr. George Vaillant to take part in the first-ever symposium on substance abuse in the People's Republic of China. In both Hong Kong and Thailand the Fellowship is largely made up of expatriate English-speaking members who were wondering how they could cross what seemed to be insurmountable boundaries of reaching the indigenous Thai and Chinese communities. I was able to share with them the experience that we had received from other countries with similar challenges. The secret seems to be found in approaching various professional communities and also having written material available in the indigenous languages so that the alcoholic can have direct access to our program. We examined the material available and as a result, A.A.W.S. embarked on translating five pamphlets into Thai that were published early in 2003. The Chinese material is being assessed and we are certain that at the upcoming A.O.S.M. (Asia-Oceania Service Meeting) in Hong Kong in July, the subject of reaching the indigenous communities will be front and center.

Our trip to the People's Republic of China was the culmination of patient and persistent work by my predecessor on the International desk, Eva Sanchez, and the dedication and commitment of a small group of medical professionals in China. Since their visit to our 65th Anniversary Celebration in 2000, these Chinese doctors have been shepherding A.A. growth in their hospitals and amongst the Chinese community. Following a 2001 visit to China by Dr. Vaillant, Eva and Greg Muth, we have translated both *Alcoholics Anonymous* and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and several pamphlets into Simplified Chinese.

There are still many restrictions on gatherings between foreigners and Chinese nationals and the expatriate A.A. community is careful about how much contact they have officially with Chinese nationals in their A.A. groups. There are, though, several small meetings that bring together bilingual English members and the Chinese members. I had the privilege to attend some of

these. The first one was the most memorable. As I sat in the circle on the floor in a member's living room and watched as each of the Chinese members pulled out their copy of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in Simplified Chinese, I welled up in tears at the thought of what a crucial Twelfth Step activity A.A.W.S. provides when it translates and distributes our Conference-approved literature. Each of us Conference members and all the members of the Fellowship should feel proud of how we are all doing in carrying on the heritage of our pioneers.

Our wonderful board chair Elaine McDowell and I had a mountaintop experience on our November 2002 visit to the African Continent. Our first stop was Cameroon, West Africa, where we joined three of our colleagues from the French General Service Structure to visit the burgeoning A.A. community in Cameroon. The Fellowship began there five years ago, when an alcoholic chief prison guard in a small rural center awoke from a drunken sleep to find a French-language A.A. pamphlet on his bedside table. He wrote to the address in Paris and was sent some complimentary literature and encouraged to work with other alcoholics. Being a desperate yet resourceful fellow, our friend Donatien started a meeting in his own prison where he knew that he had what you may call a captive audience. Soon after, a Loner in the capital city of Yaounde became A.A. #2 and our two pioneers were successful in establishing approximately a dozen groups and have found great support from non-A.A. professionals in Cameroon and our friends in France.

We attended the meeting in the prison and were overwhelmed by the vibrancy of the A.A. group. Close to 70 members attend the meeting and have but a few battered photocopies of pamphlets and no other literature. What they did have was hope for a better life through A.A. Once again, we had transcended a frontier—hopelessness. If there were ever a place where hopelessness would breed, this prison would be it. Instead they had heard the message and had created a community of hope. They opened the meeting with a song about how A.A. can save us from death from alcohol. We are in the process of sending literature and service material to the newly formed General Service Board in Cameroon for distribution to this and all the other groups in this country and hope that in the future their experience can help the surrounding French-speaking countries' A.A. communities to flourish, as our friends in Cameroon have.

Leaving our French and Cameroonian friends behind, Elaine



and I proceeded to South Africa where we met with their General Service Board to discuss the possibility of having a Sub-Saharan zonal meeting take place in South Africa, gathering together those African countries in that region who have active A.A. communities. We had discussed this with our friends in the UK earlier in the year and had agreed to jointly fund the cost for this initial gathering and were hoping that the South African Board would act as host. The Board there was enthusiastic and had been trying for a number of years to find a way to reach out into Africa.

One of the subjects that was discussed, and will probably be a topic of discussion at this zonal meeting, is having our literature available in indigenous African languages. Many people use English to interact with the various language groups in the region, but actually live in their native African language. The sense many have is that having the message available in their own language will better communicate that this is neither a problem nor a program that is European in nature. It is a universal problem with a solution in A.A. that is also universal. It also was mentioned that some of the languages are mostly oral and that perhaps having audio versions would be preferable. I mentioned that we have audio books of our basic texts in English, French and Spanish and we could perhaps investigate the viability of having certain translations produced in audio format. It was then pointed out that not many villages had tape decks or CD players; indeed many villages did not even have electricity. Now we are talking about *New Frontiers!*

The funny thing was that this subject had come up in our preliminary discussion with our British colleagues. Mick Wallace, chair of that board, and Greg, both being on the technological cutting edge, had discussed either battery or solar-powered mini-MP3 players loaded with an audio disc of our texts. In fact, they felt that one could be developed that could be wound up like an old-style alarm clock and deliver the necessary energy. I thought that they were very visionary, but perhaps decades ahead of the curve. Our South African friends informed me that in these villages many radios already exist which are powered by a wind-up system. I am certain that we won't be seeing them in the next few months, but am sure that if these frontiers need to be crossed we will find the resources and creativity necessary to cross whatever barrier appears; be they cultural, linguistic or technological. It is that important to our spiritual heritage that we continue the example of our founders and continue the life-saving process of *carrying the message*.

We do not need to look so far as Africa and Asia for New Frontiers. Our friends in Canada are faced with similar New Frontiers with the indigenous people in the far north. They are facing them with the same determination and creativity as our African and British friends are. In fact looking at the growing diversity in many of our states and provinces, we all have potential New Frontiers in our own backyard.

Indeed, every suffering alcoholic is still facing the age-old Frontier of isolation. I encourage all of us to recommit ourselves and our home groups toward supporting all the efforts that are going on to *carry the message*, whether across the street or across the planet. Let us all take that subway ride that Ebby took and make the call that Bill W. made from the Mayflower Hotel. *Carrying the message* is an action that all of us can take.

Bill Archer, G.S.O. staff

Warren Jepsen (Western Michigan) and Mary Alice Sanderson (Northeast Ontario) are from the same home group — Les Chenaux Group in Hessel, Michigan — a town of about 500 people.

SPONSORSHIP

Following lunch on Tuesday the session opened with three presentations, chaired by Allen Ault, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee.

Responsibilities of Sponsorship

As a member of Alcoholics Anonymous, I have had the opportunity and good fortune to have had the essential guidance of a sponsor, as well as being able to provide sponsorship to others.

The responsibility of sponsorship is an undertaking that cannot be taken lightly. This relationship is one of a "fit and match" partnership of exploration and discovery through our Three Legacies. This journey through recovery, unity, and service will take many twists and turns, as well as run the gambit of human emotions. There will be many instances when tears will be the result of this arduous journey, but there is also laughter; we are reminded of this in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (p. 26). "At this juncture, his A.A. sponsor usually laughs."

Millions have heard the familiar words "Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics and to practice these principles in all our affairs" (*Alcoholics Anonymous* p.60). This reminds us that we are to sponsor others and to dutifully "Pass it On." If this reminder is not enough to encourage the act of sponsorship, Bill relates to us why sponsorship is essential for spiritual growth. He informs us that "Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intense work with other alcoholics. It works when other activities fail" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 89).

Once they have sought each other out the dance begins. In the beginning a few expectations are usually discussed between the two as they enter the beginning phase of this interactive relationship. The responsibility of sponsorship is jointly shared in much the same manner as a tourist and tour guide. The sponsor begins by relating in a general way: what it was like, what happened, and what it is like now. It is the responsibility of the sponsor to show that the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts are an essential and indispensable guide to success in recovery.

As the journey continues, the horizon is bright as they walk together through our first legacy—Recovery. It is the Legacy of Recovery that allows us to stop killing ourselves through active alcoholism. The sponsor has the responsibility to guide the newcomer through the Twelve Steps of recovery by practicing what he is suggesting.

The responsibility of the first Legacy, sponsorship through the Steps, is much like a game of show-and-tell in reverse. The sponsor first tells the sponsee how the Steps have had a positive impact in his life and then as the two engage in Step work the showing begins.

Responsible sponsorship qualities include being able to listen, being a power of positive example, being honest with the newcomer (even though it may hurt one's feelings), and being willing to trudge the road of happy destiny with the sponsee.

Although this Step work may be gut-wrenching through fearless and moral inventories, the admitting of wrongs that have been done to others, the making of lists of those we had harmed in the past, and the making of amends, it is an essential ingredient to being able to receive the benefit of the spiritual awakening that is necessary to help others and perpetuate A.A.'s message of hope.

As time passes, the sponsor's responsibility transcends into our Legacy of Unity and practicing the Twelve Traditions. It is our Legacy of Unity that allows us to work together for the common good of Alcoholics Anonymous, and not kill each other.

Here the sponsor has the responsibility to instill the historical importance of tradition as it relates to the survivability of A.A. There are discussions on the spirituality of self-support, the necessity of anonymity for our survival, the responsibilities of a trusted servant, group autonomy, public relations, and the importance of placing principles above personalities. The responsibility of Legacy Two—sponsorship—is encapsulated exquisitely in the long form of our Twelfth Tradition. “And finally, we of Alcoholics Anonymous believe that the principle of anonymity has an immense spiritual significance. It reminds us that we are to place principles before personalities; that we are actually to practice a genuine humility. This to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us; that we shall forever live in thankful contemplation of Him who presides over us all” (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, pp.565-66).

At this point the sponsor's responsibilities are two-thirds completed; what remains is probably the most misunderstood of A.A.'s Three Legacies—our Legacy of Service. The acceptance of the responsibility of sponsorship through service has, in many cases, been discarded somewhere along the road of happy destiny. It is just such an issue that has led to the emergence and maturation of the service sponsor. Our Legacy of Service enables us to carry the A.A. message worldwide, and therefore prevents some alcoholics from killing themselves due to their active disease of alcoholism. Acting as a service sponsor takes a substantial amount of time, effort and understanding. It is this Legacy of Service that one must experience first hand. For example, it is impossible to tell others what it feels like to be on the floor of the General Service Conference.

The sponsor must have an understanding of the Concepts, the Conference Charter and especially the Warranties of the Twelfth Concept. The service sponsor will need to be responsible for relating this understanding to the sponsee. As the sponsee blossoms into a trusted servant the service sponsor is glad to be a supportive resource as the sponsee makes his way down the triangle of A.A.'s service structure.

This posture can be emotionally stressful to the sponsor as well as the sponsee. I can remember my election for delegate; as we were well entrenched in the Third Legacy Procedure and my name was being placed in the hat. I had an overwhelming sense of peace as I noticed my sponsor was a little nervous and anxious. I noticed the sense of relief that came over my sponsor's face when my name was pulled out of the hat. It was then crystal clear how much this man, who has been my sponsor for over 14 years, loved me and my ability to serve Alcoholics Anonymous.

I would like to close from an excerpt from a September 1975 Grapevine article titled “Leaders in Sober Living.” “But I do recognize that sponsorship will have to be of a different type. It will be a sponsorship that explains the program, thrives on the Steps, and succeeds through the applications of our Traditions. It will be, as it has been throughout our history, the combination of one person seeking and another furnishing answers. Sponsorship, the one-to-one idea that started with Bill and Dr. Bob.”

Thank you for the opportunity to serve, for it is through service that I remain grateful and through gratitude that I remain sober.

Miles Brookes, Maine

Working with Medical Practitioners, Other Professionals and Friends

When Warren offered me a loving invitation to speak on working with medical practitioners, I felt pulled in two directions, rather like Dr. Doolittle's two-headed animal the Pushmipullyus that could walk in two directions. Should I talk about my experience

working with medical practitioners, or about the importance of A.A. members working with medical practitioners like me.

I have no choice but to walk in two directions. First, let me share the enormous importance to me of those members of the Fellowship who were willing to share their story with me. Gently, they took me under their wing so I could learn to keep it simple.

The way it used to be for me was illustrated when I stepped over a drunk in the street and said to my department chairman, “Dr. M., we really should do something about the alcoholics in our neighborhood. We are, after all, a community mental health center.” When he replied “That's fine, George. Why don't you do something about it,” I shrunk back feeling hopeless and overwhelmed. Street drunks were incurable. After that I was careful to blend in with everyone else's posture of denial. Alcoholics don't exist.

What happened to me was that two years later, in 1970, I was invited to become the psychiatric co-director of an alcohol clinic. I only got the job because the clinic was largely staffed by counselors in recovery. When I told them I didn't know anything about alcoholism and I didn't know of any one else at Harvard Medical School who did, I got the job because they wouldn't have to take so long to retrain me. For the next 10 years my new A.A. “sponsors” took me to open meetings and gave me loving appraisals—A.A. speak for gentle butt kicking. They gave me hugs and much more important they gave me hope. For years I had working in Boston City Hospital and only saw patients who died of alcoholism. Suddenly tolerant winners surrounded me. They were not superior and in the staff meeting that I ran the staff elected me an honorary alcoholic so I would not feel such an outsider. The only time I felt so proud again was when I was nominated to be a Class A trustee. So the take-home message is a simple one and one that I hope you will take home to your areas: always tell your own doctors your story. Until you tell them, they really don't believe that recovery is possible.

Now let me walk in the other direction and tell you how I work with medical practitioners. They are a lot tougher than drunks and the recovery rate is lower. Their problem is called denial. For example, I was on a medical charitable foundation, and someone suggested we should sell our “immoral” stocks. Should we sell our tobacco stocks, we asked. It seemed a no brainer until someone asked, “Should we sell our liquor stocks too?” For two hours the board argued and argued, shedding much heat and little light. Consensus seemed impossible. Then our wise chairman cut through the palaver, “Let's vote on each question separately.” The two motions, “Sell the tobacco stocks; they are immoral” and “Keep the liquor stocks; I like my gin and tonic,” carried with strong consensus. Never mind that alcoholism takes 100,000 United States lives a year. Never mind that 50% of alcohol is sold to the 10% of the population who are problem drinkers. Alcoholism has nothing to do with medicine.

On another occasion, I was asked to give grand rounds to the medical (not the psychiatric) staff of one of the great hospitals in America. I was thrilled. Finally the doctors had abandoned that river in Africa, the one called Denial. They were going to listen. Then, they told me my topic “Why alcohol is good for your health.”

So I tried to do what I do for all medical audiences. I first spelled out the magnitude of their denial with humor. Second, I tried to counter their hopelessness with the excellent statistics on long-term recovery—recovery that came through abstinence and A.A. and not through moderation management and Librium. Third, I tried to offer them a specific plan of what to do if one of their patients asked for help with stopping drinking. The specific plan was to identify a grateful patient in their practice who was in A.A. and would at least serve as a liaison, link-

ing the willing patient to a Twelfth Step call. But of course, doctors can't do that if their grateful patients have not filled them in on their recovery through A.A. and their willingness to share their hope, strength and experience.

George Vaillant, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee

PRINCIPLES

The final presentation/discussion session of the Conference began the Thursday morning session. Dick Gallagher, Southeast regional trustee, chaired.

What Are the Principles?

I crash landed into an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous about a year before I was to surrender to the knowledge, deep in my heart, that my "social" drinking had become an obsession, an illness that I could not control or cure. It was evident to me that, in that group of seven to ten men in that little town, these people had recovered and were living productive, happy lives. Several of the members of my first home group had many years of sobriety. So, on August 14, 1983, when I introduced myself I added for the first time, "and I am an alcoholic." No lights flashed, no burning bushes, no applause (although there was a smile or two). It would be a while longer before I fully understood that I had acknowledged the problem, and was desperately seeking a solution. I did know at that one meeting a week, for one hour, I was experiencing acceptance, sanity, humor, information, guidance, tolerance, everyday lessons on how to live in my own skin, and how to live among others. All of this was done simply by listening to the stories of these new friends. I was experiencing the safety and protection afforded to a drunk by a group of fellows that are aware of the importance of our principles. I was to learn responsibility to my family, my employer, my church, and to my friends. These first friends didn't "preach" the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous, they lived them. They had been around each other so many years and sponsored each other so long that anything short of living the principles in the Steps would not have been tolerated.

A year later, a woman moved to our little town who had several years of sobriety and, reluctantly (at first), agreed to sponsor me. She was a "by the book" sponsor, and so she shared the first eight Steps with me. I knew from our first meeting that I was receiving precious spiritual, emotional and mental tools. Someone cared enough to take time out of every week and sacrificed energy and patience to help another person. Our fragile beginnings soon became a strong bond of friendship. She has moved to another state and I have had many sponsors since her, each with a special personality and each sharing more about our way of life. I have a sponsor and sponsor several women. On page 25 of the Big Book there is a paragraph that states: "*There is a solution.* Almost none of us liked the self-searching, the leveling of our pride, the confession of shortcomings which the process requires for its successful consummation. But we saw that it really worked in others, and we had come to believe in the hopelessness and futility of life as we had been living it. When, therefore, we were approached by those in whom the problem had been solved, there was nothing left for us but to pick up the simple kit of spiritual tools laid at our feet. We have found much of heaven and we have been rocketed into a fourth dimension of existence of which we had not even dreamed."

The earliest account of a one-word description of the principles, for me, came from a tape recording of a talk given by Rod L. in 1951 at the Texas State Convention. They are: Step 1 -

Honesty, Step 2 — Hope, Step 3 — Faith, Step 4 — Courage, Step 5 — Integrity, Step 6 — Willingness, Step 7 — Humility, Step 8 — Brotherly Love, Step 9 — Justice, Step 10 — Perseverance, Step 11 — Spirituality, and Step 12 — Service.

I was to learn that these principles were the end result, the gifts of following the "loving" words in the Big Book, such as, "a course of vigorous action," "strenuous effort," "review our conduct," "shape a sane and sound ideal," "we asked God," "we remembered," "we must be willing to grow toward it," "we must be willing to make amends," "we let God be the final judge," "we avoid hysterical thinking or advice," "this requires action on our part," "we search," "we discuss," "we pocket our pride and go to it," "we must lose our fear," "we are not to be the hasty and foolish martyr," "there is a long period of reconstruction ahead," "we must take the lead," "the spiritual life is not a theory. We have to live it."

And finally, "It is easy to let up on the spiritual program of action and rest on our laurels." We are headed for trouble if we do, for alcohol is a subtle foe. We are not cured of alcoholism. What we really have is a daily reprieve contingent on the maintenance of our spiritual condition. Every day is a day when we must carry the vision of God's will into all of our activities. "How can I best serve Thee? Thy will (not mine) be done."

Much has already been said about receiving strength, inspiration, and direction from Him who has all knowledge and power. If we have carefully followed directions, we have begun to sense the flow of His Spirit into us. To some extent we have become God conscious. We have begun to develop this vital sixth sense. But we must go further and that means more action.

Rita Lambert, Southwest Texas

Living the Principles, Accepting Our Differences

Since I first read the text of the Big Book, I have thought of it as being a truly prophetic writing. Despite the fact that it was written years before my birth it speaks directly to my life, my experience and my flaws, as if written by an intimate acquaintance. Due to its principle author's vision, it contains statements that describe the Fellowship as it has grown, rather than the male, white, protestant Fellowship that existed at its writing: "All sections of this country and many of its occupations are represented, as well as many political, economic, social, and religious backgrounds. We are people who normally would not mix" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 17).

We look for those who are like us; those who are the "right kind." At my first meeting, at the tender age of twenty-six, I fearfully looked from middle-aged faces to even older faces and wondered if I could really "belong." My eye caught sight of a youngish fellow with long hair and a beard. I knew it was alright to stay. You took my kind. You even took other kinds.

In 1980 I lived on the west side of Cleveland, Ohio. I had no job, no driver's license, very little money, not even a phone. As often as possible I walked to meetings. I couldn't be too choosy. Nearby there was a gay group called The Open Door. Good meeting. I couldn't help but notice that some of the men would kiss each other on the lips by way of greeting. I'd not seen that before. I heard one of the members of this group share his story at the Harbor Lights Detox. He said: "It doesn't matter who I am. It doesn't matter what I am. It doesn't matter what I've done. I have the right to sobriety."

As I heard this man's story I realized that sexual orientation was all that separated us. Much more brought us together: the pain, the fear, the powerlessness, the hope, the reliance on a higher power and the "way out on which we can absolutely

agree, and upon which we can join in brotherly and harmonious action" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 17).

There are other kinds of differences, sometimes harder to accept than differences between kinds of people—differences of opinion. I often think of a cantankerous oldtimer I knew from the beginning of my sobriety. No names necessary, those who knew her know. In some respects she was a polarizing figure. There were those who loved her and those who couldn't stand her. No one lacked an opinion.

When members would join hands for the prayer at the close of the meeting she would stand to the side. You see, they didn't hold hands when she came in during the fifties. When I was about four months sober I joined her and one of her sponsees at a diner for the meeting after the meeting. They were upset. They'd visited a meeting where the chairman was not set apart; he didn't sit at a head table or at the head of the table. This group just didn't know how to run a meeting. I pointed out that the placement of the chairman struck me as something that did not affect A.A. as a whole, and the autonomy provision of the Fourth Tradition left such matters entirely up to the group. She looked at me and said: "I hope I know as much about the program as you do when I'm sober as long as you are!" I realized then that there would never be a point to disputing with her; she would always have a quarter century on me. This I believe had a great deal to do with our relationship over the next 18 years. We never had an argument, or even a cross word. She passed out of our sight and hearing a few days after my nineteenth anniversary. She didn't drive. I had many opportunities to take her to meetings and learn a great deal. More, in fact, than from my "official" (read male) sponsors.

Sometimes her opinions seemed hopelessly out of date and just plain wrong. But then again: I've only made a "fine start." What do I know?

Joe O'Neill, *Southern New Jersey*

Is Sponsorship Fading Away?

When I was asked to make a presentation on "Is Sponsorship Fading Away?" I was taken aback by the incredible idea of little or no sponsorship in Alcoholics Anonymous. The mere notion of newcomers not having anyone who would share their experience, strength and hope to support the newcomer in their recovery would seem to me that all sober alcoholics would have lost their gratitude and/or forgotten their early times in the program. On the heels of the idea that sponsorship could fade away, my gut reaction was "I certainly hope not." It is really quite a scary idea and indicates the spiritual malady, which I possessed when I was still drinking — not caring for anyone or anything except for alcohol. To prepare for this sharing, I read Chapter 7 of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, "Working with Others," pp. 89-103; Step Twelve, pp. 106-125, from *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; and the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."

I know what sponsorship has meant to me and perhaps many of you are reflecting on what it has meant to you. I went through an intervention with my employer and was sent off to treatment where I was assigned two sponsors upon my discharge. They were fine women, but you know how we are about being told what to do. I did engage with them somewhat, but being a little rebellious I wanted to choose my own sponsor and did so. She was very kind and continually urged me to read the literature and after several months, began to ask me about doing my Fourth Step. The gift of understanding and acceptance that this lady gave me as I began to share with her, was the begin-

ning of my recovery. Through the years I have had a sponsor and, because I believe that inventory is continuous, I interact with her when more is revealed.

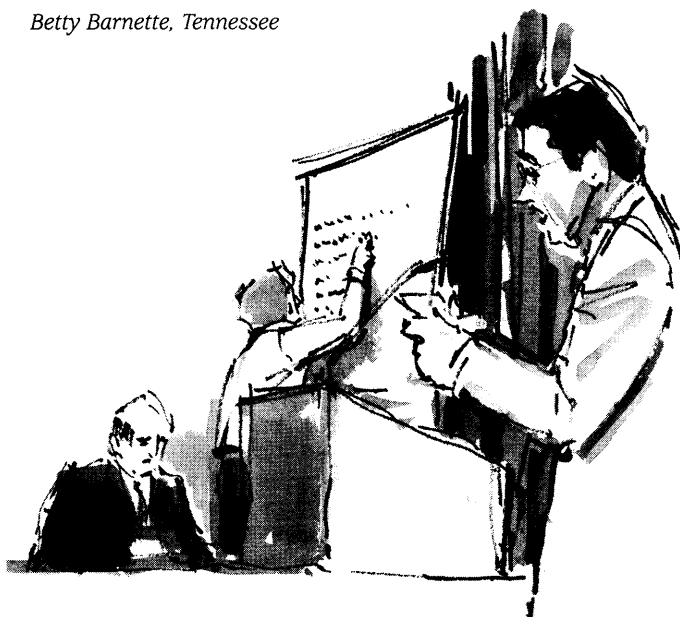
I have, over time, sponsored newcomers. Perhaps through this effort I learned the true meaning of powerlessness. Not only over my alcoholism, but also alcoholism in others. I realized through these efforts that I was responsible to the newcomer, but not responsible for them. I was to be willing to help them, but they needed to be making efforts on their own. Their reliance needed to be on the program and not on the sponsor. My life has been blessed and enriched through this work with other women, some of whom have become very dear friends. As the book says, "this is an experience you must not miss. We know you will not want to miss it. Frequent contact with newcomers and with each other is the bright spot of our lives" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 89).

There are also some very interesting things that are promised to you as you engage in the responsibility of helping others. These are listed on page 97 of *Alcoholics Anonymous* and include "the loss of many nights' sleep, great interference with your pleasure, interruptions to your business . . .," to mention a few as they relate to Twelfth Step work. In the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," the difference in "A Twelfth Step Call...may become the *beginning* of sponsorship, but by itself it is not necessarily sponsorship" (pp. 8-9). Sponsorship is the continuing interest and responsibility for helping the newcomer who is willing to be helped.

I posed the question "Is Sponsorship Fading Away?" to my group as a topic for a closed discussion meeting. The sharing presented various viewpoints, many of which involved differences in approaches of sponsors. These included sponsors who wanted daily contact to those who said, "Call me if you need me." There were several newcomers in this meeting and the information regarding sponsorship that was shared appeared to be useful. The pamphlet was also mentioned, as was the need for having them on hand. My personal observation is that sponsorship is still sought after, in both my group and in my home district.

The Third Legacy of Service embodies the need to pass on or share our spiritual awakening and the results of that experience. This thread of sponsorship is woven throughout the program of Alcoholics Anonymous and I believe we, as individuals, will continue to practice this principle or we may perish, as individuals and as a society.

Betty Barnette, *Tennessee*



Reports from the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: If I were to characterize this past year, since we last gathered for the 2002 General Service Conference, I would say that through your support, opportunities were provided to bring the A.A. message into communities where alcoholics were without hope.

Our trustees-at-large, Charlie Bartell and Alex Palmer, traveled with G.S.O. staff members to Oviedo, Spain for the 17th World Service Meeting. This week-long event was characterized by the sharing of strength, hope and experience by 41 delegates representing 29 countries or zones. As with all efforts in A.A., the primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is to seek the best way to carry the A.A. message. The general sharing sessions, committee meetings and workshops were filled with expressions of gratitude and humility as well as good humor. One delegate from Ireland announced that the A.A. service structure in Ireland had become completely self-supporting through the contributions of its members and groups. In fact, they had an abundance of Seventh Tradition funds, and it was their group conscience that some of these funds, \$50,000, be contributed to the International Literature Fund to help provide materials and translations for emerging A.A. groups and service structures around the world. This spirit of reaching out to help others truly exemplified the theme of the meeting, "The A.A. Message — A Message Without Borders." The theme for the 18th World Service Meeting, which will take place in New York in 2004, will be "One Message — Many Languages — One Fellowship."

The G.S.O. general manager, Greg Muth, and Bill Archer, the staff member on the International desk, to whom we extend our loving support as he grapples with health challenges, traveled to many countries sharing the collected experience of our office. Their travels took them to Belarus, Belgium, Bulgaria, Cambodia, China, Cuba, the Czech Republic, Estonia, France, Germany, Great Britain, Greece, Latvia, Lithuania, Mexico, New Zealand, Poland, Portugal, Russia, Slovakia, Slovene, Spain, Thailand, and Turkey.

In early November, Bill and I traveled with members of the French G.S.O. and General Service Board to Cameroon, in central Africa. We had been invited to participate in the continuing development of the A.A. service structure in that country. A moment of historic significance occurred when we witnessed the formation of the Cameroon A.A. General Service Board. There we met with a variety of national and local officials such as the steward or warden and staff of the Monatele Prison; the Cameroon Ministers of Health, Social Affairs and Justice; priests from Catholic missions; and several medical professionals. We visited government offices, health clinics, prisons, Catholic missions, and community centers, and also participated in Public Information (P.I.) and Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) meetings in urban and rural settings. We learned that there are some 200 different languages spoken in Cameroon.

From Cameroon, Bill and I flew to

Johannesburg, South Africa, where we met with the South African General Service Board and visited the General Service Office. We agreed that the South African G.S.O. will work with the G.S.O.s in Great Britain and the United States/Canada to host an African Zonal meeting in June of this year. Next, in Pretoria, we met with South African government officials, including the South African Minister of Corrections. This was a mutually satisfying meeting and, hopefully, will result in providing A.A. members easier access for bringing meetings into South African correctional facilities. The Minister of Corrections told us that this was the first time he had personally met with a nongovernmental group, and he was quite pleased with the results.

In December, I was invited to speak to a group of business and industry professionals at the 45th International Council on Alcohol and Addictions (ICAA) Conference on the Prevention and Treatment of Dependencies in Sao Paulo, Brazil. My talk was on A.A. as a resource for the professional and how, historically, A.A. has sought to cooperate with the professional community and continues to seek that cooperation today.

In September, A.A. participated in the World Forum 2002 in Montreal, a symposium attended by 2,500 professionals from around the world. Representing Alcoholics Anonymous were Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees Linda Chezem, Leonard Blumenthal, Allen Ault, George Vaillant and I, as well as Greg Muth, general manager of the General Service Office and Susan Ulseth, G.S.O. staff member. At the opening session, the chairperson of the Forum said that the Forum was the realization of a vision to work toward international cooperation between organizations and individuals in the addictions field.

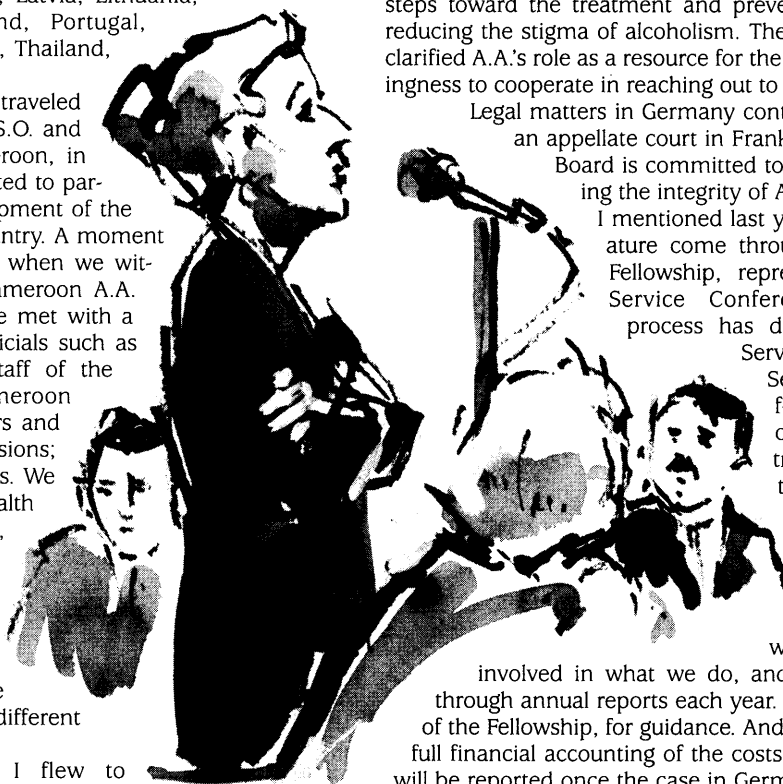
Another C.P.C. event of significance was a visit to G.S.O. and the Grapevine by the new director of the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (NIAAA), Dr. T.K. Li and his associate, Dr. Faye Calhoun. Our guests shared about the research initiatives of the NIAAA, as well as the agency's vision for further steps toward the treatment and prevention of alcoholism and reducing the stigma of alcoholism. The trustees and G.S.O. staff clarified A.A.'s role as a resource for the professional and our willingness to cooperate in reaching out to alcoholics who still suffer.

Legal matters in Germany continue to be considered by an appellate court in Frankfurt. The General Service Board is committed to the principles of protecting the integrity of A.A.'s message in print. As

I mentioned last year, changes to A.A. literature come through the guidance of the Fellowship, represented by the General Service Conference. The Conference process has delegated to the General Service Board and A.A. World

Services the responsibility for licensing boards in other countries to publish translations of A.A. literature copyrighted by A.A.W.S. No one individual in A.A. is authorized to make changes to our literature to suit a particular perspective. A wide group conscience is

involved in what we do, and we keep you informed through annual reports each year. We look to you, the voice of the Fellowship, for guidance. And as we have said before, a full financial accounting of the costs involved in legal matters will be reported once the case in Germany is resolved.



In July 2002, three new trustees were welcomed to the General Service Board — Pacific regional trustee Phyllis Halliday; Eastern Canada regional trustee Bob Pelot, and general service trustee Ron Gauthier. We have welcomed new G.S.O. staff members, Gayle Solheim Riese and Mary Clare Lynch, and, sadly, we said good-bye to Susan Ulseth, who retired last January. Shortly after this Conference, we say good-bye to our dedicated and wonderful "sweet pea" from Texas, Joanie Moncrief, who has worked at G.S.O. for 14 years.

We were delighted to welcome the chairpersons of the Conference Committees to the quarterly General Service Board meeting in February. The chairpersons attended sessions of their corresponding trustees' committees, and were invited to attend other meetings of the trustees, including the board meeting. Having the delegate chairpersons present for the February meeting has become an integral part of the sharing process that brings us together at this Conference.

The General Service Office hired a new publications director, Chris Cavanaugh, who will be present during the Conference. I hope all Conference members will take the time to meet him. Chris has tremendous in-depth experience in the book publishing field. We started Chris off with a light project load as evidenced by the thickness and weight of the Literature Committee's background material. Already the department has spruced up the traveling C.P.C. display and waded through umpteen three-ring binder samples. Chris has overseen the translation of the Big Book into Urdu, plus translations of other A.A. literature such as *Living Sober* into Greek, two pamphlets into Setswana and five items into Thai. All this in addition to another dozen or so projects keeps him busy. Chris is doing a wonderful job, and we are delighted that he is with us.

Last year a call came to G.S.O. regarding approximately 200 Sudanese immigrants living in Nebraska, many of whom were described as suffering from alcoholism. A.A. members in Area 41, Nebraska, immediately reached into this community and began helping to carry the message. "The A.A. Fact Sheet" was translated into Nuer, a prominent dialect in the Sudan and several hundred copies were sent to the area. The pamphlet, "Is A.A. For You?," in Nuer will soon be ready to distribute. This is a prime example of how your support, your area activities and your contributions help to carry the A.A. message and bring about needed translations of A.A. literature.

Financially, G.S.O. continues to be robust. Contributions to G.S.O. were 6.4% greater than last year, which continues an exciting five-year trend of growing support from members and groups. The Grapevine financial results reflected a net loss for the year of \$9,500, and a profit of \$4,358 is budgeted for 2003.

Since the 52nd Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Regina, Saskatchewan; Phoenix, Arizona; Fredericton, New Brunswick; and Huntsville, Alabama. Two Special Forums have been held — one in Chicoutimi, Quebec and a Special Hispanic Forum in Bakersfield, California. Love of A.A. was manifested at each of these Forums as was interest in finding ways to better carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic.

We often refer to numbers, such as A.A. being in more than 150 countries; A.A. literature is translated into 69 languages, etc. Those are matters for our heads to ponder, but you and I know that A.A. is about the language of the heart. I would like to share with you one of the most moving highlights of the trip to Africa. It occurred after a long, hot day of meetings. We were informed that a group of 29 A.A. members were waiting in a small, very rural village for us to have an "open" A.A. meeting with them in the local church. It was dusk by the time we arrived, and it soon became apparent that we could no longer meet in the church because of the darkness, as there was no electricity in this parish.

The pews of the church were moved outside, and under the vast African sky, with a shining moon and bright stars, members shared their stories of recovery and newcomers expressed the hope that they could stop drinking. The message without borders—the language of the heart.

Elaine McDowell, chair

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors, who are responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature. The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the last Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations; review financial reports; price new or revised publications; review publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; and the G.S.O. general manager and the staff coordinator also serve as directors. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the senior advisor to the general manager, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, information services director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and a Grapevine staff member. The board welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which considers the needs of all service assignments; Publishing, which reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance, which oversees salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

New Groups — During 2002, a net total of 1,388 new groups were registered with G.S.O.

Regional and Special Forums — Since the last Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in the following Forums. Regional Forums: Western Canada, in Regina, Saskatchewan, June 7-9; Pacific in Phoenix, Arizona, July 12-14; Eastern Canada in Fredericton, New Brunswick, September 27-29; and the Southeast in Huntsville, Alabama, November 15-17. Special Forums: A Special Forum was held in Chicoutimi, Quebec, May 25-26, 2002; and a Special Hispanic Forum was held in Bakersfield, California, January 11-12, 2003.

Visitors to G.S.O. — G.S.O. welcomed 1,700 visitors during 2002 — compared with 1,624 in 2001.

Distribution of Big Books to Correctional/Treatment Facilities Committees — 16,000 soft-cover copies of the Third Edition Big Book were made available to correctional and treatment facilities committees, at the cost of \$20.00 per case (20 books per case).

Visits by G.S.O. Office Staff to Overseas Service Structures — General Service Office staff enjoyed visits with trusted servants and A.A. members in service structures in other countries:

Europe: Greg Muth traveled to Greece to attend the 8th International Greek Convention in Ermioni, where over 400 A.A. and Al-Anon members from 22 countries participated. The following week, Greg visited with members in Turkey and the

General Service Committee and G.S.R.s from throughout that country. Bill Archer and Greg Muth traveled to York, England for a planning meeting on the possibility of a Sub-Saharan zonal meeting in 2003. Bill also met with the G.S.O. and General Service Board of Poland, in Warsaw; and attended the 15th Anniversary of A.A. in Russia, held in Moscow. Bill also attended the "All Groups" Meeting in Slovenia.

Africa: Bill Archer and Elaine McDowell traveled to Paris and met up with the chair of the Board of A.A. in France, Dr. Isabelle Sokolow; and the International staff from the French Office, Jean-Yves Moreau and Claudine Litzellmann, who accompanied them on a visit to Cameroon, West Africa. The group met with the Minister of Health of Cameroon and was also present when a Board of Trustees was formed for the fledgling Fellowship in that country. Bill and Elaine concluded their travels in South Africa, where they discussed with the South African Board the possibility of a Sub-Saharan zonal service meeting in that country in 2003.

Latin America: Bill Archer attended the Area Norte Convention in Mexico City. Greg Muth and Charles Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S., traveled to Peru to meet with the General Service Board in Lima.

Asia/Oceania: Bill Archer visited Bangkok, Thailand, and Hong Kong and attended the W.H.O./ Beijing Institute of Substance Abuse in Beijing, China.

Special International Meeting: The 17th World Service Meeting was held in Oviedo, Spain. Forty-one delegates, representing 29 countries were in attendance.

International Visitor to G.S.O.: Dr. Helga Kleinkowski, a social worker, working for the Archdiocese of Accra in Ghana, visited G.S.O. to gather information about A.A. to help the existing A.A. groups in Ghana.

Other Meetings: Throughout the year G.S.O. staff members attended: The 17th Annual Intergroup Seminar in Pittsburgh; the 12th Annual National/International Native American Indian Convention in Burbank, California; the Al-Anon Family Groups World Service Headquarters Share-a-Day; the National Drug Court Institute Focus Group (NDCI) in Alexandria, Virginia; the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) Advisory Council meeting in Bethesda, Maryland; and the World Forum Montreal 2002.

Also a day of C.P.C. sharing was held at G.S.O., hosted by General Service Board chair Elaine McDowell, with representatives from the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.), the National Council on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence (NCADD) and Smithers Drug and Alcohol Services.

Financial — New G.S.O. assistant controller, Dan DeFilippis, was hired in March 2003.

Financial Results for 2002 — A brief summary of the financial results for 2002 reflected the following: gross sales of \$10,800,000 were approximately \$1,000,000 (10%) greater than budgeted, but \$619,000 (5%) less than the year 2001. Non-A.A. sales accounted for 16% of total sales income in 2002, compared with 19% in 2001. Contributions received from groups and members of \$4,990,200 were \$301,500, or 6.4% higher than 2001 and \$196,000, or slightly more than 4% higher than our budget as well. The \$4,990,200 in contributions came from about 25,800 groups, individuals and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 45.5% of the 56,629 groups registered with G.S.O., and is just slightly higher than the previous year.

During the year, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as contributions to G.S.O., therefore total contributions of \$5,097,800 are reflected on our financial statements and include approximately \$107,500 received to help carry the message

around the world from those participating countries. Total revenue (gross profit from literature, contributions and interest) for 2002 was \$10,048,000, \$511,000 (5.4%) greater than budgeted and \$561,000 (5.3%) less than in 2001. Total operating expenses, for the 12-month period ending December 31, 2002, were \$10,165,100, approximately \$152,000 less than budgeted and only \$61,000 less than in 2001. In summary, net income for the year was \$5,000. After including the results of closing S.M.A.A., a loss of \$117,000 was realized last year.

Mid-Year 2002 Budget Adjustment — The board approved an increase in the "Contracted Services" line of G.S.O.'s 2002 budget, to allow an increase from \$292,500 to \$322,500 to cover the \$30,000 cost of the P.S.A. Tracking Project recommended by last year's Conference. This recommendation was forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review.

Approval of 2003 Budget — Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended G.S.O.'s 2003 budget to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. The budget projects \$10,443,300 in gross sales, \$4,606,400 in gross profit, \$5,125,000 in contributions, which resulted in \$9,735,900 of total revenue. Total expenses are projected at \$10,626,300 with a \$890,300 net loss budgeted for the year 2003.

Transfer of Excess Cash to Reserve Fund — At its March 2003 meeting, upon the recommendation of its Finance Committee, the board approved the transfer of \$500,000 in excess cash to the General Service Board's Reserve Fund.

Transfer of Monies to Cover General Service Board Deficit — At its March 2003 meeting, upon the recommendation of its Finance Committee, the board approved the transfer of \$1,286,191 to the General Service Board to cover its deficit.

Publications — New G.S.O. Publications director, Chris Cavanaugh, was hired in October 2002.

Unit Distribution of Books — For the year 2002, G.S.O. distributed a total of 1,855,874 book units, down 7.3% from a total of 2,002,287 in 2001. It appears this decrease was directly attributable to the high sales of the Fourth Edition Big Book in 2001. A.A. purchasers accounted for 1,534,339 units or 82.7%, while non-A.A.s accounted for 321,535, or 17.3%.

Big Book Sales — For the year 2002, we distributed 1,169,767 units, compared to 1,356,016 in 2001. Year to year, we are down 186,249 units, or 13.7%. We also processed 32,496 literature orders (cash and charge combined) and 9,765 no-charge orders.

The *Fall/Winter 2002-2003 Catalog of Conference-Approved Literature* was released and features improved format and design, as well as inclusion of items in both Spanish and English.

Recommendation to Place Fourth Edition Big Book, Alcoholics Anonymous, on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The board approved the following motion:

"A.A. World Services has determined to place the Fourth Edition of the A.A. Big Book, Alcoholics Anonymous, on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

"A.A.W.S. recognizes, however, that its action may raise important issues in relation to the A.A. Fellowship. Hence, A.A.W.S. will defer implementation of its action until after the 53rd General Service Conference in April 2003, so the General Service Conference can consider all aspects of the action.

"A.A.W.S. requests that its intent to place the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the G.S.O. Web site be placed on the Agenda of the 53rd General Service Conference for discussion by the Conference and/or action as appropriate."

Literature Pricing — The board approved pricing of the following items: Daily Reflections (large print); TV P.S.A.s (Beta SP); TV P.S.A.s (U-MATIC ¾"); "Markings on the Journey" (Video); CD of Radio P.S.A.s; Braille Big Book (Fourth Edition with Stories); The A.A. Service Manual (large print); Anthology: Experience,



Strength and Hope; Les Alcooliques Anonymes (French Big Book); De Las Tinieblas Hacia La Luz (Fourth Edition Stories in Spanish); and Spanish language parchments, "Doce Pasos," "Las Doce Tradiciones," "El Ultimo Mensaje de Bill" and "La Charia de Despedida del Dr. Bob" (to be priced according to their English language equivalents). The board also approved the production and pricing of the following special formats: The English language Twelve Concepts (short form) Window Shade was priced at \$29.00; the Spanish language Twelve Steps, Traditions, and Concepts (Short Form) Window Shades were priced at \$29.00 each. The set of Spanish language Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions Window Shades is available for \$48.00.

Pamphlets to be Translated into American Sign Language (A.S.L.) Scripts — The board approved production of A.S.L. scripts for the following pamphlets: "This Is A.A.," "Do You Think You're Different," "Understanding Anonymity" and "Information on A.A."

Other Languages — The following items were completed and priced according to our policy, i.e., English equivalent (unless provided on a complimentary basis): Greek Living Sober; Thai pamphlets, "This Is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?," "44 Questions" and "A Newcomer Asks"; "Is A.A. for You" and "This Is A.A." in Setswana (a language spoken in South Africa, also referred to as Betswana); and the Big Book in Urdu. In addition, the "A.A. Fact Sheet" in Nuer (a dialect spoken in the Sudan) was shipped.

Discontinuance of 20% Discount of Foreign Language Literature — The A.A.W.S. Board voted to discontinue the 20% discount of foreign language literature when the current inventory of catalogs has been consumed. (This discount had also been applied to the foreign language books G.S.O. purchases from overseas and this discount has been discontinued, as well.)

Standard Pricing of All Products — Beginning with the May 2003 Catalog of Conference-approved Literature, G.S.O. will price each item the same in English, French and Spanish. A.A.W.S. can expect a decrease in revenue of \$30,000–\$50,000 per year due to this change.

Change in Warehouse — In December 2002, we returned our warehousing operations to Kansas City Distribution Services since the cost of using Quebecor in Kingsport, Tennessee, was due to rise by \$80,000 annually.

Copyright Infringement — Both parties to the legal matters before the German Appellate Court filed additional briefs on January 15. The Court indicated that it may render a decision in both matters soon.

Domain Name Disputes — G.S.O. continued its efforts to inform

and encourage the proper usage of A.A. marks on the Internet and within Domain Names. We are involved on an ongoing basis in discussions/negotiations with other organizations or individuals to achieve transfer of Domain Names that are confusingly similar to A.A. marks.

New Board Officers and Directors — The board elected a slate of officers to serve through the April 2003 Conference. The board welcomed East Central regional trustee, Dorothy J. May, as a new trustee director; and new directors, Paul Cleary and Don Miller to its June 2002 meeting.

Amendments to Employees' Retirement Plan of A.A. World Services and Grapevine — The A.A.W.S. Board approved amendments to the Retirement Plan which were required either by recent legislation or by our early retirement windows. After similar approval by the Grapevine's Board of Directors, the Plan will be forwarded to the IRS for requalification.

Work Force — At year-end 2002, G.S.O. had 77 full-time positions plus four part-time/ students. Gayle Solheim Riese joined the G.S.O. staff in October 2002, and replaced Susan Ulseth, who retired in January 2003. Mary Clare Lynch joined the G.S.O. staff in March 2003, and replaces Joanie Moncrief, who plans to retire this July. Susan Ulseth was recognized for her more than 28-year tenure of service at G.S.O.

G.S.O. Computer Upgrades — In early January, the whole organization was successfully upgraded to Windows XP and the Office XP platform.

Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes Inc. (A.A. World Services' French Language Publishing Office in Montreal) — The directors of Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes (S.M.A.A.), held meetings on a quarterly basis since the last Conference, receiving reports on the operations and finances of the corporation during 2002. Effective December 31, 2002, the directors and members of S.M.A.A. voted to terminate the corporation and close the operations of the Montreal office. Three employees continued to work through mid-March 2003 in order to wind down the activities of that office. S.M.A.A. general manager, Lise Payette, will be retiring. All French literature was shipped from S.M.A.A.'s warehouse to the A.A.W.S. Canadian warehouse in mid-December 2002. G.S.O. has brought in a French-speaking temporary employee to handle order entry and customer service for our French-speaking customers, while we consider adding a permanent position.

John Koster, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: The production of the archives video, "Markings on the Journey" has been completed, and the video became available in November 2002. Our goal was to maintain the content of the original video and update, where appropriate, the content and the presentation format to a more dynamic representation of the beginning of the Fellowship and the archival efforts to protect and preserve our history. The final product has been very well-received. The video is currently available in English. French and Spanish translations are being prepared presently.

It has been almost two years since the Archives Workbook was published, and the comments received from area collections, along with the shared experience we gathered during this time, were reviewed by our committee, and numerous changes were adopted. The changes will be implemented with the 2003 reprint of the workbook.

The committee reviewed the existing photocopying policy and research permission policy at the G.S.O. Archives. As the Archives continues to assist researchers on a regular basis, our policy statements are reviewed regularly. The newly affirmed policies will be included in the 2003 reprint of the workbook.

Leonard Blumenthal, chairperson

Archivist's report: The audio preservation program continues to proceed at an excellent pace. We started the project in 2002, first preserving the most fragile reels from the Archives collection, and in 2002 we moved onto transferring some of the cassette recording to CD-ROMs. The project is expected to be completed in 2003.

Archives related information was added to the G.S.O. Web site for the first time. Besides basic information about our policies, we added the research form, the archives guidelines, and the archives service piece, all of which can be directly downloaded from the site. We will continue to expand the scope of our Web site in 2003.

Our storage facilities, both on-site and off-site, have been evaluated in 2002, in terms of size, ease of access, and expense. Additional storage was acquired at the Riverside Drive location, while we continue to explore the possibilities of moving our off-site storage closer to the G.S.O. location. The nature of daily inquiries shows that the Archives are increasingly contacted to gather material for presentations and talks at all service level. We made substantial progress in rearranging large sections in our collection, including the early pamphlets, newsletters, and other publications, the photographs and slides, and area histories collection. The folders and boxes are relabeled and comprehensive finding aids were developed for these collections for the first time.

Judit Santon, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 2002 Conference. During that period, we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the 2002 Conference, including the theme chosen for the 53rd General Service Conference, "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship."

The committee discussed a Summary of the Evaluation Questionnaires and a Summary of the Post-Conference Sharing Session. We made the following suggestions:

- That the secretary gather background information on how translations of Area Highlights presented at the Conference have

been handled in the past.

- That delegates be encouraged to include the name along with the number of the Area when introducing themselves at the Conference.

- That the Evaluation Questionnaire not be changed at this time. We agreed that the joint committee sessions should continue to be scheduled in two sessions.

In November, we agreed to forward to the trustees' Literature Committee the A.A. World Services Board's proposal that the 53rd General Service Conference consider that board's intent to place the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the G.S.O. Web site.

We reaffirmed the General Service Board's position on the matter of forming a trustees' Committee on Special Needs, which reads: "During the Executive Session on Sunday, October 28th, trustees considered an area's request that the board establish a trustees' Committee on Special Needs/Accessibilities. It was agreed that this work would be best served by the Group Services desk." In addition, the committee agreed to forward a request to form a standing Conference Committee on Special Needs to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

We reviewed and accepted the preliminary budget for the 53rd General Service Conference and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. In addition, we reviewed and approved the workshop questions for the 53rd General Service Conference for distribution in the Communications Kit to be mailed on or about January 2, 2003. We also reviewed the preliminary Agenda of the 2003 Conference and approved the schedule. All agenda items submitted to date were reviewed and forwarded each to the appropriate committee or board for consideration.

We discussed the laptop experiment and requested that the secretary include a copy of the guidelines for PC users at the General Service Conference with the invitation to all Conference members about the continuing laptop experiment. In February, the committee discussed the Conference Laptop Experiment and suggested that a subcommittee be impaneled at its July meeting in order to generate a report to be forwarded to the 2004 Conference Committee Policy/Admissions. The committee also suggested that language be added to the 2003 General Service Conference Evaluation Questionnaire requesting sharing regarding the laptop experiment.

We discussed a request from a G.S.O. staff member to have the committee initiate a discussion on adding to the G.S.O. Web site the following: A list of Preliminary and Final Conference Committee agenda items; the pamphlet, "Circles of Love and Service." We felt that further clarification of the Web site oversight and development process needed to be defined before proceeding. Therefore, the committee took no action at this time. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that a request to form a secondary General Service Conference Committee to review all aspects of G.S.O. Internet usage and to make recommendations for additions, changes and/or improvements be placed on the agenda of the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee. At the February meeting the following actions were taken:

- Finalized and approved the main Conference Agenda, including presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda Committee and approved by the 2002 Conference.
- Recommended to the General Service Board that the subject of data collecting of personal information of A.A. members who attend conventions be forwarded for consideration by the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.
- Recommended to the General Service Board that the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions consider establish-

ing an ad hoc committee of trustees, delegates and staff to outline the means and criteria for examining material submitted for Conference approval.

- Recommended to the General Service Board that a request that the trustees conduct an audit of all reported Conference Advisory Actions to ensure that they have and will be in future years reported accurately, be placed on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

- We recommended to the General Service Board that a request that the Conference examine roles and responsibility of regional trustees and determine the means of their selection which will provide substantially more input from the areas within a given region for the selection of their regional trustee, be placed on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

- We viewed favorably the suggestion that Conference Committee Agendas and background material be transmitted electronically and referred this matter to the Board of Directors of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. for consideration.

Since the 2002 General Service Conference, the committee has forwarded 55 proposed Conference agenda topics to trustees and Conference committees, to the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards. Several topics were discussed in great detail before being forwarded.

- It was with great pleasure that we welcomed the delegate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee to the January meeting. Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a wonderful Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us in Alcoholics Anonymous while "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship."

Ted Stoa, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

Created in 1951, the annual meeting of the General Service Conference became in July 1955 "...the guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetrators of the

world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Doctor Bob and Bill." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, pp. S91-S92)

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area committees for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred to a Conference committee. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable staff assistant and an in-house team of G.S.O. employees working behind the scenes to help to make the Conference week a memorable experience.

Warren Stafford

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2002 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities has met three times.

The committee's work embodies A.A.'s primary purpose, and is guided by actions of the General Service Conference and the General Service Board. Highlights of trustees' Committee meetings have been sent to area, district and other C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities chairs, in addition to current sharing that could benefit local committees.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. Articles were published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities throughout the year. This created a lot of interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

On June 11, 2002 G.S.O. and the Grapevine hosted an Open House to connect us with the staff of all 70 agencies in the building at 475 Riverside Drive.

The General Service Board chair and G.S.O.'s



general manager were among those who spoke to administrators about A.A. as a community resource, after which more than 35 employees attended the Open House on the 10th and 11th floors where refreshments and tours were offered.

World Forum Montreal 2002: September 22-27, five Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees, G.S.O.'s general manager and the staff member on the C.P.C. assignment participated in World Forum Montreal 2002. Each gave presentations and participated in four 90-minute sessions where professionals asked specific questions about A.A. Members from Southwest Quebec Area 87 hosted "open" A.A. meetings and C.P.C. Committee members staffed our professional exhibit.

International Council on Alcohol and Addictions (ICAA) Conference and Tuerk Conference: The General Service Board chair presented "A.A.: A Resource to Business and Industry" at the ICAA in Sao Paulo and Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, December 8-13, 2002. In addition, the chair gave presentations on "A.A. Anywhere and Everywhere" and "Singleness of Purpose in a Multifaceted Environment," at the Tuerk Conference on Addictions, April 10, 2003.

As liaison from A.A., the C.P.C. staff member attended three meetings of the National Institute of Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (NIAAA) in Bethesda, Maryland, three Recovery Month Planning Sessions, and a luncheon sponsored by the American Foundation for Addiction Research, held in the Rayburn Building of the House of Representatives. Other functions were a press conference in the National Press Club with the Secretary of Health and Human Services; and, a focus group meeting of the National Drug Court Institute in Alexandria, Virginia, with the incoming C.P.C. staff member. Last October, the general manager and the C.P.C. staff member attended a Day of Sharing at Al-Anon Family Group Headquarters.

On January 14th, the director of the National Institute of Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (NIAAA), the president of the National Council on Alcohol and Drug Dependence (NCADD), and the directors of Smithers' Inpatient Treatment Services and Drug and Alcohol Research met with several trustees and staff for a day of sharing at G.S.O.

Exhibits for 2002 and 2003: The committee reviewed the 2002 list of 39 exhibits as well as the exhibit evaluations. The list of 47 exhibits for 2003 was reviewed and approved. Offers to exhibit at professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions and on new geographical locations. In 2002, over 50 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees.

Steps have been taken toward the development of a new design for the traveling displays sent to local C.P.C. committees staffing those exhibits. The information will be shared with the 2003 Conference C.P.C. Committee.

Three issues of *About A.A.* were published in 2002. In accordance with a suggestion of the trustees' Committee, articles on "Singleness of Purpose" were published, including one by Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Dr. George Vaillant, which was mailed to over 10,000 recipients. Additional articles featured trips to China, the World Forum Montreal 2002, and cooperation with court programs, which also introduced Class A trustees Allen Ault and Vincent Keefe.

Treatment Facilities — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging the Gap. Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit.

Since the 2002 Conference, our committee has worked with

the Publications Department to prepare a progress report for the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities who asked us to examine options for combining the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook in a 3-ring binder format.

In late spring 2002, local Treatment Facilities Committees were given an opportunity to purchase Third Edition Big Books for \$20/case (\$1 each). Those books were sold within a few weeks, and we are assured that local committees distributed those Big Books to patients or clients in treatment programs.

Dorothy May, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet few know what A.A. is, or what we do, and fewer have been to an A.A. meeting. The staff member on the C.P.C. assignment, along with a capable assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates good communication with those outside of A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

In 2002, the C.P.C. desk responded to more than 2,000 inquiries from professionals, 1,334 of which were associated with visits to our A.A. Web site, with other requests through letters, e-mail and phone calls. Many of those same professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Other ways that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. include the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.*, and arranging for the Professional Exhibit and literature to be seen at national conferences of professionals on request. Currently, more than 15,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*, featuring articles about our singleness of purpose, information on our Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees, and our gratitude to A.A.'s professional friends. In 2002, 39 exhibits were staffed by local C.P.C. committees during national professional meetings. Another 44 invitations to local events were referred to area C.P.C. committees. In addition, G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees. Exhibits continue to be rated by local C.P.C. members as an effective tool in carrying the message to professionals, often resulting in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent a welcome letter and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in *Box 4-5-9* articles.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Gayle Solheim Riese

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office currently lists 90 area Treatment Facilities committee chairpersons, plus over 300 district and other T.F. chairpersons, as well as 21 area Bridging the Gap and 16 area hospitals and institutions (H. & I.) committee chairpersons. Each is involved in one or more facets of providing A.A. meetings and/or information in treatment settings. Some local committees are combined with Correctional Facilities, Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, or Public Information, thus serving more than one function.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees. Periodically, we share similar information with area, district and other T.F. chairs for the benefit of the committees they chair.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the Treatment Facilities Kit or Workbook, as well as A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date list of all area T.F. committee chairs so that they can share experiences and activities, and pass on contact information for newcomers exiting treatment. Correspondence from local committees is always welcomed. Some committees are invigorated through cooperation with professional staff in local facilities, often learning better ways to approach clients within the regulations established by the facility. We are especially grateful for written shared experience that may be useful for *Box 4-5-9*.

Correspondence from clients or patients in treatment centers is always welcome. Each receives a response from the staff member, along with A.A. literature. Many are referred to local committees for additional sharing. Requests from professionals in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each is sent literature, and most are put in touch with members of the Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. Committee. The staff member on this assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Joanie Moncrief

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2002 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times.

We reviewed a suggestion by the Conference Committee and agreed that the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" be included with welcome letters and other material sent to incoming area chairpersons of Correctional Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging the Gap committees. We also considered the request from the Conference Committee to distribute the newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls* to A.A. groups in Correctional Facilities, and recommended that the newsletter be mailed to all A.A. groups in Correctional Facilities.

As requested by the Conference Committee, the trustees' Committee prepared a progress report that includes the most

workable solutions for combining the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook for review by the 2003 Conference committee. The committee reviewed and forwarded a draft statement of purpose for use as an introduction to the Correctional Facilities Workbook. The General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation that the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee consider a proposal to revise the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* to add or replace stories to better reflect current experience. A request to publish a new pamphlet about "bridging the gap between prisons and A.A." was also forwarded to the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee for consideration. We also reviewed the statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose currently in our literature and suggested that the same statement be printed in the Correctional Facilities Workbook. And finally, the committee continues to discuss ways to improve the methods of carrying the message of A.A. into a variety of correctional settings.

Allen Ault, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Over 600 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Correctional Facilities committee. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet, whenever we communicate the tremendous need for CCS volunteers there have been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside.

One of the most pleasant duties of the assignment is communicating with the area and district Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap Committees. During the past year we were able to share the wonderful opportunity provided to committees, as the remaining inventory of the Third Edition Big Book was made available at \$20 per case (20 Big Books in a case). Over 50,000 Third Edition Big Books were purchased by Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees to assist in their efforts to carry the message of A.A. into Treatment and Correctional Facilities. We also shared with the committees our list/order forms for obtaining Correctional Facilities discount packages. These packages were designed to assist Correctional Facilities committees in their Twelfth Step work by providing an assortment of A.A. literature at discount prices.

And finally, welcome letters were sent to all newly elected Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap chairpersons of area, district and central office/inter-group committees. Expressions of gratitude were also sent to rotating chairpersons for their valuable service.

Julio Espallat

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2002 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a loss from operations of approximately \$750,000. Actual results for 2002 were considerably better than the proposed budget; strong sales of the Fourth Edition Big Book allowed us to just about break even. Following substantial, but anticipated, losses in 1995, 1996 and 1997, we accomplished the mandate of lowering the Reserve Fund balance. The results of 2000 and 2001 allowed us to add to the fund. At the end of 2001 the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 11 months of operating expenses; today it is about 11.2 months.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2002 were higher than in 2001, and more than anticipated for the year. This represents the fifth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year. Contributions from groups and members of \$4,990,200 were \$301,500, or 6.4% higher than 2001 and \$196,000, or slightly more than 4% higher than our budget as well. The \$4,990,200 in contributions came from about 25,800 groups, individuals and service entities. That represents 45.5% of the 56,629 groups registered with G.S.O., and is just slightly higher than the previous year. During the year, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O., therefore total contributions of \$5,097,800 are reflected on our financial statements and include approximately \$107,500 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. While contributions were up, more importantly, both the number and percent of groups contributing appear to be increasing. Two years ago we suggested that perhaps we had reached a bottom in the percent of groups who choose to support G.S.O.'s work. Let's hope that this year we are seeing a new positive trend.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$10,486,000. This was \$1,000,000, or 10% greater than budgeted, and about \$619,000, (5%) less than 2001. I'm sure that everyone knows the reason for this is the release of the fourth edition of the Big Book. Unfortunately, it is hard to estimate what the number of books sold would have been without the Fourth Edition. However, as reported last year, other titles generally showed modest increases over the prior year, which followed the year 2000 increase of 3%, or 40,700 units above the 1999 level, which was itself about 1% over 1998 levels. That means that book sales, as measured in units, may have finally stabilized after declining for approximately ten years. It is interesting to note that in terms of dollars, pamphlet sales report almost a 9% increase; this would appear to mean an increased use of this form of literature. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were greater than budget, as were sales. As a result of Fourth Edition sales, gross profit of \$4,942,000 was \$200,000 more than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$10,048,000, some \$511,000, or 5% greater than originally budgeted.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2002 were \$10,165,000. This was \$152,000 less than budget, and \$61,000, less than the previous year as well. Therefore, compared to the budget, the increase in revenues augmented by the decreased expenses resulted in an operating loss of \$117,000 for the year, a substantial improvement from the budgeted loss of \$780,450. It should be noted that these figures reflect the combined results of G.S.O. New York and the SMAA Office in Montreal. Effective

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2003¹

	Groups	Members
United States	51,537	1,168,990
Canada	<u>4,903</u>	<u>96,100</u>
Sub-Total	56,440	1,265,090
Correctional facilities ²	2,566	66,942
Internationalists		74
Lone members		<u>214</u>
Total	59,006	1,332,320
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>44,762</u>	<u>760,140</u>
Grand Total	103,768	2,092,460

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 54 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figures.

January 1, 2003 the SMAA office was closed and the French - speaking A.A. members are being serviced from G.S.O. in New York. The loss of \$117,000 reported for the year includes those SMAA operations for 2002, as well as estimates properly recorded for the discontinued operations. Absent these SMAA costs, G.S.O. activities just about broke even for 2002.

In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We had accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. At December 2000, (before transfers) it was just about 9.9 months, perhaps a comfortable level. At the end of 2001 the balance was about 11 months and at the end of 2002 about 11.2 months after the anticipated \$500,000 transfer in 2003.

At \$10,827,000, (the adjusted balance used for the calculation) the Reserve Fund amounts to \$191 per listed A.A. group. To give perspective to this number, contributions per group averaged about \$88 for the 56,629 groups registered, while expenses to support services to those groups averaged \$127 per group.

Turning to 2003, the G.S.O. budget, after taking into account an estimate for sales of the "Anthology," and a leveling off of sales of the fourth edition, assumes relatively flat unit sales of books and booklets. In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget also includes a 2% increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately a 4.5% increase in costs when compared with 2002 actual, but only a 3% increase when compared with the 2002 budget. This follows a smaller than usual increase from 2001 to 2002, which itself followed a larger than usual increase in operating expenses from 2000 to 2001. Based on these primary assumptions — a reduction in dollar sales; a 2.0% increase in contributions; a 4.5% increase in total

operating expenses — the projection for 2003 is for an excess of expense over revenue of \$890,300, which compares with the 2002 budgeted loss of \$780,450.

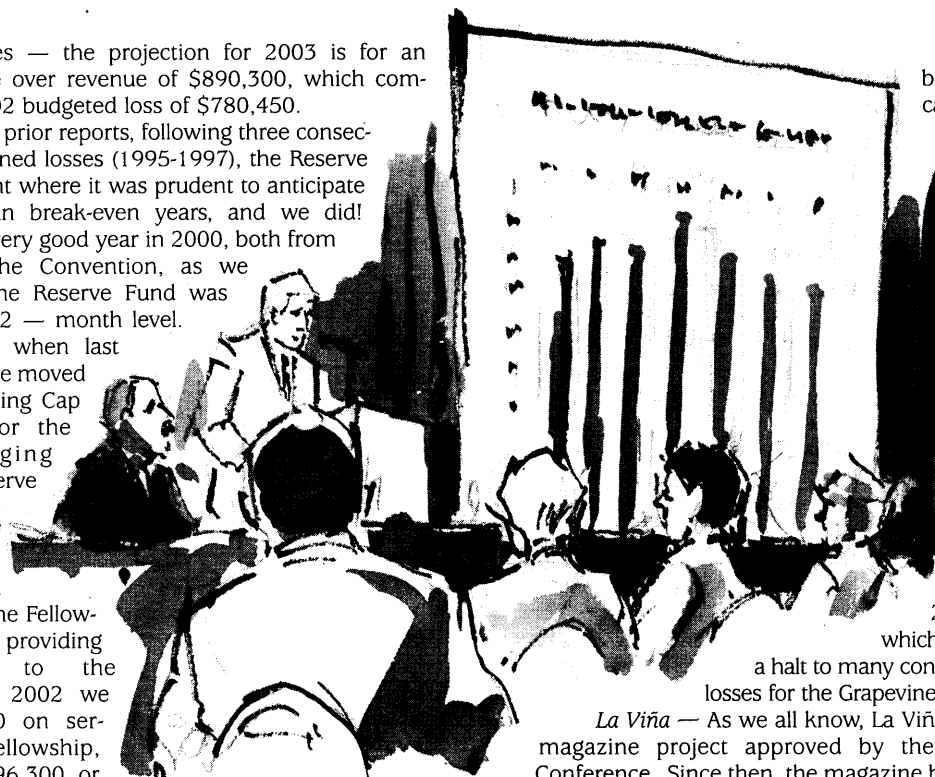
As mentioned in prior reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund was at a point where it was prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we did! Then, following a very good year in 2000, both from operations and the Convention, as we noted last year, the Reserve Fund was approaching the 12 — month level. We were grateful when last year the Conference moved forward the "Floating Cap plan" allowing for the orderly "managing down" of the Reserve Fund. We are seeing the results of that action.

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2002 we spent \$7,182,000 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$496,300, or 7% more than the \$6,685,690 spent in 2001. This compares with \$6,143,300 spent in 2000, \$5,876,500 spent in 1999, \$5,867,700 in 1998 and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 71% of this and 29% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 70% and 30% in 2001 and 73% and 27% for 2000.)

Services spending amounted to \$127 per listed A.A. group, up \$9 from last year, while contributions were about \$88 per group, up \$5. The 2002 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 35.1% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.7%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 11.2%; Trustees' and Directors' activities, 6.3%; Regional Forums, 7.0%; Archives, 8.7%; C.P.C., 5.8%; Spanish Services, 1.8%; Public Information, 4.8%; Correctional Facilities, 3.3%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.8%.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with last year, as was circulation. Average circulation during 2002 was 115,753 compared with 115,000 in 2001 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,066,800, which was \$38,200 more than last year and \$57,000 more than budget as well. Revenue of Other Items was \$26,400, more than budgeted, and \$105,800 more than last year. Gross profit on Other Items, was approximately \$7,000 less than budgeted but \$97,000 more than 2001. The major reasons for the increase from the prior year was sales of new CDs and The Language of the Heart/Big Book package. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,477,000, approximately \$119,000 more than last year and \$37,000 more than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,486,500. This is \$32,000 more than last year and \$47,000 more than budget. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a small loss from operations (excluding SMAA) of \$9,500, compared with the \$96,000 loss last year.



The Grapevine's 2003 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a \$3,000 increase in magazine subscription income to \$1,757,800, compared with 2002, a decrease in magazine direct costs of \$106,000, and a gross profit of \$1,179,600. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$47,000, while interest income should be somewhat less. This break-even projection for 2003 compares favorably with the 2002 budget of \$188 and the actual 2002 loss of only \$9,500, which goes a long way in putting

a halt to many consecutive years of operating losses for the Grapevine.

La Viña — As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2002 average circulation of close to 9,000, (up slightly from 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, but not significantly higher than 8,400 in 1997). La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past six and one-half years. During 2002, subscription income was \$70,084 and direct costs of publishing were \$59,247, resulting in a \$10,837 gross profit. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$114,653. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project for the year was \$103,800.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2003, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to increase approximately \$22,000 to \$125,800 and circulation is projected to increase slightly to around 9,500 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$668,118 has been invested in La Viña, and, in 2001 the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense.

In summary, the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition, the outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer

The Small World of A.A.

Ruth Barth (Virginia) and Ted Stoa's (West Central regional trustee) paths had crossed prior to the Conference. Ted's father was Ruth's 12th grade math teacher, and Ruth's mother regularly babysat for the Stoa kids.

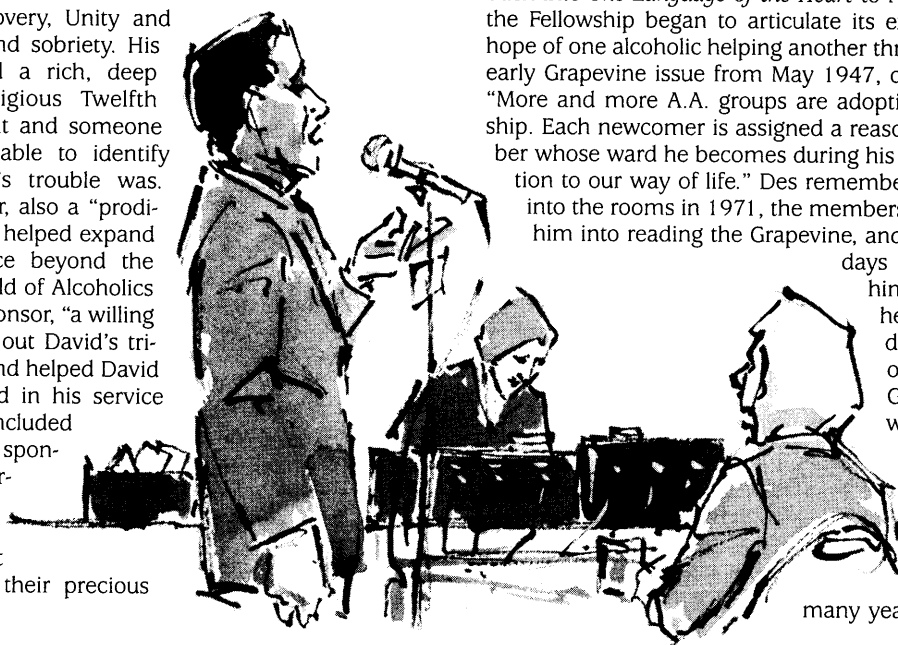
GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 53rd General Service Conference, the board held three General Sharing Sessions. The topic of the July 2002 session was "Sponsorship — Sharing the Gift of Our Legacies." The November topic was "A Vision For Our Future: Where Are We Going?" In February 2003, the session focused on "A.A. Literature Does Twelfth Step Work."

July 2002 — Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Bob Miller focused his presentation on sharing A.A.'s Three Legacies from the perspective of the nonalcoholic. Bob used the concept of "community," "the oneness with others that springs from shared vision, shared goals, shared memory and shared hope." He touched on the need of human beings to have a relationship of "mutuality" within community. "In relationships of mutuality, we give by getting and get by giving," he said. He noted that this was the main discovery that Bill W. made in his first meeting with Dr. Bob: "...this mutual give-and-take is at the very heart of all of A.A.'s Twelfth Step work today" (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 70). Bob also noted that community is created when people seek the same spiritual reality. It takes two, he said, "the meeting between the novice and the experienced practitioner is essential. The process of identification is transmitted from person to person. The disciple approaches the master and says, 'Teach me' and the teacher replies, 'Come, follow me.' The 'following' is identification, and like love, it involves a kind of fusion of the knower with the known."

G.S.O. staff member Joanie Moncrief shared about her experience as an individual member with her sponsors and her reluctance to ask for help when she first came into A.A. Her sponsor guided Joanie in her early sobriety. Through her second sponsor's "example and devotion to A.A.," Joanie learned about the Fellowship, and accepted sponsorship as basic to sobriety. In her experience in general service and at G.S.O., Joanie found "folks whose presence and strength of character" made lasting impressions on her. She concluded by saying, "I believe my best days as an employee are rooted in the gifts of sobriety and sponsorship, a balance of giving and receiving."

General service trustee David Every focused on "Sponsorship — Sharing the Gift of Our Legacies in the A.A. Service Structure and in A.A. as a Whole." He described the three sponsors he has had, each adding a layered element of the Three Legacies — Recovery, Unity and Service— to his life and sobriety. His first sponsor provided a rich, deep example of a "prodigious Twelfth Stepper," group servant and someone who always seemed able to identify with whatever David's trouble was. David's service sponsor, also a "prodigious Twelfth Stepper," helped expand David's A.A. experience beyond the group to the wider world of Alcoholics Anonymous. A third sponsor, "a willing past trustee," rounded out David's triumvirate of sponsors and helped David through a tough period in his service experience. David concluded by thanking his three sponsors and his other "informal sponsors" for "the gift of their example and the incredible gift of so many hours of their precious time."



November 2002 — Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Leonard Blumenthal described his perspective as that of an outsider looking in. He focused his presentation on several challenges that he senses A.A. faces in the future connected to the Traditions: singleness of purpose; nonaffiliation; refraining from expressing opinions on outside issues; anonymity; and attraction vs. promotion. He expressed confidence that these challenges "will be addressed within our Three Legacies based on the Steps, Traditions and Concepts." He concluded, "we will explore and perfect new ways of sponsoring individuals, groups and resources to extend A.A. geographically and culturally."

East Central regional trustee Dorothy May opened by stating, "We are moving forward into a bright future if we each take on the responsibility to ensure that sponsorship within the groups, the districts, the areas, and country-to-country is strong. Alcoholics Anonymous has a bright future and direction through sponsorship. Why? Because sponsorship is an integral part of the A.A. program. Alcoholics Anonymous began with sponsorship." She shared how sponsorship works, one on one, within groups, at the district, area and international levels. She concluded with the observation that "By each member taking responsibility and sharing their experience, strength and hope with the newcomer our future will be secure."

Retiring G.S.O. staff member, Susan Ulseth, observed that, "If sponsorship continues, our future looks rosy." She noted that the A.A. Fellowship is growing rapidly and there is definitely a need to find a sponsor in the beginning to help the new member, and sponsors are needed for the middle member and oldtimer, too. She emphasized that each individual member in A.A. is important and needs love, a good sponsor, a good group and some spiritual strength. All professionals who deal with alcoholics need the same — a good sponsor and some spiritual strength. Susan continued, "What A.A. does do is transform lives. At some point, what is expected from us is that we do more than carry the message of A.A., we become effective citizens of the community. And as Dr. Bob said to Bill just before his serious operation, 'Remember, Bill, let's not louse this thing up. Let's keep it simple!' If we continue to do that, we will continue to be going in the right direction."

February 2003 — Des Towey, executive editor of the Grapevine, focused his topic on "Grapevine and Sponsorship." Des reached back into *The Language of the Heart* to A.A.'s pioneering days as the Fellowship began to articulate its experience, strength and hope of one alcoholic helping another through sponsorship. In an early Grapevine issue from May 1947, co-founder Bill W. wrote, "More and more A.A. groups are adopting the idea of sponsorship. Each newcomer is assigned a reasonably stable A.A. member whose ward he becomes during his brief period of introduction to our way of life." Des remembered that when he came into the rooms in 1971, the members of his group sponsored him into reading the Grapevine, and with only three or four

days of sobriety, they made him the Grapevine rep. It helped him not drink a day at a time. So early on, Des said, "The Grapevine became my way of getting sober."

Referring to a May 1986 issue of the Grapevine, Des related the story in an article about an oldtimer who had many years of sobriety. Although

this member no longer considered himself a bleeding deacon, he was very concerned by the invasion of younger people into A.A., many of whom were dually addicted. As things happen in A.A., this oldtimer ended up sponsoring a sixteen year old just out of treatment, who had been told by his counselors to get a sponsor. The oldtimer went on to say, "...it's been a learning experience for both of us. It's up to us to see that they [newcomers] get active, that they contribute, and it's up to us oldtimers to provide the guidance they need." Des concluded by observing that in A.A., as far as sponsorship goes, "...there is somebody for everybody. The magic of sponsorship is one drunk talking to another."

The next presenter, Madeleine Parmley, delegate chair of the Conference Literature Committee, shared on the topic, "A.A. Literature — Helping Sponsor the Newcomer." She observed that A.A. literature continues to adhere to the original purpose of the first published piece of literature, the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. This message reaches "...over barriers and borders" that word-of-mouth alone would never be able to cross if the program of A.A. were not in print. Her first sponsor described to her that a sponsor's job was to guide and direct the newcomer "...in working the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, and that the program of Alcoholics Anonymous was found in our basic text, the Big Book." She shared that her sponsors have always used A.A. literature to guide her. Madeleine told of when she carried a meeting into a local woman's prison she always took nine specific A.A. pamphlets with her to give to the inmates. "These pamphlets would become the inmates' survival kit," she said. The pamphlet represented a "sponsor in print" for these women. Madeleine concluded by sharing about a woman she met on a Twelfth Step call, who still is struggling to get sober. Madeleine had given her a copy of the Fourth Edition Big Book she had just received. The woman still calls and still reads her precious Big Book. "She has the best," Madeleine observed, "...an undistorted, adequate record of what A.A. is, what it believes and how it works. It is there rain or shine, day or night, drunk or sober. It never gets tired or weary. It just reaches out to the alcoholic in need."

Chris Cavanaugh, the publications director at G.S.O., focused his presentation on, "A.A. Literature — Carrying the Message Around the World." Prior to providing snapshots of how A.A. World Services helps spread A.A.'s message around the world, Chris shared about the importance of A.A. literature in his early sobriety. He recalled when he first came in that the concept of a Higher Power and praying were tough ideas to grasp. He had already begun to read the Big Book and, with the encouragement of his sponsor, the principles in the chapters *More About Alcoholism* and *We Agnostics* lead him to the deep realization that there was a power greater than himself. In describing how the A.A. message is carried around the world, he noted that in the A.A. literature, "...our message comes across gently, yet with authority, and rebels like me (and many of you, too) can come to our own understanding of the message." He reported that A.A. literature is published in 69 languages and that the Big Book is published in 40 countries. There are currently 15 translation projects underway at the G.S.O. Publications Department. Chris noted that when it came to translations there had to be a certain amount of flexibility because "...there are cultural differences, language differences, literacy differences that influence a decision on the best way to translate our literature so it will help the most people. It can be complicated." Chris concluded by stating that in addition to continuing to spread the message with literature to new people in new countries, we can look to the future in making our message accessible on the Internet, updating the look of our books and pamphlets every five years so that "even oldtimers at meetings will have a renewed interest," and making

sure our message is available to those with special needs. "Our goals should be to make the message as easy to get as possible for everyone who needs it," he said.

Ron Gauthier, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: To better serve and assist groups, the Group Services coordinator provides information and shared experience not found in Conference-approved literature. When a need is indicated G.S.O. provides service material, such as: New Group Forms; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material, as well as a catalog for Special Needs. A multiple-page list describes the service items. The staff member on the Group Services desk oversees the production of these information pieces and the Group Handbooks, G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits. G.S.O. continues to work toward providing services in the three major languages of North America — English, French and Spanish. Current ongoing projects involving Service Material:

- Involved with coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.
- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops. It is available in Spanish and French whenever possible.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, G.S.R., and D.C.M. Kits, and material for Special Needs.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the 18th Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in San Diego, California, September 2003.

Currently all correspondence in Spanish from the U.S./Canada comes to the Group Services desk, with the exception of corrections correspondence. There are approximately 1,680 Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S. and Canada. The Group Services staff member assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been formed in area service structures, and continue to grow. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter and is currently G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site liaison.

Eva Sanchez

INTERNATIONAL/ WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal service meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting (WSM) — The 17th World Service Meeting was held October 6-10 in Oviedo, Spain, with the theme "The A.A. Message — A Message Without Borders." Over

41 delegates representing 29 countries or zones. Charles Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S., was the first-term delegate and Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada second-term delegate representing our General Service Board. Greg Muth presiding at the event; Bill Archer was the WSM coordinator. Other staff members who served as secretaries to WSM committees were Adrienne Brown, Valerie O'Neill and Doug Richardson. John Kirwin was the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities.

Literature Assistance — The 2003 Literature Assistance budget of \$300,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. If no structure exists, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Since the last Conference our Big Book has been translated into Urdu; our basic text is now in 48 languages. A wallet card (containing the Preamble, Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and "I am Responsible" Statement) has been translated into Simplified Chinese, *Living Sober* is now in Greek, and the A.A. Fact Sheet has been translated into Nuer. "This is A.A." and "Is A.A. For You?" are now in Setswana. The following pamphlets have been translated into Thai: "This is A.A.," "44 Questions," "Is A.A. For You?," "A Newcomer Asks," and the Information Sheet on A.A.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits or regional assemblies or events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Cameroon, France, Greece, South Africa, New Zealand, Dominican Republic, Japan, Portugal, Spain, Thailand, Australia, Turkey, Mexico, Great Britain, Poland, Russia, Hong Kong, China and Slovenia.

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the International A.A. community and General Service boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Alex Palmer, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 54 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and, with the help of outside translators, it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. The International desk is also responsible for communication with all Spanish-speaking structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the International desk is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and the services of our G.S.O. Spanish translators. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new General Service or Information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 48 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting and the European Service Meeting. Our two trustees-at-large are our delegates to the REDELA (Meeting of the Americas).

Bill Archer

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Convention — The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. Ultimately the committee acts and makes recommendations in order to affect broad purposes of the General Service Board, as those purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well planned International Conventions.

We considered 25 final theme suggestions out of the 297 submitted for the 2005 Convention and recommended that the theme for the 2005 International Convention be "I Am Responsible." Announcement of this theme appeared in the October/November 2002 issue of *Box* 4-5-9. The theme selected will support the objectives of this International Convention: 1) To provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A. 2) To enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world. 3) To let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee adopted the following policy regarding vendors of goods and services at the 2005 International Convention:

"During the 2005 International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous from June 30-July 3rd in Toronto only those purveyors of goods and services that are part of or under contract to the Convention Management will be permitted to

operate on any of the facilities or grounds that are assigned to or under contract to Convention Management.”

The staff coordinator for this event reported to the committee that the General Service Office continues to wait for the final simplified version of a new Canadian law that will positively affect the accessibility of some members with D.U.I.s and certain felonies occurring ten years or more ago into Canada. It was suggested by a Canadian immigration official that, given heightened global security, it might be helpful for members of the Fellowship to secure a passport to help with immigration and security screening if they are planning to attend the 2005 International Convention in Toronto. A passport is not required for U.S. citizens to enter Canada but could be helpful.

The committee reviewed the service piece, “Frequently Asked Questions About the 2005 International Convention and Travel to Canada” (this piece is accessible on the G.S.O. A.A. Web site). As the process of paperwork for admissibility to Canada for some members with past legal or court histories could take up to a year or more, language was added to the FAQ that suggests beginning this process as soon as possible.

Don Meurer, G.S.O. Controller, gave a brief report on the 2005 International Budget Process. The final budget will be submitted to the committee in 2004. The committee recommended that the “I Am Responsible” design for the 2005 International Convention logo be accepted pending determination that this design does not infringe on any other mark. We discussed favorably inviting 21 non-A.A. speakers to participate in the 2005 International Convention program at A.A.’s expense and will seek approval from the 2003 General Service Conference to continue this custom. The committee reviewed and accepted the following broad categories for the 2005 International Convention: Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings, Marathons, Mini-Marathons, Special Interest Meetings, Special Needs Meetings and Special Language Meetings.

The committee reviewed the City Convention Bureau Bid Questionnaires submitted for site selection of the 2015 International Convention and recommended to the General Service Board that the under noted ten (10) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be forwarded to the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums for consideration as possible sites for the International Convention in 2015: Atlanta, Cleveland, Detroit, Honolulu, Indianapolis, Los Angeles, Montreal, Seattle, Vancouver and Washington, D.C.

Regional Forums — Since the last General Service Conference, the following regions have held Forums: Pacific, Southeast, Western and Eastern Canada. All were well attended by enthusiastic members interested in service. A Special Forum was held in Chicoutimi, Quebec and many of our French-speaking members were attending their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. Also, a Special “Hispanic” Forum was held in Bakersfield, California, and it was a wonderful weekend of sharing.

The committee discussed ways of improving Regional and Special Forums and suggestions included:

- Continue Power Point Presentations, “Early Bird” Newsletter and Full Forum Workshops. (The effectiveness of Full Forum Workshops depends on the presentations and the information provided.)
- Have more time for sharing from attendees.
- Explore having more Forums, smaller in size.
- Track “topical” items at Forums and speak to issues through panels or workshops, e.g., “Rituals in A.A.” and “Should We Go Easy on the God Stuff?”
- Consider wider distribution of Forum Ask-It-Basket questions and an article in Box 4-5-9 from the point of view of an attendee.

- Utilize the directors and trustees more at Regional Forums re: Ask-It-Basket and sharing sessions.
- Continue gathering presentation topics, workshop suggestions and ideas that reflect the interests and concerns of A.A. members in a specific region.

We discussed a report from the subcommittee that was created to discuss the concept of Special Forums and their purpose in meeting the needs of the Fellowship and improving communication. Based on the suggestions in the subcommittee report, in order to facilitate the scheduling of Special Forums equitably throughout the U.S. and Canada, the committee agreed to the following:

- Consider requests for Special Forums when there is an expressed need based on culture, language or geography.
- If needed, a region may request a Special Forum every two years and, preferably, not in the same year as their Regional Forum.
- Requests for Special Forums be submitted to the regional trustees for discussion at the regional luncheons that are held at the General Service Conference (the deadline for all special requests is at noon on the day of the regional luncheons).
- Regional trustees forward Special Forum requests to the trustees’ Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums for their consideration at the July/August meeting.
- The Regional Forum coordinator includes the above-mentioned information in the annual letter mailed each February to regional trustees and delegates.

The chairperson asked the subcommittee to continue their exploration of the relationship between Special and Regional Forums and prepare a final report for discussion at the August 2, 2003 committee meeting. The committee reviewed a request for a Special “Hispanic” Forum tabled at the November 2, 2002 meeting and agreed to forward the request to the Southwest regional trustee for discussion at the Regional Luncheon held during the 53rd General Service Conference in April, 2003.

The committee agreed that the Special Forum scheduled for Goose Bay, Labrador be held in June 2004 and that the Special Forum in Hawaii be extended by one day and moved to the holiday weekend January 16-19, 2004, in order to include four of the islands. The following Regional and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2004 General Service Conference:

2003		
May 17-18	Special	Smithers, British Columbia
June 20-22	Northeast	Grand Island, NY
July 18-20	East Central	Columbus, Indiana
September 5-7	West Central	Minot, North Dakota
October 3-5	Southwest	Kansas City, Missouri
2004		
January 16-19	Special	Hawaii
February 27-29	Western Canada	Grand Prairie, Alberta

Beth Rabren, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Conventions — This assignment involves coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up the A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. These Conventions provide a wonderful opportunity for individual A.A. members to serve, celebrate and share sobriety. Very preliminary plans are already underway for the International

Convention in 2005 to be held June 30-July 3 in Toronto, Ontario, Canada. Preparations and logistics are being studied to plan for three stadium meetings, celebratory dances, a blockbuster block party, approximately 250 workshops, panels, regional meetings, topic meetings, marathons and special language meetings, all of which will require about 1,000 speakers and moderators. Research has started regarding procedures for housing and registration, which will be coupled with advanced computer technology and will offer other opportunities to utilize the Internet as a significant communications tool.

The International Convention coordinator was responsible for gathering approximately 300 theme suggestions submitted for the 2005 International Convention. The coordinator worked with the 2005 Convention consultant and an outside design firm to select and develop the logo for the 2005 International Convention, which was approved by the trustees' committee. Consistent planning and preparation continues so that the 2005 Convention, hopefully, will provide the same experience that A.A. members found in past Internationals — a milestone A.A. event filled with gratitude and the language of the heart in a welcoming, friendly A.A. setting.

Doug Richardson

Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" Newsletter at each Forum and a Final Report of the Forum to all who attend.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact, tailoring each agenda to local needs.

The staff member on A.A. Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and, currently co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Adrienne Brown

Gene Davis (Washington State East) was in an elevator with two other Conference members when a few occupants looked at the delegates' badges and wondered if they were in the wrong elevator. They asked "what organization?" and when told it was A.A., they responded, "Now we *know* we are in the wrong elevator." and zipped off at the next stop.

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2002 General Service Conference.

Projects For the Past Year:

Experience, Strength and Hope — The committee reviewed and accepted the final anthology Preface, story Introductions and book jacket copy prepared by G.S.O.'s Publications Department. The committee and the General Service Board accepted the Publications Department's recommended subtitle, "Stories from the First Three Editions of Alcoholics Anonymous."

Proposed update of "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet — A subcommittee was created in response to the 2002 Conference Advisory Action "An updated draft copy of the 'A.A. and the Armed Services' pamphlet be developed to include current experience of A.A. members in the Armed Services..." A request for story submissions was mailed to all Conference members in May and August 2002. A story solicitation letter was also sent to international Armed Services groups in July 2002. Twenty stories were received for consideration by this subcommittee.

The subcommittee agreed to follow the precedent of the Fourth Edition Big Book subcommittee by using the following story selection criteria defined by our co-founder, Bill W.: "The audience for the book is people who are coming to Alcoholics Anonymous now. Those who are here have already heard our stories. We are looking for straight personal narratives which describe the drinking history, how the newcomer arrived in Alcoholics Anonymous, how A.A. affected him, and what A.A. has since accomplished for him."

The subcommittee agreed that these stories would express "in a general way what we used to be like, what happened, and what we are like now." The subcommittee would also follow the Fourth Edition of the Big Book subcommittee in selecting stories that had a spiritual aspect or demonstrated spiritual growth, if possible. Also, it would be ideal if stories represented all branches of the military, women, dependents, and the military experience of a wide age-range of alcoholics.

The committee accepted with gratitude the updated draft manuscript of the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet. The proposed manuscript has a total of 14 stories, seven from the current pamphlet and seven new stories. The committee unanimously agreed to forward this draft manuscript to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee for their consideration. The proposed introductory and closing text is very close to that of the current pamphlet. The Publications Department's research indicates that there will be no increase in the 45 cent cost of this pamphlet despite the increased story count from ten to fourteen.

"The A.A. Group" pamphlet — A subcommittee was created in July 2002 in response to the 2002 Conference Report and Charter Committee's request to revise the chart "Service Structure Inside the A.A. Group" on page 24 in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet. The subcommittee met twice by conference call and limited its discussions and deliberations to the section "What Trusted Servants (Officers) Do We Need?" on pages 23-28 in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet. As a result of these deliberations, the subcommittee recommended four text changes to the trustees' Literature Committee.

As the subcommittee scope was limited, the subcommittee also asked that the trustees' Literature Committee forward to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee a request for input and direction from that committee and the Fellowship regarding the possibility of a future comprehensive review of this pamphlet by the 2003 trustees' Literature Committee.

"Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General

Service Structure. Video — A subcommittee was formed in July to discuss a request to update the video “Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure.” The subcommittee met twice by conference call. There was a lengthy discussion of the content of the video based on each subcommittee member’s review of this video. There was unanimous agreement that the subcommittee members were pleasantly surprised by how well this video holds up. Comments ranged from “one of the finest videos we have ever produced” to “functions very well.” The subcommittee also reviewed distribution of this video from its introduction in June 1998 to November 2002.

The subcommittee requested that the General Service Office implement the following revisions/updates to the video: 1) Correct soundtrack so that the maximum contribution is described as \$2,000 not \$1,000. 2) Add visuals of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book. 3) Add visuals of the new Web site format.

These revisions to the video master were completed in September 2002 at a cost of \$1,450. The revised, updated video became available from G.S.O. in November 2002. Based on the subcommittee’s extensive study of the video, the committee accepted the subcommittee’s recommendation that production of a new video not be considered at this time.

Review of comic book pamphlets “What Happened to Joe” and “It Happened to Alice!” — A subcommittee was formed in July to discuss updating, revising or replacing the comic book pamphlets “Joe” and “Alice” and to discuss whether to forward a concept for new comic book pamphlets to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee. The subcommittee met four times and discussed the target audience for these pamphlets, pamphlet distribution numbers, “easy-to-read” formats and personal experiences with the pamphlets’ popularity in detoxes and rehabs.

“What Happened to Joe...” — The committee accepted the subcommittee’s recommendation to forward text revisions and updated illustrations to reflect contemporary language, clothing and hairstyles and to add ethnic and age diversity in the pamphlet “What Happened to Joe...” to the Conference Literature Committee for their consideration.

“It Happened to Alice!” — The committee accepted the subcommittee’s recommendation that the 2003 Conference Literature Committee consider replacing the pamphlet “It Happened to Alice!” with a new women’s comic book pamphlet.

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for discussion:

- Updated draft manuscript for “A.A. and the Armed Services” pamphlet.
- Updated Grapevine information text for “Your A.A. General Service Office” pamphlet.
- Revised text for “The A.A. Group” pamphlet requested by the 2002 Conference Report and Charter Committee.
- Suggested revisions to update “What Happened to Joe...” comic book pamphlet.
- Proposed new concept to replace current “It Happened to Alice!” comic book pamphlet.

David Every, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees’ and Conference Literature Committees, the literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services’

Publications Department. This year there was close collaboration and cooperation with the Publications Department on preparation of suggestions for “What Happened to Joe...” and “It Happened to Alice!” comic book pamphlets, on preparation of a suggested draft manuscript for “A.A. and the Armed Services” and on updating text in the “Your A.A. General Service Office” pamphlet.

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity, meetings, conference calls, deadlines and detailed reports. The literature coordinator served as secretary to “The A.A. Group” pamphlet and the “Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure” video subcommittees. The literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate all Literature assignment committee and subcommittee responsibilities.

In November 2002, updated Literature Committees Guidelines (shared experience) became available with new sharing regarding literature displays, translations information and an explanation of pamphlet cover design.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups asking many literature-related questions: How can I order literature? Who does translations? Who can help me with my literature order problems? Where can I send my suggestion for a new literature format? and Who can give me specific text and/or historical information from our literature? Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, Customer Service representatives, Publications staff or our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 76 area literature chairpersons, 238 district literature chairpersons and 175 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following distribution: 53,000 copies in English, 2,400 copies in French and 1,600 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. The editorial committee welcomes ideas, suggestions and sharing on service from the Fellowship so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Valerie O'Neill

LONERS/INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS (LIM)

Staff report: The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable method of sharing for about 220 Loners in 81 countries, plus 76 Internationalists, and 175 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

The correspondence service also includes 446 Loner Sponsors, who are not “Sponsors” or “Loners” in the traditional sense.

Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list more than 50 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly on shore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists, & Homers Directory* and a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*. Each LIM member receives the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication comprised of excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office. As with any directory or list distributed by G.S.O., LIM is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

Last year, with the assistance of the Group Services assignment at G.S.O., we produced a new service piece, "Loners-Internationalists Correspondence Service," to better describe this service.

In 2002, correspondence from around the world demonstrated that A.A. continued to be the basis of sobriety and our way of life. A single issue of LIM may include sharing from Australia, Belgium, Germany, England, India, Ireland, New Zealand, Peoples Republic of China, Slovenia, Taiwan, one or more countries in Africa, as well as Canada and the U.S. The letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straightforward sharing.

It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter and walk through difficult circumstances each day. The courage of these Loners, Homers and Internationalists is an inspiration that I hope to pass on.

Joanie Moncrief

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: Since the 2002 General Service Conference, the committee has met three times. At each meeting, the committee's work was guided by the principles of love, responsibility, and mutual respect. Following is a list of the committee's work:

- The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedures and made no changes.
- A search for two Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees was made and four "friends of A.A." were interviewed. The committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Herbert I. Goodman be invited to serve as a Class A trustee, replacing Linda L. Chezem, J.D., following the 2003 General Service Conference. Herb's background is in international business.

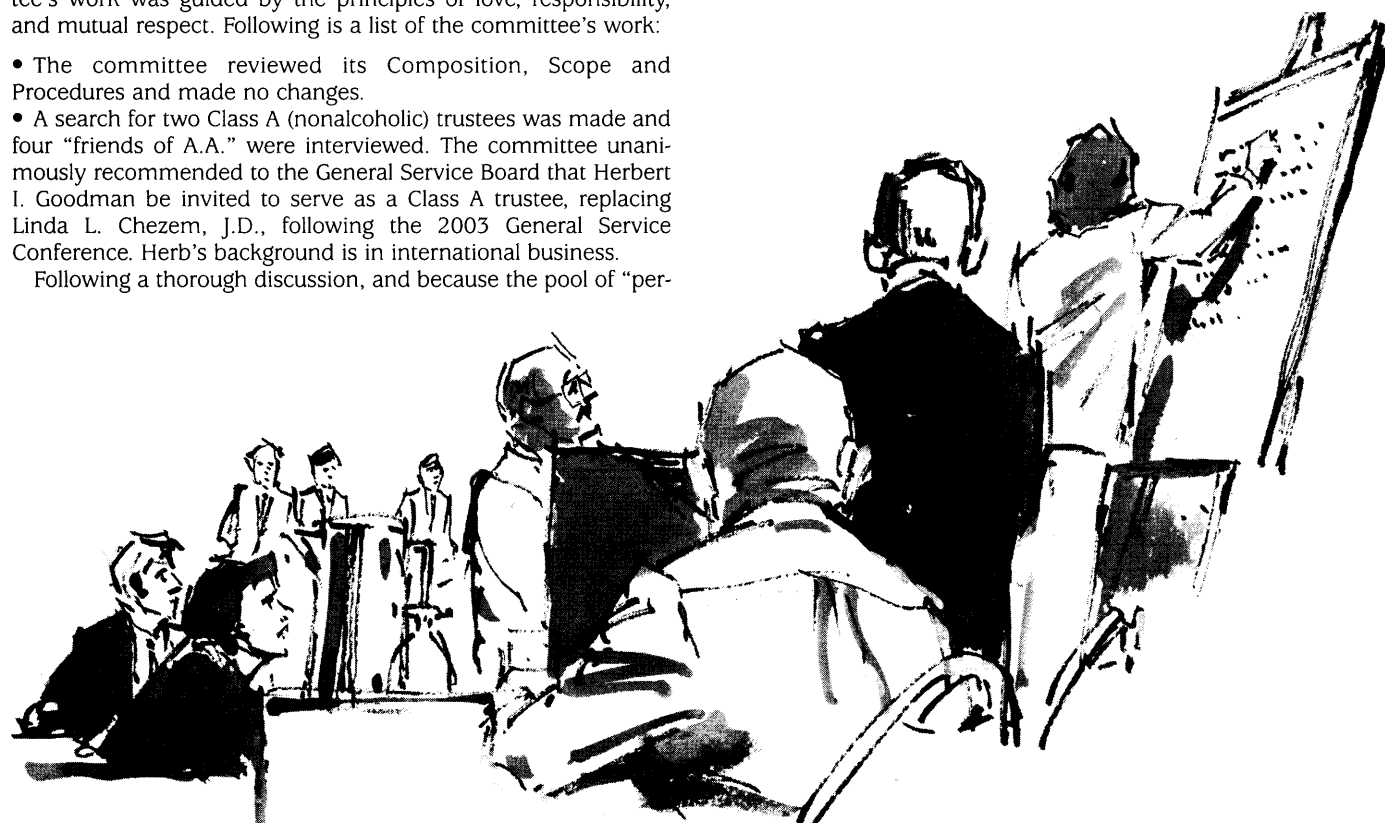
Following a thorough discussion, and because the pool of "per-

sons of faith" was reduced prior to the February 2003 board weekend, the committee agreed to continue and enlarge their search for qualified Class A trustee candidates. Although the Nominating Committee realizes the value of Class A trustees to the General Service Board, the committee unanimously decided to move forward with a slate of six Class A trustees for the 2003 Conference year. We agreed that members of the General Service Board should be made aware of the ongoing need for them to look for and encourage qualified and willing nonalcoholic "friends of A.A." to serve as Class A trustees.

- The committee reviewed and reaffirmed its policy regarding the time commitment of appointed committee members during General Service Board weekends, as follows: "Appointed committee members are expected to attend the meeting of the committee to which they are appointed and the general sharing session; they may also attend the Saturday night dinner and A.A. meeting, if they wish." (Excerpt from Nominating Procedure No. 2, reviewed July 27, 2002.)

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Corporate Board* — Robert Pelot, Eastern Canada regional trustee, replacing R.J.M. (Ric) Downey; *Grapevine Corporate Board* — Leonard M. Blumenthal, Class A trustee, replacing Robert O. Miller, Phyllis A. Halliday, Pacific regional trustee, replacing Ted Stoa; Arnold L. Ross, as a general service trustee, replacing Gregory Tobin; and John Skilton, as a director, replacing Arnold L. Ross.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 2003 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May, following presentation at the 2003 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:



Trustees of General Service Board:

Class A

Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.	Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D.	George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Herbert I. Goodman	(one vacancy)
Vincent E. Keefe	

Class B

Charles F. Bartell	John C. Koster
R.J.M. (Ric) Downey	Murray McIntosh
David V. Every	Dorothy J. May
Richard F. (Dick) Gallagher	Robert Pelot
Ronald J. Gauthier	Michael D. Perry
Phyllis Halliday	Arnold L. Ross
Gary Kluksdahl	Ted Stoa

Officers of General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Elaine McDowell
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	George E. Vaillant
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Leonard M. Blumenthal
<i>Treasurer</i>	Vincent E. Keefe
<i>Secretary</i>	Ted Stoa
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Doug Richardson*

Directors of A.A. World Services Corporate Board:

Paul Cleary	Greg Muth
Ronald J. Gauthier	Robert Pelot
John C. Koster	Doug Richardson*
Dorothy May	Jane T. Sheppard
Don Miller	

Directors of A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board:

Leonard M. Blumenthal	Arnold L. Ross
Susan Campbell	John Skilton
David V. Every	Ted Stoa
Richard F. (Dick) Gallagher	Desmond Towey
Phyllis A. Halliday	

*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation, July 2003

Tony Taschner, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the A.A. Membership Survey; carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. The committee met three times since the last Conference. Following is a list of some of our work over the past year:

- In response to the recommendation from the General Service Conference, the committee oversaw the production of a new television public service announcement (P.S.A.), which was forwarded to the 2003 Conference P.I. Committee.
- The committee was responsible for distribution of "Reach Out," the P.S.A. approved by the 2002 General Service Conference, to over 800 networks and stations around Canada and the U.S. in English, French, and Spanish.

- The committee reviewed reports on the tracking and evaluation of "Reach Out," noting that it had been played over 11,000 times in the six months from July to December 2002.
- The committee requested that the 2003 Conference P.I. Committee consider centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the public service announcement that was presented to the committee for approval.
- With the committees' guidance, a press release covering the 17th World Service Meeting was distributed for use by attendees and posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. The annual letter to the media reminding them of our Anonymity Traditions and thanking them for their cooperation was sent to over 9,000 media outlets in February 2003.
- The committee discussed the possibility of a toll-free telephone number to be included in P.S.A.s that would route the caller to the nearest intergroup/central office. The sense of the committee was that such a system is currently not a viable option, but that they will continue to explore this subject.
- The committee began a review of current prerecorded audio P.S.A.s to see if they need to be updated.
- Keeping in mind the suggestions of the 2000 Conference P.I. Committee regarding changes to the survey questions, the trustees' committee forwarded the questionnaire for the 2004 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey to the 2003 Conference P.I. Committee.

Ric Downey, chairperson

Staff report: Public Information in Alcoholics Anonymous is the attempt to share with the general public what A.A. is, what we do, and how to get in touch with us. In keeping with our Traditions, A.A. "avoids sensational advertising" and members remain anonymous in public. Our hope is that an alcoholic, or a concerned friend or relative, who hears about A.A., will know that we offer a solution to alcoholism. The Public Information assignment helps to carry the A.A. message through the media, health fairs, and schools.

The assignment provides accurate and consistent information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous. Throughout the year the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is, and what it can and cannot do.

A crucial part of Public Information work here at G.S.O. is to act as a resource and central repository of the sharing from Public Information Committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. The staff member communicates with over 700 P.I. Committee chairpeople at the area, district, and intergroup/central office level. All new Public Information chairpeople are sent a "welcome" letter and receive materials, including the P.I. Workbook and A.A. Guidelines on Public Information. Committee chairs receive a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*, which includes articles focused on P.I. Through activity updates sent two to three times a year, current P.I. information is communicated from the staff member.

During the past year, literature was provided for local health and community fairs. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with a local P.I. committee, so that there can be a local group conscience decision about how A.A. can best participate in these events. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide literature and participate. Using the P.I. Discount Package Order Form, they are able to purchase quantities of pamphlets at reduced prices. The results of the A.A. Membership Survey are useful at such events, and are available in a tabletop display as well as pamphlet format.

The P.I. desk receives information regarding anonymity breaks

at the level of press, radio, film or on the Internet. If the area is identified, this information is forwarded to the area delegate. The delegate chooses whether to respond to each anonymity break on a case-by-case basis. In the past 12 months, approximately 19 articles were forwarded to area delegates. In January, all new Conference delegates were sent a letter explaining our procedures for forwarding anonymity break information.

In 2002, the General Service Conference approved a new television public service announcement that was centrally distributed in English, French and Spanish, and also made available for committees to provide to stations. The staff member provided P.I. committees with information regarding this process in order to enhance their efforts on the local level.

The annual Anonymity Memo to Media, including a Rolodex card with a description of Alcoholics Anonymous, highlighting our Web site address, and a return postcard for those who wish additional information about A.A., was mailed in February to more than 9,500 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services. The distribution included French and English outlets in Canada and the black and Hispanic media in the US.

We responded to numerous other requests from media professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism. We referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to an appropriate source. When requested, we also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on controversial issues in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. In this instance, Alcoholics Anonymous is unique in that Public Information succeeds when we do not get media attention.

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other A.A. service: are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message of recovery gets to the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

Rick Walker

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Ten A.A. members make up the "G.S.O. Staff," with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2002, the staff received 34,130 such requests by mail, fax and e-mail (a 17% increase over 2001; a 37% increase since 2000), plus many phone calls. The staff coordinator helps to ensure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects, away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. Last year, staff participated in more than 100 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional and Special Forums, where we provided information on services available through G.S.O. and gathered shared experiences to bring back to the office to be used to benefit other groups.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further ensure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes

Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experiences of A.A. groups gathered over many years, resources that are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Ideas received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, where we focus on problems best addressed by a group conscience. Our weekly meetings also provide a forum for sharing ideas on ways to further improve services to A.A. groups and members.

Gayle Solheim Riese joined the staff in September 2002, replacing retired staff member Susan Ulseth, and plunged right into a schedule of planning exhibits on the Cooperation With the Professional Community assignment. Gayle was one of over 120 members who applied for the staff position being vacated by Susan. Criteria for applicants who want to be considered for an opening on the G.S.O. staff are: a minimum of six years sobriety, professional background, excellent verbal and writing communication skills and A.A. service experience. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff.

Each G.S.O. staff member serves as secretary to a Conference Committee and is a voting member of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

During 2002, we welcomed 1,700 visitors to G.S.O. from around the world. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator serves as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the assistance of a very capable support staff.

Doug Richardson



Literature Distributed - 2002

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (3rd Ed.)	38,752
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed)	614,270
Alcoholics Anonymous (softcover-3rd Ed.)	17,086
Alcoholics Anonymous (softcover-4th Ed)	359,251
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-3rd Ed)	1,070
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-4th Ed)	33,514
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	111,110
Daily Reflections	149,440
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	179,143
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	13,791
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (softcover)	161,131
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	16,433
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	52,733
A.A. Comes of Age	14,039
As Bill Sees It	45,152
As Bill Sees It (softcover)	31,139
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	13,791
"Pass It On"	13,287
Total	1,865,132

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	37,083
Living Sober	157,415
Came to Believe	79,600
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	22,232
Total	296,330

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	10,583
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	33,808
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	34,894
A.A. for the Native North American	18,102
A.A. for the Woman	123,706
The A.A. Group	91,721
A.A. in Your Community	51,636
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	27,470
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	28,618
The A.A. Membership Survey	42,001
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	101,454
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	31,640
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	15,153
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	114,733
Circles of Love and Service	38,671
Bridging the Gap	32,713
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	20,754
The Co-founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	19,609
Do You Think You're Different?	130,264
44 Questions	255,088
G.S.R.	48,444
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	10,591
How A.A. Members Cooperate	18,638
How It Works	71,655
If You Are a Professional	37,697
Inside A.A.	45,522
Can A.A. Help Me Too?	50,432
Is A.A. for You?	352,523
Is A.A. for Me?	100,413
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	17,710
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	99,756

It Happened to Alice	50,245
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	59,719
The Jack Alexander Article	27,192
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	14,183
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	84,216
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	53,519
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	39,465
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	11,422
A Newcomer Asks	301,926
Problems Other Than Alcohol	127,631
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	265,015
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	22,304
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	29,828
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	77,777
Twelve Tradition Flyer	8,101
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	54,812
This Is A.A.	284,998
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	22,135
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (large print)	85,596
Too Young?	85,974
Understanding Anonymity	67,840
What Happened to Joe	51,879
Young People and A.A.	124,875
Total	4,026,651

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	378,103
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	58,619
Wallet cards-Anonymity	44,135
Anonymity Display Card	3,518
Parchment-scrolls	3,331
Placards	558
C.P.C. Workbook	1,941
Archives Workbook	864
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,405
P.I. Workbook	1,860
Treatment Facilities Workbook	2,139
Treatment Facility Kit	380
Big Book on computer disk	369
Twelve and Twelve on computer disk	298
A.A. Guidelines	97,503
Group Handbook	2,653
Wire Racks	2,392
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	1446
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	3,677
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	299
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,965
TV Public Service Announcement	169
Radio Public Service Announcements	387
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,027
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,859
Fact File	2,210
Table Top Display 12 & 12	488
Pioneers of A.A. (Cassette Album)	111
Living Sober (Cassette Album)	288
Total	614,994
Grand Total	6,803,107

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous softcover)	22,752
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Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	7,907
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	13,008
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	6,146
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	4,015
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	3,553
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	4,370
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	9,310
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	15,420
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	4,020
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	23,596
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	8,446
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	8,601
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	10,833
Total	141,977

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	10,011
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	29,313
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	27,884
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	62,376
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	6,238
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	8,555
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,909
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	4,072
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	3,077
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,546
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	17,067
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	8,783
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	10,350
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	3,354
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	9,182
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	10,547
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	6,884
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	6,480
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,379
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	15,752
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	2,735
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	8,559
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	3,376
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	10,525
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	9,044
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,928

Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,379
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	5,651
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	2,297
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,420
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	9,373
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	6,671
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. (Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings)	1,630
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	9,755
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,952
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	2,029
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	12,348
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	5,299
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	6,664
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,674
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,083
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,242
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,093
Total	362,457

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	7,991
Parchments, Spanish	450
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	16,049
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	691
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	794
Total	25,975
GrandTotal	530,409

FRENCH

Livres (Books)	
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	3,981
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	1,845
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	985
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,413
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	1,011
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	1,174
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	572
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	1,878
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,887
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	713
Total	17,459

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,513
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,153
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,277
Total	4,943

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	10,351
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	2,160
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	12,255
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,582
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	185
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	1,193
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,331
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	351
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	194
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,305
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,006
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	398
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	325
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	909
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	442
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	413
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,105
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,057
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	515
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,231
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	250
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	832
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	795
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	328
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	554
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	780
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	176
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,081
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,692
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,289
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	537
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,234
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	2,288
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A.	

(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	401
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,594
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	382
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	308
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	579
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	966
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	942
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,910
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,285
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,917
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	831
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	3,699
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,145
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	345
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	3,514
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	342
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	317
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	1,337
Total	71,114

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	88
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	103
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,415
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	201
Cassettes	107
Notre Methode (How It Works)	10,993
Manuel de Groupe	63
Pochette de l'Information Publique	19
Pochette des Centres de Detention	12
Pochette de la CMP	13
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	10,567
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	9
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	350
Total	23,590
Grand Total	117,106



Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is a not-for-profit service corporation that publishes the Grapevine magazine, the Fellowship's international journal and "meeting in print," as well as books, booklets, and CDs, among other items; the Grapevine is also responsible for the publication of the Spanish-language magazine, *La Viña*, which is a project of the General Service Board. The A.A. G.V. Corporate Board met eight times since the 52nd General Service Conference.

The board held four quarterly meetings — three during General Service Board weekends. Four planning committee meetings, of a more informal nature than the quarterly meetings, were also held, at which policy and strategic issues were discussed, and one planning meeting (December) was devoted exclusively to in-depth examination of the 2003 budgets for the Grapevine and *La Viña*. The G.V. Corporate Board also held a joint dinner meeting with the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board, a body comprised of publishing, graphics, and writing professionals (all A.A. members) who share their experience, insight, and perspective concerning the editorial content, graphics, and readership of the magazine and related items.

Board Structure — There are nine Grapevine corporate directors. Currently five are trustees, including two general service trustees, two regional trustees, and one Class A (nonalcoholic); three are nontrustee directors; the executive editor also serves as a director. In May 2002 the board welcomed one new director, Richard Gallagher, Class B, Southeast regional trustee, who has served as the treasurer of the corporate board. John Skilton was nominated by the corporate board as a new nontrustee director, to replace Arnold Ross in that position after the Conference; Arnold Ross will begin a term as a general service trustee in May 2003, replacing Gregory Tobin, along with Phyllis Halliday, Class B, Pacific regional trustee, replacing Ted Stoa, and Leonard Blumenthal, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, replacing Robert Miller. All nominations are subject to General Service Conference disapproval, if any.

For the past year, on an experimental basis, the board chairman, Gregory Tobin, appointed several ad hoc committees to facilitate the Grapevine Board's ability to conduct its important business for the Fellowship. The customer service committee, chaired by Ray Massey, nontrustee director, identified problem areas and suggested solutions to management and staff in the important and sensitive area of customer relations. The *La Viña* committee, chaired by Susan Campbell, nontrustee director,

explored issues of concern regarding the publication and distribution of the Spanish-language magazine. David Every, general service trustee, chaired the digital accessibility and preservation committee, which provided guidance and background information about the ongoing project to preserve and make accessible to the Fellowship all past content of the Grapevine magazine. The finance committee was chaired by Arnold Ross, nontrustee director, with the task of supervising the budgeting process and monitoring the corporation's finances, in concert with the treasurer and the chief executive. And Susan Campbell also chaired a special committee devoted to the continuing discussion of the Grapevine Board's structure and composition.

2002 Financial Results — The Grapevine's loss on operations is \$9,529 for the year ended December 31, 2002, as against a budgeted break-even for the year. Average monthly circulation of the magazine was 115,573 for the year, which is slightly above budget. Gross subscription income was \$1,751,304 and gross profit on the magazine was \$1,066,808, which was both higher than budget and greater than the previous year. The postage pass-through, which was implemented in the third quarter of the year, accounted for a nearly \$20,000 positive variance. Other publishing income, from sales of books, tapes, new CDs, the combination offer of *The Language of the Heart* and the Big Book, as well as Grapevine calendars and pocket planners, was \$537,017, which is substantially higher than budget and previous year's sales. The gross profit in this category was \$339,496, though lower than budget, was substantially greater than last year.

Total Grapevine expenses were \$1,486,532, and total income, including cash flow and interest from the Reserve Fund of \$70,500, was \$1,477,003, which resulted in the net loss of \$9,529. Note that, among the factors in this \$9,717 negative variance from the budgeted net was a \$13,000 shortfall in interest income as against the budget, as well as lower than budgeted sales of the calendars and pocket planners.

For *La Viña*, the average monthly circulation of the six bimonthly issues was 8,999, just one copy shy of the budgeted 9,000! Overall results show a net loss of \$103,818, compared to a budgeted loss of \$114,777. The reason for this less-than-budgeted total charge for the Spanish-language magazine was containment of costs in the categories of editorial and circulation/business.

Operations — Change and progress continued at the Grapevine throughout the year. The executive editor, Desmond Towey, has



continued to refine the Grapevine's business planning, as well as office restructuring. Included in these plans were action items and deliverables that were keyed to each quarter of the year, allowing management and the corporate board to monitor progress throughout the period. The executive summary of the plans was discussed at each quarterly meeting of the board. The primary objective of the plan, which is ongoing through the year 2003, is to increase group support of the magazine through subscriptions. Current subscription support for the magazine is below the 10-15% penetration level and the Grapevine hopes to increase that level to 20-30% in the current year, with a long-term target of 50% group support of the magazine.

The governing strategy behind the objectives and tactics can be summarized as, a) to position the A.A. Grapevine as the living voice of the Alcoholics Anonymous movement and thereby an efficacious tool in the recovery process; b) to use the outreach potential of trustees, area delegates, Conference members, GvRs (Grapevine representatives), and area committees for renewed cooperation with the professional community, correctional and treatment facilities, which efforts will further increase Grapevine circulation and help carry forward the message of recovery in Alcoholics Anonymous. The executive editor has focused on aggressively reducing costs of all operations, including printing, paper purchasing, fulfillment, and internal office functions. He has worked throughout the year with the ad hoc committees of the corporate board to implement a common vision of efficiency and focused service to our Fellowship.

The Grapevine Office — The editorial, finance, Internet operations, and customer service departments have been streamlined and refocused as part of the ongoing office restructuring that was begun in 2001. A new team member was hired as office manager and administrative assistant to facilitate various functions in the office, as well as internal and external communications for the executive editor and the corporate board. The position of circulation director was eliminated and the position of controller will be brought back during the coming year. Staff meetings, customer care meetings, editorial meetings, and informal get-togethers and brainstorming sessions are held on a regular basis.

La Viña — Editor Hernán Merera continues to oversee the writing, editing, and publication of the magazine that plays a vital role in the Spanish-speaking community of the U.S. and Canada General Service Conference. He was joined this year by a new bilingual art director, Delia Planchart. The editor, in collaboration

with the GV's executive editor and other departments, is charged with helping to increase the profile of La Viña within the Conference structure, and he participates in Regional Forums and other service events by invitation. The commitment of RLVs (La Viña representatives), group members, district and area officers, delegates and trustees, in addition to the staff and board, has caused the circulation of this vital organ to flourish, and sets the stage for continued circulation growth in the current year.

Grapevine Editorial — The year 2002 saw an increase in sales of Grapevine items, through the intense efforts of the editorial department, which repackaged such titles as *The Language of the Heart* and *The Best of Bill* (first time in hardcover format) and introduced the CD format into the GV product mix. A new full-color catalogue was offered to the Fellowship last year. Editorial projects for the current year include a revised and reprinted Grapevine Workbook; a new easel-back poster for GvRs; a magazine display unit for Intergroups/Central Offices; Grapevine cover posters for IGs/COs; development of the new CD on sponsorship, and increased reportorial focus in the editorial content of the Grapevine magazine. The editorial department has outlined topics and themes for issues of the magazine from March 2003 through December 2003 and intends to work closely with the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board throughout the rest of the current year.

Charles McGovern, managing editor, and Robin Bromley, senior editor, work closely with the Grapevine art director, Ken Chaya, on each issue of the magazine and on each new or reconfigured title that the Grapevine produces. The Grapevine has enjoyed a year of exciting new features and continues to evolve in design and content. The heart and soul of GV lies in the editorial content that is created and developed by A.A. members, both inside the office and throughout the Fellowship.

Grapevine Web Site — Internet operations are an important part of the overall Grapevine operation, under the direction of Maggie Keogh. The Grapevine Web site maintained an increase in the yearly average number of visits in 2002 and an increase in the number of orders. The GrapeNet bulletin board is a tool for Grapevine representatives to share information and experience. Available downloads include the free Slogans screen saver, a subscription order form, and the cover of the current issue of the magazine. After approval of the proposed digital accessibility and preservation project by the General Service Board, the initial stage of work was accomplished the first quarter of 2003. The





total expenditure during that launch period is projected to be about \$15,000. Further efforts continue to make more GV content available online, including iSay and Rule No. 62 postings.

Mission Statement — For the past two years, the Grapevine corporate board has been mindful of its role as an affiliate service corporation of the General Service Board and its responsibility to the A.A. Fellowship as a whole in particular and pertinent ways. In all of its business activities the board incorporates the following purposes:

- To oversee the publishing operations of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts.

This mission statement was adopted by the corporate board on October 27, 2000, and amended on January 26, 2001. Later this year, the Grapevine will enter its 60th year of continuous monthly publication as a service and tool of recovery for members of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Greg Tobin, chairperson

Staff report: This year the Grapevine staff's chief goals have been to heighten awareness of the Grapevine within the Fellowship; update the content and design of the Grapevine, La Viña, and the Web site; begin creating a digital archive of all Grapevine articles, and improve service to subscribers. With these ends in mind, the executive editor developed a set of "aggressive attraction strategies," which included new Grapevine and La Viña presentations at Regional Forums and assemblies; incentives for subscribing to the Grapevine; quarterly inserts in the magazine, describing new Grapevine items and special offers; posting special offers on the Web site; updating the GvR workbook; offering *The Best of Bill* in a gift edition and *The Best of the Grapevine* and *The Language of the Heart* in softcover; and making Grapevine audiocassette cassettes available on CDs. A La Viña CD, a collection of letters to the Grapevine, and an anthology of Grapevine stories about A.A. members' spiritual journeys are currently in production. The hope is that these efforts will remind members that the Grapevine and La Viña are powerful tools of recovery and encourage them to use them in their work with hospitals, correctional facilities, and other institutions, as well as with newcomers and people with special needs in their groups.

Addressing subscriber services, the executive editor has reorganized the customer service staff and taken over direct management of circulation, fulfillment, and customer service.

Setbacks in the delivery of the magazine, occasioned in large part by the move to a new printer and mailing house, are being addressed. Delivery of the magazine is improving steadily. Every aspect of the magazine distribution process is being reviewed.

Updating the design and contents of the Grapevine is an ongoing process, aimed at attracting newcomers to the message A.A. has to offer and encouraging current members to use it to enrich their sobriety and to share their experience with others. This year, innovations in design have included bolder covers, new graphics, and a two-page table of contents highlighting a key message in each article. Editorial changes include the addition of two new features, Time for One More and A.A. in Cyberspace, more interactivity with the Web site, and more interviews. Many of these changes were made with valuable input from the Grapevine's Editorial Advisory Board, which met five times this year.

La Viña has continued to develop its own identity as our meeting in print in Spanish, with bold covers and new layouts designed to enhance the magazine's attractiveness and readability. It also has continued to be a tool for unity within the Spanish-speaking fellowship by offering articles from diverse backgrounds, geographical regions, and representing varied viewpoints, while also providing a link between the Spanish-speaking communities and the English-speaking Fellowship through its close association and mutual sharing of information with the Grapevine.

The Grapevine's Web site, www.aagrapevine.org is flourishing, with a 35 percent increase in visitor activity from 2001 to 2002. The most popular features are the archives, Rule #62, information on the current issue, and our on-line catalog. There are also several new features on the web, including an entire area for Grapevine Reps, where they can download a Grapevine cover, the Grapevine workbook, and subscription forms; find their region; and access via password a special Grapevine Rep Bulletin Board to exchange ideas with fellow GvRs.

The biggest news is the green light we have gotten for the A.A. Grapevine Digital Preservation and Accessibility Project. This project will preserve our most important asset and legacy — the approximately 12,000 articles and letters published over the 59-year history of the magazine. Having all Grapevines available in digital format will allow us not only to make articles available on our Web site but also to have them available for many future projects, such as publishing material for people with special needs. It will also include a complete and dynamic index of all Grapevine articles, so that we can access our rich heritage for all the Fellowship to enjoy. We look forward to the project's being completed by late 2004.

Robin Bromley, senior editor

AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2002

ENGLISH

Books Units

Best of Bill	7,141
Best of Bill (Gift edition - hardcover)	1,124
Best of Bill (Gift edition - softcover)	306
Best of the Grapevine I (softcover)	2,357
Best of the Grapevine II (softcover)	1,590
Best of the Grapevine III (softcover)	1,884
The Language of the Heart	11,265
The Language of the Heart (softcover)	711
The Language of the Heart/Big Book Set	2,668
The Home Group	3,920
A.A. Around The World	2,774
Total:	35,740

Cassette Tapes

Attitudes	606
Character Defects	531
Classic Tapes #1	523
Classic Tapes #2	76
Classic Tapes #3	348
Maintaining Spirituality	740
Pathways to Spirituality	72
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol.1	98
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 2	129
Our Experience Has Taught Us	354
Practice These Principles	522
Back to Basics, Vol.1	484
Back to Basics, Vol.2	384
Sponsorship, Vol.1	528
Sponsorship, Vol.2	452
History Lights the Way	430
What We Were Like	494
Youth Enjoying Sobriety	298
Old-Timers Corner	312
Total:	7,381

CDs

Pathways to Spirituality	2,053
Classic Grapevine, Vol 1	1,288
Classic Grapevine, Vol 2	726
Classic Grapevine, Vol 3	648
Not for Newcomers Only	853
Total:	5,568

Miscellaneous

Grapevine Index	3
AA Preamble	1,306
Co-founder's Memorial Issue	1,298
Facsimile of first Grapevine	1,006
Grapevine Binder	718
Man on the Bed	1,775
Serenity Prayer	4,582
Slogans	2,204
Traditions Checklist	477
Wall Calendar	15,072
Pocket Planner	14,182
Total:	42,623

SPANISH

El Lenguaje del Corazon (Language of the Heart)	3,501
Preámbulo (Preamble)	480
Lemas (Slogans)	423
La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)	633
Sonidos de Sobriedad (Sounds of Sobriety)	172
Total:	5,209

FRENCH

Les Sons de la Sobriété (Sounds of Sobriety)	46
Total:	46
Grand Total:	96,567

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 2003	APRIL 2002	
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	1,070	1,088	— 18
Alaska	519	542	— 23
Arizona	1,800	1,766	34
Arkansas	689	665	24
California	10,274	12,382	—2,108
Colorado	1,739	1,750	— 11
Connecticut	1,750	1,833	— 83
Delaware	440	426	14
District of Columbia	210	206	4
Florida	5,511	5,684	— 173
Georgia	2,787	2,915	— 128
Hawaii	612	616	— 4
Idaho	643	599	44
Illinois	4,282	4,367	— 85
Indiana	1,579	1,625	— 46
Iowa	1,273	1,307	— 34
Kansas	1,304	1,359	— 55
Kentucky	1,000	1,016	— 16
Louisiana	992	1,030	— 38
Maine	675	740	— 65
Maryland	1,558	1,514	44
Massachusetts	3,292	3,404	— 112
Michigan	3,620	3,751	— 131
Minnesota	3,010	2,965	45
Mississippi	607	662	— 55
Missouri	1,920	2,053	— 133
Montana	715	757	— 42
Nebraska	1,014	1,010	4
Nevada	774	808	— 34
New Hampshire	772	849	— 77
New Jersey	3,091	3,105	— 14
New Mexico	739	779	— 40
New York	6,330	6,622	— 292
No Carolina	2,593	2,661	— 68
No Dakota	438	512	— 74
Ohio	3,106	3,365	— 259
Oklahoma	1,025	1,080	— 55
Oregon	1,446	1,550	— 104
Pennsylvania	5,149	5,387	— 238
Rhode Island	422	489	— 67
So Carolina	1,120	1,174	— 54
So Dakota	440	445	— 5
Tennessee	1,238	1,398	— 160
Texas	4,484	4,620	— 136
Utah	644	614	30
Vermont	422	436	— 14
Virginia	2,310	2,353	— 43
Washington	3,201	3,385	— 184
West Virginia	447	432	15
Wisconsin	2,554	2,692	— 138
Wyoming	336	374	— 38
Puerto Rico	46	48	— 2
U.S Possessions	70	18	52
Subtotal U.S.	98,082	103,228	—5,146
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	844	843	1
British Columbia/Ykn	979	1,079	— 100
Manitoba	377	378	— 1
New Brunswick/ Prince Edwards Island	298	279	19
Nova Scotia/ New Foundland/Labrador	390	467	— 77
Ontario	2,871	2,991	— 120
Quebec	192	189	3
Saskatchewan	404	394	10
Subtotal Canada	6,355	6,620	— 265
FOREIGN	1,207	1,553	— 346
Grand Total*	105,644	111,401	—5,757

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

Area Service Highlights — Panel 53 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alabama/Northwest Florida: Area 1 is located from the foothills of the Appalachian Mountains to the sugar white beaches of LA (Lower Alabama), extending along the coastline shores and inland of the Florida Panhandle. We have 418 registered groups in 23 districts: 17 in Alabama and 6 in Florida. Our area assemblies are held quarterly in Montgomery, where we encourage participation by all, whether it is a newcomer manning the Hospitality/Coffee room or past delegates moderating and sharing at the Ask-It-Basket session. Committees and districts present workshops geared to the Conference theme and suggested Conference workshops. This past November we hosted the incredibly successful and informative SE Regional Forum, with simultaneous Spanish translation. Over 350 participants enjoyed the Fellowship, the sharing and the ice cream! There continues to be progress in bridging the gap between the English- and Spanish-speaking communities and the desire for unity within the area structure. Our committees are active and are given an opportunity to input to the delegate their group conscience on Conference agenda items. Our Literature committee is working to produce a workbook; a need was recognized. Area 1 is reaching out to other areas in the region, seeking their experience, strength and hope as we try to be more effective in creating Love and Service without boundaries through Humility and Responsibility: A.A. in two Words. — *Jutta (Utah) Matthews.*

Arkansas: Area 4 serves 12 districts with 243 registered groups. We hold four quarterly, two-day assemblies in a central location. Our Archives committee continues to trace the A.A. roots in our area. The convention committee works diligently to prepare for our state convention, Ol' Grandad, the oldest convention west of the Mississippi. The corrections committee is fortunate to have some men from "behind the walls" participate in the Saturday session up through the Committee meeting. Corrections, with the cooperation of the State Department of Community Corrections, continues to carry the message to those incarcerated. The C.P.C. committee reaches out to the professionals. The Grapevine committee has an extensive display to inform the Fellowship of all the Grapevine has to offer, as well as a slide show. P.I. continues to share information and places A.A. meeting directories in motels and other public places and participates in health fairs. The treatment committee has initiated a Bridging the Gap program. This past year we had an ad hoc committee on Remote Communities to brainstorm and come up with ideas on how to carry the message to those separated from us by geography, language, or culture. Last, but not least, Area 4 has a group relations committee, chaired by one of our past delegates and consisting of all D.C.M.s from the area, which shares ideas on ways to get people involved in general service, as well as helping each other solve problems in the individual districts. We

are fortunate to have a very active group of past delegates who continue to support the area assembly and share their experience, strength and hope with us. — *Clay Cutten*

British Columbia/Yukon: Area 79 serves approximately 14,000 members in over 700 groups in 46 districts. We are the second largest geographic area in the service structure, covering almost 800,000 square miles. Our remote districts make up about three-quarters of our geographic area and many are only accessible by boat or plane. The Yukon, which is one district,

makes up about one-third of our area. Due to the mountainous and rugged terrain in our remote districts, even centers that are accessible by car can take several days to reach. Some groups in these districts have only 4 or 5 members and the next closest group would be an 8-hour drive. Groups from more populated districts are making tapes of meetings and sending them to our Remote Communities. We hold mini-assemblies in these districts,

and have a travel subsidy to assist D.C.M.s to attend area assemblies. Last year we added two appointed positions to our General Service Committee — a Northern Remote Communities liaison and an alternate. We have three quarterlies, one combined with the Pre-Conference Service Assembly. All districts have the opportunity to host quarterlies and assemblies and this has added to the unity of our area. There is a very special feeling that accompanies a general service function in a Remote Community. The combination of the Fellowship in traveling great distances together and the work done in the districts to welcome the members leaves a lasting impression. This May we will host a Special Forum in Smithers, British Columbia. — *Maureen Maguire*

California (Central): Area 93 consists of approximately 860 groups, with 21,000 active members, broken down into 26 districts, five of which are linguistic districts serving the Spanish-speaking population. We have a hard-working Translation Committee that provides for the translation of all written material and for interpreters at our area events. We have three "combined" districts that meet together under a D.C.M., but most of our districts are "stand alone" districts. Our area assembly meets five times a year, with a two-day pre-Conference assembly and workshop each year, plus a two-day assembly with elections in the even years. Our area committee also meets five times a year to set agendas for the assembly. We in Area 93 spend our first two years deciding on the guidelines we wanted to put into place for our area and getting our committees going on some projects that facilitate carrying the message. We had our first area inventory in September 2002 and received many valuable suggestions that we are trying to now implement. Our Spanish-speaking districts hold an annual general service forum



that is open to the whole area (translation is provided for non-Spanish speakers). We join annually with Areas 5, 8, and 9 for a D.C.M. sharing session that allows D.C.M.s to share the varied ways that they work within their districts. We are currently considering implementing a quarterly Third Legacy meeting. Being at the grass roots level of building a new area is exciting and I am incredibly privileged to be a part of it. — *Jeanine Rios*

California (Northern Coastal): Area 6 is approximately 600 miles long, and 50 miles wide, encompassing the coastal counties including the San Francisco Bay Area from Monterey to the Oregon border. There are 22 districts, four of which overlay geographically and are Spanish-linguistic districts; translation is provided at all assemblies and area committee meetings. There are 8 area officers, roughly 1,720 groups and 51,000 members. We hold four assemblies per year rotating throughout the area. There are five standing committees: P.I./C.P.C., B.T.G., Archives, Finance and a newly formed Web committee. We are blessed to have past delegates who continue to stay involved. We have decided to start a Web site, rearranged the area meeting agenda to encourage more participation, worked to streamline our BTG Workbook and improve Archive preservation. We have been challenged with low D.C.M. participation, disunity within some Spanish-linguistic districts, and finding ways to host assemblies in more expensive, urban areas. We are seeking solutions for increasing G.S.R. participation at assemblies, mending rifts in our unity, and improving Spanish translation. The dedication and love for A.A. in California, Northern Coastal is inspiring! — *Doug Grude*

California (Southern): Area 5 has 33 districts serving 1,136 registered groups with over 39,000 A.A. members. We have both combined districts and stand-alone districts. Our four Spanish linguistic districts also have an interdistrict meeting attended by district officers. Communication in our area is in both Spanish and English, including our Web site. All our area assemblies and area committee meetings have simultaneous professional English/Spanish interpretation. We also have professional American Sign Language interpretation when needed. One minor glitch in communication is that people who have e-mail will communicate only by e-mail and not realize that not everyone has easy access to a computer. Our area is facing some financial challenges. Before we were granted an additional delegate area three years ago, the area had plenty of money. Now we can't do everything we want. One of the upsides to this is that people are realizing how important it is to inform our groups about what the area is doing, and trying to do. Another positive aspect is that Area 5 now goes through two budget processes a year so that money that was allocated to one area function can be redirected if the money wasn't spent the way it was originally planned. Our new smaller area allows us to concentrate on parts of the area that need attention. We are having some success getting inactive districts going again. Attendance at area meetings is almost what it was before the new delegate area was formed. — *Jim Irwin*

Colorado: Area 10 has 591 active registered groups in 33 geographic districts. We have one Spanish-speaking linguistic district. We have three assemblies per year. We try to encourage outlying districts, which generally have a smaller number of groups, to host assemblies. Attendance at a typical assembly consists of about 125 G.S.R.s, most of our 43 D.C.M.s, all of our 15 elected officers and Standing Committee chairs, and four or five of our eight living past delegates. The area also puts on an annual State Convention, which rotates between the larger met-

ropolitan areas. Over the next year, we hope to decide on whether we should have an Area Web site and whether we need more (or fewer) assemblies per year. It is fitting that the theme of this year's Conference is Sponsorship. Without good Step and service sponsorship, I would not be standing here today. My sponsor did not stop working with me when we finished the Steps. Instead, he took me through the Traditions and Concepts. And he suggested (strongly) that I get involved in service work. Sponsorship is alive and well in Area 10. Many groups, including my home group, have monthly sponsorship meetings. Area committee members sponsor newer members in general service work, and are involved in *Service Manual* and/or Concepts study groups. G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s often ask me how to get their groups and districts more involved in service. My answer is always the same: Sponsorship. — *Mark Greider*

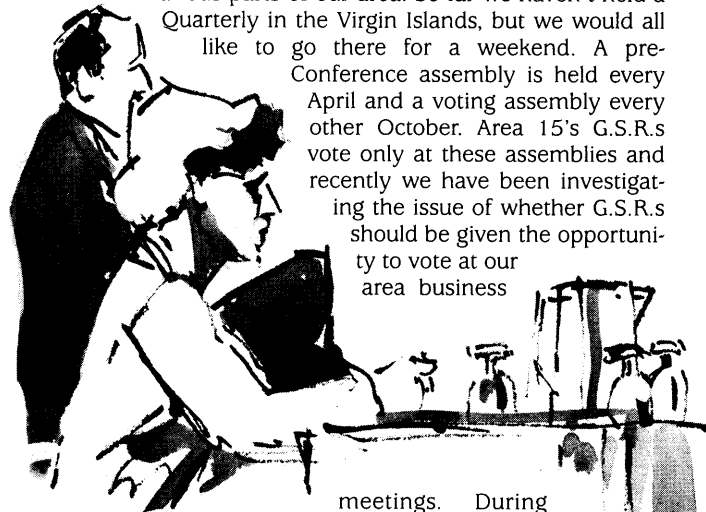
Connecticut: Area 11 includes nine geographic districts, one nongeographic Spanish-speaking district and 14 special service committees; two committees are new: Special Needs and the Conn. State Conference of Young People in A.A. There are 1,467 registered groups representing over 35,000 members. Our corrections facilities committee holds 45 meetings each week and treatment facilities 83. BTG supports a statewide answering service where persons being released may be connected with a contact person to bring them to meetings in their neighborhood. We hold ten area meetings, two assemblies and a pre-Conference assembly. This year we will support our 14th summertime get-together "Soberfest," the second Young People's Convention and the 45th annual convention. We publish an area service directory each year. Listings include officers and committee members and event members, as well as area guidelines, officer job descriptions, and the Concepts Checklist. An informal Concepts discussion meeting meets before the monthly area meeting. The area is in the process of incorporating as a non-stock corporation, and we expect this process to be finalized in the first quarter. — *Gale Plancon*

District of Columbia: Area 13 has two complementary service structures, our Washington Area General Service Assembly and the Washington Area Intergroup Association, as well as three active and cooperative Hispanic Intergroups. We serve the District of Columbia, the Maryland counties of Prince George's and Montgomery, and the Hispanic community in those regions as well as in Northern Virginia. We have 38 districts with 477 registered groups holding 1,451 meetings a week. Each month, over 200 meetings are taken to treatment and corrections facilities, in English and in Spanish. Our C.P.C. committee represents A.A. at many national conferences held in our nation's capitol, and our P.I. committee provides information in English and Spanish to local schools, and serves the general population through exhibits, public meetings, and public announcements on local radio and TV stations. We have an active Bridging the Gap program underway. Last year, in cooperation with the Hispanic Intergroup of Maryland, we supplied Big Books in English and Spanish to public high schools. As with all areas, we experience challenges and growing pains. I was born and raised in Guatemala, came to the U.S. and found sobriety in the Spanish-speaking groups in D.C. 17 years ago. I volunteered for service positions at the group and area level and find myself standing here as the first Area 13 delegate of Hispanic origin. This, more than anything, speaks loud and clear of the spirit of unity and the "right of participation" you can find in Area 13. I speak English and I speak Spanish, but the language of recovery is the "Language of the Heart," which is spoken by all A.A. members around the world. I expect to take home new ideas from

this Conference, which can help Area 13 to always remember what our co-founder Bill W. meant when he said "No personal sacrifice is too great for the preservation of the Fellowship." — *Enna Rodas*

Florida (North): Area 14 has approximately 700 groups in 32 districts; last year we added a Spanish linguistic district. The area purchased the translation equipment and the district is providing the translator. I recently attended their first Spanish District Anniversary and it was heartwarming to see their enthusiasm, and the work they are doing to carry the message to our Spanish-speaking population. We have four assemblies a year. In April, where all workshops and committee meetings focus on the upcoming Conference Agenda items, which are discussed at our pre-Conference meeting. The area has recently opened an Archives repository, which has enabled us to house all material in one location and have frequent working sessions, as well as an open house four times a year in conjunction with the area assembly. Our Web site is up and running. The area chair appoints the webmaster and the P.I. committee oversees the Web site. The districts are active and are holding workshops throughout the year. There is a profound commitment of all involved in service in Area 14 to carry the message of recovery to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Corliss Gibbons*

Florida (South Florida/Bahamas/Virgin Islands/Antigua): Area 15 is divided into 16 districts (including one Hispanic linguistic district) most of which are very large. We have a total of 1,674 groups, represented by 120 D.C.M.s. There are 19 intergroups or central offices. We hold four quarterly weekends each year in various parts of our area. So far we haven't held a Quarterly in the Virgin Islands, but we would all like to go there for a weekend. A pre-Conference assembly is held every April and a voting assembly every other October. Area 15's G.S.R.s vote only at these assemblies and recently we have been investigating the issue of whether G.S.R.s should be given the opportunity to vote at our area business



meetings. During 2002 I visited all of our districts, including the Virgin Islands. The service work going on there, in a very remote community, is nothing short of phenomenal. Many of the districts have created ad-hoc committees to study the issue of Spirituality vs. Religion in our A.A. literature, as suggested by the Literature Committee of the 52nd Conference. Area 15 is supported very generously by our many groups and at our January Quarterly we were gratified to send a check to G.S.O. for over \$17,000. We are especially proud that our Spanish Linguistic district, together with the Spanish Intergroup in Miami, hosted the 30th National Hispanic Convention of A.A. and that the 8th Annual National Archives Workshop will be held in Ft. Lauderdale in September. Yes! Alcoholics Anonymous is alive and well in South Florida. — *Beth Davidson*

Hawaii: Area 17 has 15 districts on six islands (Oahu, Maui, Kawai, Hawaii, Molokai and Lanai), with 302 reported groups and 5,541 members. We have four two-day area assemblies with over 120 G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, intergroup chairs, committee chairs and area officers attending. In April we have our "Inform the Delegate" assembly to pass on the group conscience of the area. We have four committee meetings per year. Our assemblies and committee meetings rotate among the Islands providing service opportunities for all the districts. We have nine standing committees and five intergroups. A Hawaii Area Convention is held in November with over 3,000 guests, half of them from over 20 states and 10 countries. We participate in PRAASA every March with about 25 members attending from Hawaii each year. We are excited about a Special Forum in Hawaii in January 2004. Our ongoing challenge is to keep the groups informed as to the importance of area service to all the Islands and all the districts within the state. We continue to strive to assist in keeping all groups informed as they carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Don Anderson*

Illinois (Chicago): In 1948, Bill Wilson asked the Chicago Group to customize their service structure to see if his concept for the proposed General Service Conference would work. Thus Area 19, Chicago, became the very first Central Office in A.A. and a model for our future. Those early Chicago members' energy and commitment to A.A. is today mirrored in the P.I., Finance, Corrections, H&I and Grapevine committees. The cooperation among the committees is a demonstration of A.A. unity and our Legacy of Service. Our Grapevine Committee works to boost awareness and increase subscriptions; our H&I will host the National Bridging the Gap conference this fall. Last March Chicago hosted the first Inner City Forum. We have two Spanish districts and equipment for simultaneous translation is available for meetings, conferences, and area assemblies. Our 24-hour answering service is staffed by more than 100 volunteers and assures immediate contact for any newcomer. Our annual All-Chicago Open Meeting, begun in 1940, will be held in September. Please know it is a privilege to trudge with you on that Road to Happy Destiny. — *Don Bennett*

Illinois (Southern): Area 21 covers the southern two-thirds of the state and is composed of 17 districts; the area has approximately 437 registered groups, 7,300 members, and 1,040 meetings per week. Being a predominately rural area, some of our districts are rather large and spread over small towns and rural communities, however, we do have a few cities with populations in excess of 100,000 people.



We meet in assembly four times a year and host a spring service conference yearly with all service events rotating between different locations. Additionally, we host the Illinois State Conference once every three years as part of the scheduled rotation. This year we host the East Central Regional Conference being held in conjunction with our state conference. Financial support from the groups has been steady and sufficient for the area to operate within a limited budget; we maintain a prudent reserve of six months. Both our Archives and the Grapevine committees have traveling displays. Our area and individual district corrections committees are active. Attendance

at assemblies has remained constant but little growth in attendance; efforts are being made to increase the number of G.S.R.s attending and encouragement is being offered to D.C.M.s to reach out to adjacent districts. Area 21 continues to carry the message to those alcoholics still suffering and I am honored to represent it here today. — *Richard Grunloh*

Indiana (Northern): Area 22 has approximately 709 registered groups in 48 districts covering 50% of Indiana. We hold area assemblies four times a year; our May assembly is weekend long, and the program is dedicated to the delegate's report of the Conference. We are showing an increase in participation for our weekend assembly format. We hold two D.C.M. conferences a year, modeled after the delegates/past delegates conference held in our region. The spring D.C.M. conference is dedicated to discussing the agenda items for the General Service Conference. At the fall D.C.M. conference our annual proposed budget is passed out to the D.C.M.s and area committee chairperson to allow discussion by the groups before the budget is proposed at the November assembly. This year Area 22 will be hosting the 50th Indiana State Convention in Fort Wayne. We have recently gone through the process of updating our area structure to more closely follow the *A.A. Service Manual*. As enthusiasm for service work fluctuates, our past delegates have taken the challenge to help encourage and inform struggling districts. We have ten standing committees. Our area committees are staffed by D.C.M.s, drawn from the hat. Northern Indiana is very dedicated to carrying the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Jack Ottinger*

Iowa: Area 24 consists of over 600 groups in 21 districts. We hold three area committee meetings per year in a central location and two area assemblies per year that rotate between districts. Our eight committee chairs stay very active. We have recently relocated our Archives from Des Moines to Denison and combined two Archives positions into one. We have changed from having a permanent museum-like display that only a fraction of our area has seen to having a traveling display that can be modified for local workshops or area functions. In addition to the Archives display, we also have Literature, Grapevine, Public Information and C.P.C. displays that travel the state for workshops and assemblies. Our Web site has begun its second two-year trial period. We have listings for meetings and upcoming events. Our P.I. committee has been diligent in circulating copies of the Fourth Edition Big Book to libraries in Iowa. Corrections work continues to be a major focus, with meetings held across the area in state and county facilities. A workshop was held in December that included professionals from the corrections field. Our newsletter is published quarterly with reports from service chairs and upcoming events. Our Treatment committee is active in the ever-changing environment of treatment facilities. Overall, Area 24 is committed to the service structure and helping the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Mike Lewis*

Louisiana: Area 27 has 31 districts with 446 groups. As of this year we are changing from four full assemblies (all day Saturday and Sunday morning) held in Alexandria, Louisiana, to two full assemblies and two area committee meetings (Saturday only) which will rotate around the state. The original intent of this change was to increase involvement from distant and small groups which could not send a G.S.R. to four assemblies. We are also hoping that it will lead to more involvement from the D.C.M.s. There seems to be a marked increase in workshops in our area sponsored by districts and groups. We have an annual state convention which rotates bi-yearly. It will be held in Gonzales for the next two years. Spanish-speaking groups are

beginning to be represented in the New Orleans area. We have a new position of registrar, which has already helped in cleaning up records badly in need of it. We are continuing to define the duties of our registrar. We have active committees that are continuing to grow in size and experience. I am glad that God sees fit to allow me to continue to serve this Fellowship and the area I love. — *Irving Doucet*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Area 30 consists of over 2,000 groups divided into 26 districts and two Spanish districts. We hold five assemblies a year hosted by alternating districts, and hold a monthly area committee meeting. Our Corrections and P.I. committees are joint committees with Boston Central Service. We have five other intergroups; one is Spanish. Corrections sponsors 75 meetings at correctional facilities; our Treatment Facilities committee is a joint committee with three of our intergroups; it sponsors an 800 hot-line number, and is supportive of the Bridging the Gap program. A few years ago our area started sending annual subscriptions of the Grapevine and La Viña to Correctional and Treatment Facilities, which the districts have continued. We have four standing committees consisting of Registrar, Service Seminars, *Messenger* (our area newsletter) and the Mass. State Convention (which we co-host with Area 31 every November). Our Web site is being fine-tuned by an ad-hoc committee and we have recently purchased equipment to assist in translation as well as with the hearing impaired. We still look for new ways to attract more people into service. — *Jim Parili*

Michigan (Central): Area 32 consists of the eastern half of Michigan's Lower Peninsula, except for the Greater Detroit Area. We have 14 districts with approximately 600 registered groups. Our area assembly meets on the first Sunday of every month with a different district hosting it monthly. Our area has added a registrar position and a Web site. In the spirit of unity, we meet with Areas 33 and 34 on a quarterly basis for our statewide meeting. Grapevine and Corrections are the two committees that meet at the state level. We rotate our state convention. Each area hosts it every third year. Each March, our state holds a mock Conference in order for our three delegates to get more input from others regarding the agenda items. It also allows other A.A. members to attend and get a better understanding of the General Service Conference by being a delegate for the day. We currently have an increase in attendance averaging approximately 175 people each month. Our financial support from the groups is solid. If we continue to welcome the new people who come to area assembly the same way we were welcomed, our area will continue to grow. I am grateful to represent Central Michigan, Area 32 and look forward to serving them to the best of my ability. — *Dennis Soto*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33 serves approximately 18,000 members attending approximately 743 meetings in the five county Detroit metropolitan areas. There are 25 districts, with one area-wide Spanish-speaking district. One of the challenges facing the area is the distribution of groups within districts. Population shifts in the last ten years have created imbalances in the number of groups in the districts. A few of the urban districts have 12 to 14 meetings while some suburban districts have 60

Karen Long, wife of Victor (delegate from Maryland), embroidered NERD (Northeast Regional Delegate) on sweatshirts (blue on white shirts) for the 18 delegates in the Northeast Region. All wore their shirts to the Stardust Diner.

to 70 meetings. Our P.I. committee has contacted the school systems and is working with several to establish information talks to inform young people about A.A. The three delegate areas in Michigan meet quarterly to discuss our annual Mock Conference and State Convention; also a State Correction Committee and a State Grapevine Committee meet at this time to coordinate state-wide activities. We visited each district to deliver the delegates' Conference report. It allowed us to observe, learn from and inform D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. They asked many great questions. Because G.S.O. is so informative, we were able to answer many questions or direct members where they could find the answer. — *Dan Stasinski*.

Minnesota (Southern): Area 36 has 26 districts serving about 1,000 registered groups. We hold an annual service conference in January followed by a delegate's workshop, three one-day assemblies, and four area committee meetings each year. The theme for the January service conference focuses on the Conference theme. At this event we also provide orientation for new G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and district standing committee chairs. Our officers meet monthly in addition to the scheduled calendar events. Our 13 standing committees meet quarterly. A new addition is the Remote Communities Committee. Our past area delegates are active and have voting privileges at area committees meetings and assemblies. As a result of the consistent efforts of our area committee and G.S.R.s, group contributions have increased 31 % in the past five years. Since its inception in 1998, the area's Pink Can Plan has distributed over 41,000 pieces of A.A. literature, including Big Books, pamphlets and Grapevine subscriptions, to 38 different correctional facilities. We are grateful for the support of our local intergroups, whose cooperation supports our Temporary Contact Program reaching those in treatment centers and the Temporary Sponsorship Program extending the hand of A.A. to correctional facilities. Area 36 has been blessed with wonderful trusted servants whose dedication helps carry the message to those who still stumble in the darkness. — *Brenda Lindgren*

Missouri (Eastern): Area 38 has nearly 600 groups in 23 districts. We have four one-day assemblies per year in a centralized location. Our election assemblies are two-day affairs. We use the Third Legacy Procedure as outlined in the *A.A. Service Manual*. The activities and services provided by the area and the districts are fully funded by contributions from the groups. Our paid office employee has assisted G.S.O. in testing the DelArea software package that we hope will streamline and improve the group update process. This year we are focusing on reaching and attracting as many groups as possible by assisting the districts. We stand ready to do this through workshops, sharing sessions, or any other activity that builds and strengthens that district in their quest to make our message available. Additionally, we are planning a sharing session for the area committee with the hope that the improved unity will ultimately draw other members into service. (Planning continues on the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming, an event commemorating the 50th Anniversary of the 1955 International Convention, when A.A. Came of Age, to be held in November 2005.) I have personally witnessed tremendous spiritual and physical growth in this Conference area over the past several years, and it is indeed an honor and a privilege to serve. — *Mike Foster*

Missouri (Western): Area 39 consists of 16 districts and around 210 groups. We continue to carry the message in many ways through the efforts of our area committees; for example, our Special Needs committee has made it possible for there to be more accessibility to meetings; our area Web site subcommit-

tee has been working to get our Web site up and running. We now have a very nice Web site that is linked to many other A.A. Web sites. Our area treatment and corrections committees host an Institutions Weekend every spring. This has been a great opportunity to bring professionals in these fields together with A.A.s. The weekend consists of workshops where both A.A.s and professionals are involved. There is a banquet and an auction to help with our self-support; if there are any funds left over they are divided among all the area standing committees. This year we finalized the creation of a new district that overlapped with Area 38 (Eastern Missouri) and Area 39 (Western Missouri). This was a long and somewhat tedious process and thanks to the help from our friends in the Eastern Area of Missouri this was accomplished. I am constantly amazed that we get so much done with so little organization. Thank you, God, thank you, A.A. — *Clarke Brown*

Montana: Area 40 ranges from the rolling prairies to the majestic Rocky Mountains, and includes nearly the entire state of Montana. We serve 272 groups who host around 650 meetings a week. The area committee consists of four area officers, seven standing committee chairs, the area newsletter editor, and two nonrotating servants, the area archivist and the area webmaster, along with the D.C.M.s and a representative from each of the 14 districts. We hold two assemblies annually, structured much like the General Service Conference. This has become an effective way to conduct business and reach a sense of the area. In the past few years we have started zone events. Neighboring districts have started hosting pre-assembly events prior to the area assemblies. Area officers and committee chairs are invited to participate and share background information and thoughts, and get feedback. These have become very popular and have a very positive effect in generating enthusiasm and increasing discussion of the agenda items. We are preparing to host the 2005 West Central Regional Forum, in May 2005, at a location to be determined at our spring assembly. Carrying the message of sobriety to the still-suffering alcoholic and living the principles of our Three Legacies is the main focus of Alcoholics Anonymous in Area 40. — *Earl Fink*

Nevada: Area 42 covers all of Nevada and parts of California, approximately 189,826 square miles. Nevada has 409 registered groups, while the California portion has 50 registered. Overall, there are over 1,600 meetings. Due to the miles between us, we have split Area 42 into two sections, Northern Area 42 and Southern Area 42, though we are still considered as one. Twice a year we have three-day area assemblies. We have a pre-Conference assembly in March each year where we discuss the upcoming agenda items with the delegate. Our fall assembly is in September. Assemblies are held in a tiny town in the middle of the state, which provides reasonably equal access for everyone. Area officer positions are rotated every two years — from the North one time and South the next. We are fortunate to have eight to ten past delegates and two past trustees who attend our assemblies, bringing a wealth of knowledge and information. We are excited to have hosted the Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly (PRAASA) Reno in March, a wonderful Twelfth Step call for our area. I am honored to have been a part of the growth and development of Area 42 and to be serving as delegate. My hope is to take back to my area a clearer understanding of the Conference and its workings in an effort to further educate our members about this wonderful process. — *Cherie Smith*

New Jersey (Northern): Area 44 has 44 districts serving approximately 1,200 groups and 31,000 members. The area is divided



into six sections with 37 D.C.M.s. A section leader is elected by D.C.M.s residing in each section. The area assembly comprised of D.C.M.s, standing and special committee chairs, area officers, G.S.R.s and interested A.A.s, meet in assembly three times a year. We also hold a mini-Conference in April and an area convention in September. Our standing committees, which continue to be very active, mirror the Conference structure. At our January assembly we began discussion and sharing on the Conference Theme: Living A.A.'s Principles through Sponsorship. Our work weekend, in December, was quite enlightening as eight presenters shared their experience on our Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts. It was followed by a lively discussion. We then reviewed our progress and plans of our committees and set area goals for the coming year. In conjunction with Northern New Jersey Intergroup, we have entered the 21st Century with our Web site. A major goal of Area 44 is to stimulate interest in the Remote Community Committee to reach out to the still-suffering alcoholics who have a desire to achieve sobriety. — *Barbara Bridges*

New York (Central): We have 670 active groups in Area 47. Area assemblies are held every month, except May, when a local district will host our area convention. Participation has been on the decline at the area level, which is evident in the number of G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and in the standing committees. The voice of the groups is still being heard in Central New York, but if this decline continues, the weakness of the area may cause the conscience of Central New York to not be truly heard. We have a large geographical area with a diverse membership. Unfortunately, our assembly does not reflect the minority membership evident in the groups. We have numerous central offices, intergroups, and answering services. The highlight of this level of service is the growth of the Rochester, New York, Central Office structure. Problems at the central office led to renewed interest on the part of local groups. A positive development is the continued growth of the Bridging the Gap program for corrections. This past August, we hosted the New York State Informational Workshop in Canandaigua, New York. We have many dedicated, hard-working trusted servants in Central New York that exemplify the principles of A.A. service. I am proud to serve with them. — *Paul Walker*

New York (Southeast): Area 49 consists of nearly 2,000 groups, of which 1,650 are registered, and 12 counties, as well as a non-geographical Spanish district. We have implemented a two-year trial period of holding five full-day assemblies annually. Our goal is to encourage more G.S.R. participation. We held our first Day of Sharing this year, a full-day event, which included presentations on Conference Agenda items. Our G.S.R.s now have more information, thus ensuring a more informed group conscience on these questions. Our Special Needs Committee works hard to make our message inclusive to everyone by providing ASL interpretation at our area convention, service workshops and Share-A-Days and by encouraging the use of wheelchair accessible locations for our area events. Our ad hoc Web site Committee became a standing committee in 2002. Our area convention is held annually, except in the year we host the New York State Convention. We also participate every year with the other three delegate areas in New York State in an Informational Workshop, where all four areas share how they continue to do their Twelfth Step work. SENY continues to strive to carry the message of hope to the sick and suffering alcoholic as widely and inclusively as possible. — *Terry Flynn*

North Carolina: Area 51 is made up of 35 districts that encompass a geographical span of 48,843 square miles. Our area assembly meets biannually, our area committee meets quarterly, and we host an annual State Convention. We have an approximate membership of 14,900, in 946 groups, 70 of which are located in Correctional Facilities. The Area 51 Correctional Facilities Committee hosts an annual Correction Facilities Conference, which was attended by representatives from nine different states in 2002. The C.F. chair is nominated by the Correctional Facilities Committee and approved during our November Assembly. Our C.P.C./P.I., Grapevine, and Literature chairs are appointed by the incoming area chair, while the chairs of our Budget and Finance, Site Investigation, and Treatment Facilities committees are currently elected from second year D.C.M.s serving on their respective committee. Our archivist is appointed by the area chair, and our Archives Repository is currently located in Raleigh. Area 51 is reevaluating our current committee structure and reaching out to the membership via workshops and forums, the first of which was hosted by District

11 in North Wilksboro in 2002. We are working toward the implementation of our newly formed Linguistic District, including better ways to communicate with our Spanish-speaking members. Working in the spirit of unity, Area 51 is moving confidently into the 21st century to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Teresa Frohock*

North Dakota: Area 52 has approximately 147 groups in 12 districts, covering the entire state. Each district is responsible for one month of the year to share at our state correctional facilities. Area assemblies are held three times a year in varying locations. Attendance varies from about 40 to 70, depending on location and time of year. So, roughly 25% of our groups are represented by a G.S.R. at the assemblies. Our assemblies are similar to the Conference structure, as we have six standing committees with the D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s assigned to a committee. The committee system at the area level has been a blessing, as the arguing is nearly nonexistent. This past fall assembly we held elections, and are all settling in at our new respective service positions. At this same assembly, it was decided to have a permanent Archivist instead of an Archives chair. The archivist will chair the Archives committee. Six past delegates attended our last state roundup. Having gathered together in one room, sober members with much experience and the newcomer (even more important) made me feel that A.A. in Area 52 is alive and well. — *Eric Bothun*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Area 82 is made up of 16 districts, 10 in Nova Scotia, five in Newfoundland and one in Labrador, with approximately 238 registered groups and 3,800 active members. We cover a large geographical area on the east coast of Canada, about 1,700 miles long and separated by two bodies of water. Travel between Nova Scotia and Newfoundland is by air or boat. We hold one assembly per year, which rotates between four major cities, and two service weekends, one in each province, to hear reports from our D.C.M.s, area officers, G.S.R.s and the delegate's Conference report. Each province maintains a provincial Archives with an archivist who rotates every five years. We have an intergroup in St. Johns, Newfoundland, and a central office in Halifax. Most districts have active committees. We established a Remote Communities Committee in 1999, which has been distributing literature and helping to establish A.A. meetings in coastal communities of Newfoundland and Labrador. In Aboriginal communities on the coast of Labrador several new meetings have been established and several others have been rejuvenated. A Special Forum is slated for Goose Bay, Labrador in June 2004. Much of Newfoundland and most of Labrador would come under our umbrella of "Remote Community" and we have much to do in this area. The largest obstacles we face in this endeavor appear to be language, trust and finances. There are 15 dialects in Labrador alone, but translations of A.A. literature into the Innu language have already begun; and when the call goes out to our membership, the finances come in. Slowly, but surely we are gaining the trust of our Aboriginal people. A Round-up was held in Churchill Falls, Labrador in 2002 which was a huge success. It is with gratitude and honor that I represent Area 82 at our General Service Conference; thank you for this opportunity to share with you. — *Wanda Halverson*

Ohio (Central/Southeast): Area 53 is the largest geographically of Ohio's four service area, serving 38 counties through 42 districts with over 675 identified groups and meetings. We hold quarterly assemblies and quarterly D.C.M./Area Committee meetings. The area hosts a weekend mini-conference each

March to provide the delegate with an informed group conscious and offer interested A.A.s Conference experience. A weekend Correctional Facilities Committee Conference is held in October to broaden understanding of A.A. behind the walls. Our ten standing committees meet monthly; individual districts work with these committees to provide workshops on issues of concern to interested A.A.s throughout the area. A service letter from the delegate is mailed periodically to all G.S.R.s, panel members, and interested A.A.s to keep them in the information loop. The area provides a Web site, a 24-hour voicemail, and a quarterly newsletter. Our elected D.C.M. chair works with the districts and assists the area chair and delegate. We also host the State Planning Committee for the annual Ohio/S.E. Michigan State Convention rotated and hosted by each of the four areas of the state. — *Andy Talbert*

Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 has nearly 1,400 groups in 64 districts, and an estimated 22,000 members. In addition to the delegate and alternate delegate, there are four area officers and ten standing committees. Each year we hold six area assemblies, a G.S.R. workshop, a D.C.M. workshop and a committee workshop to conduct business and share our experience, strength and hope. We have a summer picnic and a fall dinner to celebrate sobriety and express our gratitude for this way of life. Prior to the General Service Conference we hold a mini-Conference to give our delegates the informed group conscious on selected agenda items and to allow our members to personally experience the committee system and a voting conference. Along with the other three delegate areas in Ohio we participate in planning and hosting the Ohio State Convention. We also participate with the 14 delegate areas of the East Central Region in planning and hosting the East Central Regional Convention. There are eight central offices and intergroups in NE Ohio. In the past few years we have seen barriers between the area and these local offices removed through cooperative efforts. Our greatest challenge is keeping our groups active in service and practicing the Seventh Tradition. I am honored to have the opportunity to represent the groups of NE Ohio and grateful to be a member of A.A., the Fellowship that saved my life. — *Dan Mix*

Oklahoma: Area 57 has approximately 400 groups with approximately 6,200 members and 8 districts. We have one paid employee, the area secretary, and two intergroup offices. Each operates independently of the area structure. We have a strong foundation consisting of several elder statesmen. Our area committee meets quarterly. We hold two Area Sharing Sessions a year. We take Area Sponsored Workshops, on request, to our smaller and remote communities. This has been successful in improving our communication and in giving and getting support. Our area has strong service committees. We recently have seen growth in C.P.C. and P.I. We had a successful C.P.C. workshop with Drug Court officials in one of our counties, and have since started working with courts in additional counties. Our Language Service Committee is faced with the challenge of rapid growth of Hispanic population. Our two largest cities each have an annual State Fair and we have displays at both fairs. We are serving many of the Correctional and Treatment Facilities. Our area sponsors an Annual Conference for the delegate to give a Conference report. We also invite and sponsor our regional trustee and a G.S.O. staff member. We believe our message is pure. Our challenge is communicating the message that the solution to alcoholism is Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship. — *Chuck Berry*

Ontario (Eastern): Area 83 is made up of approximately 15,000

members in 550 groups organized into 28 districts. Two of our districts are in the U.S. Another district is truly international, spanning both the border and the St. Lawrence River near Brockville. There is one Spanish linguistic district in Toronto. We stretch 300 miles from the western reaches of Toronto to the Ontario/Quebec border, south into New York State and north to the lower limits of Algonquin Park. Our Provincial government is in the process of building perhaps a half-dozen mega-jails in Ontario, replacing dozens of local institutions. In Eastern Ontario, the new jail is in a rural setting, and the Fellowship is concerned about carrying our message of hope into this facility. The two nearest districts have perhaps 40 groups between them. By contrast, the Toronto area, which is home to a half-dozen or so of the jails scheduled to be closed, has over 150 groups. Toronto is the site of the 2005 International Convention. We are looking forward to welcoming the world-wide Fellowship to our area. Our members are already excited at the prospect of hosting the tens of thousands that will be attending A.A.'s 70th Anniversary celebration. See you there! — *Roy Robertson*

Ontario (Northeast): Area 84 is vast in miles, small in numbers, and large in heart. We have 8 districts with 171 groups. Our largest district, in square miles, has 42 groups; it is the most northerly in our area and has about 75% of the remote communities. I plan to make many visits to this district to encourage participation. Our contributions to G.S.O. are among the top 25%, so in spite of small numbers, I feel we are doing our share. We meet four times a year. Two times are for committee meetings to keep informed and set up the agenda for the two assemblies we have. One assembly is in late March/early April for the delegate to report on the information on the Conference Agenda. The fall assembly is a voting assembly for elections or other issues that have come about from the committee meetings. We have a Remote Communities Committee, just appointed in the fall. The last ad hoc committee has opened the door for many contacts in the remote areas. Our Archives committee has the archives available for district anniversaries. Our archivist was at the Archives Workshop in San Bernardino in September. She was the only archivist from Canada and put on a small presentation. We have an area conference that rotates between our three largest cities and draws a vast majority of our membership. The area has a newsletter that is published six times a year and we are trying to encourage members to use it as a source of information. Our goal is knowledge of service and service. Thank you for my life. — *Mary Alice Sanderson*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 has many dedicated service people but there is a need to get more members involved. Lack of service and regular sponsorship has discouraged people from becoming involved at all levels of service. Fortunately, some older members have come into the service structure after many years of sobriety. The attraction to come into service is through our past delegates and our past Eastern Canada regional trustee. Area 85 includes eight districts serving 72 groups. In the past year we have included positions like Remote Communities, and registrar chairperson and assistant treasurer. The groups are strong and there have been new groups started when old ones closed. Concepts meetings started in January 2003. A great deal of work is being done with our remote communities and we are waiting patiently for the Big Book to be available on cassette in the Ojibway language. Contact has been made with several remote reserves and they are pleased with the service that is available to them. Our remote communities chairperson speaks

the native language and is willing to travel to these remote areas, some of which are only available through winter ice roads across lakes. We need to reach out and demonstrate to them the benefits of being "a part of" and carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Marie Hamilton*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Area 59 has 34,000-plus members in 1,400 groups. We have 47 districts and six area officers. Area meetings are held quarterly. Like the Conference, we operate by the committee system. Only current D.C.M.s may serve on the area's standing subcommittees. There is an ad hoc committee for Special Needs and Remote Communities. We hold several events annually to encourage participation and foster Unity with the Fellowship: A pre-Conference workshop in early April; four mini-assemblies, post Conference, where the delegate gives report; "Area Day" informs the Fellowship about Area 59's structure; the Assembly/Convention held each November with attendance of almost 1,000. Our area is blessed with 12 inter-groups/central offices. Our P.I. committee is researching the pros and cons of creating an area Web site. The Structure Committee will delve into whether Special Needs/Remote Communities should become a standing committee or remain ad hoc for now. The C.F. and T.F. committee are fine-tuning the Bridging the Gap programs. We'll hold an area inventory half way through the panel to check our progress and seek improvements. Area 59 remains ever open to new and better ways to achieve our primary purpose — carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. May God continue to bless our efforts! — *Nancy Keohane*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 has approximately 780 groups in 46 districts. Geographically, we cover about 40% of Pennsylvania in 26 counties. Our area committee meets quarterly, and we hold two or three assemblies each year. We have the following established committees: P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Correctional Facilities, Newsletter, Grapevine, Archives, and Literature. In addition to regular area meetings, we sponsor six to eight days of sharing each year, which are well attended and generate a great deal of enthusiasm for the grass roots member. Our pre-Conference assembly is our primary means of determining the area group conscience on selected Conference Agenda items. Recently, we have completed the steps necessary to becoming incorporated, and shortly thereafter we received a determination from the IRS that we are a tax-exempt 501 (c) (3) entity. We expect to gain the same determination from Pennsylvania, shortly. Our area has instituted an ad hoc finance committee to oversee all aspects of our income and expenses and to provide guidance in preparing budgets. Another ad hoc committee on Remote Communities/Special Needs is continually looking into ways to carry the message to those alcoholics that have yet to find us. We are always on the lookout for ways to make A.A. service attractive and interesting. — *John Warren*

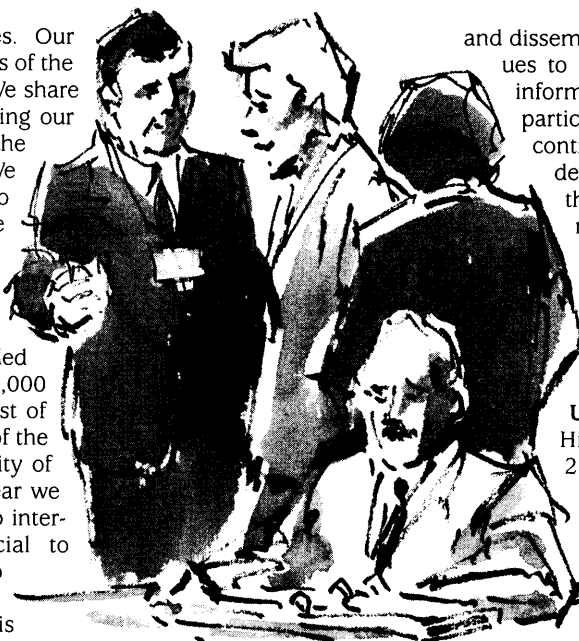
Quebec (Northeast): Area 89 is 1,000 miles in length and includes both the northern bank of the St. Lawrence River and the far north, where several native communities reside. We have 22 districts, 360 groups and about 6,700 members. Most members are French-speaking. The six members of our executive committee meet once a month. We hold two assemblies and four area committee meetings a year. The December one is a two day round-up. Seminars on various subjects are held in each district. A new one in preparation is on the Twelve Concepts. Carrying the message to alcoholics in remote communities, as well as service, will always be a challenge to our area. Great distances separate these communities, and visiting them is sometimes difficult. Our new project involves new designated **District**

Remote Communities Representatives. Our D.C.M.s are well aware of the seriousness of the challenge so they give us full support. We share our Fellowship's common goal of carrying our message of hope and live it through the Twelfth Step work and sponsorship. We are forever responsible to those who need and seek A.A. I am grateful to be part of this miracle that is A.A. and to serve as delegate in joy, respect and love. — *Réal Laforest*

Québec (Southeast): Area 88 is divided into 18 districts, with 198 groups and 3,000 members. Our area is large, starting east of Québec to the Madeleine Island and all of the South of St. Lawrence River; the majority of our members are francophone. Each year we have four area assemblies. We have two inter-regional meetings and one provincial to exchange points of view. We hold two gratitude dinners in two different cities, where the delegate presents his Conference report, and all benefits from these dinners are sent directly to G.S.O. We give three or four days a year to an explanation of Structures and Traditions as requested by the districts. One month prior to the Conference, each district holds a day to study the Conference theme. This year, we will establish a Web site and our area will distribute the brochure R.17, "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to all groups. For the coming year, our slogan will be "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsoring." I am the delegate because of the former delegates in my district and I thank them very much. I am very happy to be at this Conference. — *Claude Lieutenant*

Texas (Northeast): Area 65 has approximately 460 groups, 29 districts, and six intergroup/central offices. Four of the intergroups are English-speaking and two are Spanish. In the spirit of unity, we rotate our winter and summer assemblies around the Northeast Texas Area. Our fall and spring assemblies are held in the centrally located Dallas/Forth Worth Metroplex. We had our first assembly this year in Henderson, with an attendance of 236. We were blessed with the opportunity of hosting the 2002 Southwest Region Service Assembly, and attendance was grand at 656. The speakers/moderators were all past delegates of our Southwest Region. Their experience with the Steps, Traditions and Concepts was shared with us the entire weekend. The enthusiasm was absolutely contagious and the unity was something that I will remember forever. — *Joe Pineda*.

Texas (Southeast): Area 67 is composed of 15 districts; two are Spanish linguistic districts. The area serves approximately 533 English-speaking and 47 Spanish-speaking groups. Our assembly meets three times a year in a central location. A combination assembly and convention is held in January. This year, the theme was "We absolutely insist on enjoying life" and was attended by almost 2,000. Our area is the host for the 2004 Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly, with our capable alternate delegate coordinating the event. We also hold a Gratitude Dinner in November. Our Archives committee is busy gathering oral and written history from our long-time members. Our Correctional committee is making plans to hold its 5th Annual Bilingual C.F.C. Service Conference in September. A multi-lingual committee was formed to unify the Fellowship, with oral and written translations of area material. The Literature committee informs us of



and disseminates material. Our Web site continues to communicate service and fellowship information. As communication improves, participation in our area service structure continues to grow, albeit slowly. Our past delegates continue to attend and vote at the assemblies, passing on their experience, strength and hope. Thus we may have the best informed area conscience possible, to improve both our Twelfth Step work and general service in the southeast corner of Texas. — *Paul Mijares*

Utah: Area 69 has 11 districts, one Hispanic subdistrict, approximately 255 active groups, and over 4,600 members. We have numerous remote communities and are still looking for ways to better reach them. Most of our districts are participating at the area level. We hold three assemblies and four area committee meetings each year, with locations

moving around the state. Our districts take turns hosting two workshops each year. Our corrections committee has seen wonderful growth lately. We continue to assign G.S.R.s to standing committee roundtables to encourage their input at our assemblies. We are evaluating the possibility of creating an area Web site. Singleness of purpose seems to be on the minds of many of our members lately. We are blessed to have many of our past delegates continue to participate and share their experience with us. We will be celebrating our 60th A.A. birthday in June 2004, and look forward to a great time, and you're all invited to join us. — *Jodi Ericson*

Virginia: Area 71 covers nearly 40,000 square miles with a population of 6.5 million. At present, our area has some 30,000 members in 1,721 registered groups, of which eight to ten are Spanish-speaking. Contributions are received from 1,314 groups. We have 45 active districts; sadly last year one district went dark. About 400 A.A.s attend the area's spring and fall assemblies; approximately 250 are G.S.R.s. Close to 100 area committee members and interested A.A.s attend the winter and summer meetings. We have a workshop for new G.S.R.s at every assembly. Care is taken to rotate events throughout the state to give all districts the opportunity to host service events and drum up local enthusiasm. Virginia is working hard to maintain its rich service heritage. We have created a new service position of Information Technologies coordinator to maintain the computers and other equipment owned by the area as well as to attempt to integrate all the personal, group and Web site information into a single database. I will be presenting oral Conference reports that are hosted throughout the area by the districts. I'm thankful that for me sobriety in service is "the easier, softer way." It is an honor for me to represent the Virginia Area and to be here with all of you. — *Ruth Barth*

Washington (Western): Area 72 has approximately 1,100 groups in 40 districts; one is a Spanish-language district representing 17 Hispanic groups throughout our area. We also have nonvoting representation by seven intergroup offices with our first ever Hispanic intergroup. At our last area assembly we had about 40% of the G.S.R.s participating and approximately 670

members in attendance. This year we held six regional pre-Conferences throughout our area so the groups could have the opportunity to be more involved in the Conference topics and so I could be better prepared for the Conference. We have roughly 400 to 500 members attending these regional pre-Conferences each year. Our area is currently looking into how to fund interpreters for Spanish members and the hearing impaired at our area assemblies and other events. We have formed an area Web site, which will be coming this summer. And we have been working on a revision of our area history book, "Our Stories Disclosed" and the updated book will contain information from about 600 of our groups. — *Eddie Harris*

West Virginia: Area 73 has approximately 300 groups in 16 districts. We have an assembly each spring and fall, which is offered to every district to host in a regular rotation. In the summer we have an area-wide convention that is also on a rotation. The cooperation among the districts is successful, and all districts are active. Our area elections use the Third Legacy procedure. Any one who has served on our area committee is eligible to offer themselves for any of the area committee positions. The chair positions of P.I., C.P.C., Corrections, Hospital and Treatment, Grapevine and Literature are nominated by their district. Our delegate always visits the districts to give a report after each Conference. We have an 800 phone number in all the state directories, which receives around 250 calls per month, mostly people looking for a meeting but occasionally an alcoholic reaching out. Our Web site allows a person to look up a meeting anywhere in the state or check for upcoming events. Area 73 is currently struggling with problems like: keeping personalities out of A.A. service work; sloth and procrastination; ego and self-centeredness. I believe it was this way when Area 73 was formed and I believe it will be this way 100 years from now. I believe there will be an Area 73 one hundred years from now because I believe in alcoholism and I believe in God and I believe that we are progressing in Area 73. Come by sometime and trudge the road with us. God bless you all. — *Jerry Moore*.

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has 950 active groups served by 32 districts. District 10 is an at-large district that serves all Spanish-speaking groups. We have our own translation equipment. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies per year. An annual delegates workshop is held to create a balanced "informed group conscience" to carry to the General Service Conference. Past delegates continue to provide a "traveling G.S.R. school" for anyone that requests it. They also hold a G.S.R. school at the first agenda planning meeting of each year. Southern Wisconsin actively carries the A.A. message into correctional facilities, utilizing our "Rainbow Can" donations to purchase Conference-approved A.A. literature and our "Count on Us" program to provide hundreds of Grapevine subscriptions for the inside meetings. We, along with Area 74 (Northern Wisconsin and the UP of Michigan), hold an annual Corrections conference to coordinate BTG and volunteer efforts between Area 74 and Area 75. Our Third Annual Unity Conference will be held in July. This joint effort focuses on sharing information between Areas 74 and 75, with the ongoing theme of "Recovery, Unity and Service." This conference is held in addition to our long-standing Area 75 spring and fall conferences. Our alternate delegate is now funded to attend the Delegates/Past Delegates Conference. Our P.I. chairperson launched our Web site this year. My personal goals for this rotation are to bring the "dark districts" back into our service structure and to help the groups provide accurate information to G.S.O. to update our directories. — *Jo McLaughlin*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the question under the category "Pre-Conference" which reads, "Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate and timely, () Yes () No" be replaced with the following two questions:

a) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate?
() Yes () No

b) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. timely?
() Yes () No

- The committee also suggested that the parenthetical explanation "(e.g. schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.)" be added to the sentence for item 7, which would then read:

"If you have suggestions for improving the Conference (e.g., schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.), please list them here:"

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the updates suggested by the trustees' Archives Committee to be included in the next reprint of the Archives Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider additional items in the "Mission Statement" and in the "Calendar of Holdings" of the Workbook.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

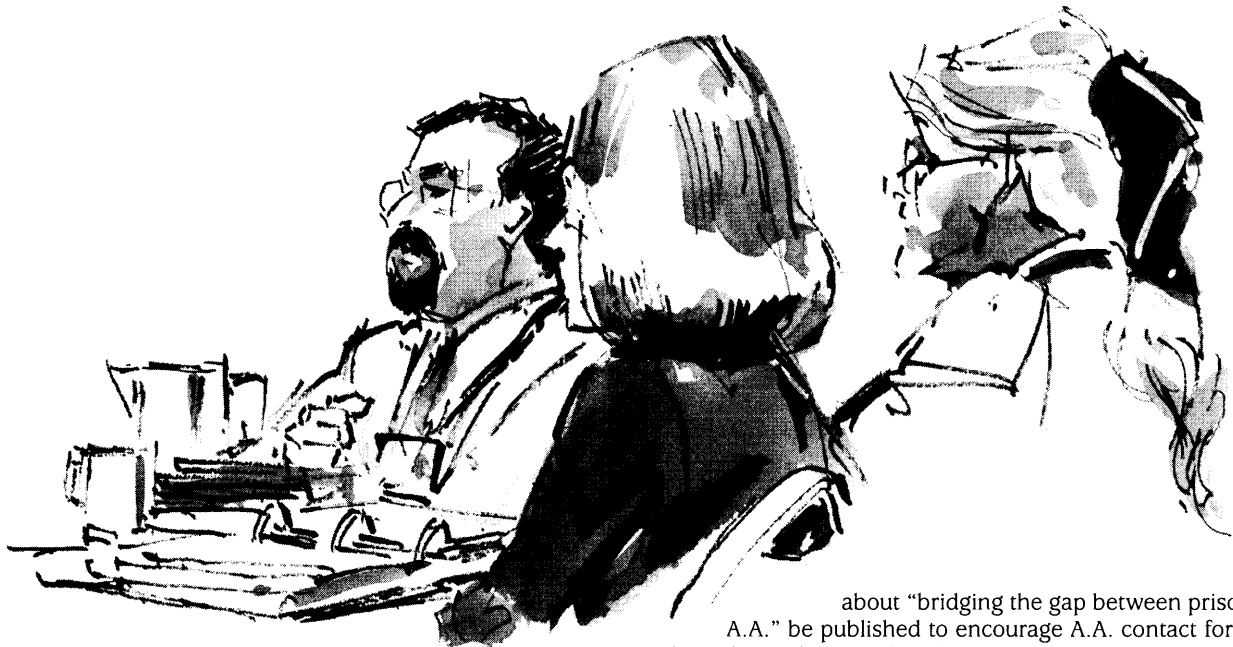
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee regarding new C.P.C. displays, and thanked the trustees' committee and the Publications Department for developing new tabletop displays for A.A. exhibits at national professional conferences.

The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider providing delegate areas with equal opportunities to obtain the current C.P.C. displays, once the new displays are available.

- The committee considered the request that the Workbook (service material) be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee; that changes to the workbook be approved by the trustees' committee; that any changes to the workbook be reported annually to the Conference Committee, and distributed as background material, and reaffirmed the sense of the 1999 C.P.C. committee that "...as service material the Kit and Workbook could be updated as often as shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Workbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee."

- The committee discussed ways of reaching a wider variety of professionals, and suggested that we: 1) continue to reach out

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



to nursing and medical schools; 2) consider assigning an A.A. "sponsor" to professionals or students who come to A.A. meetings, sitting with them and helping them understand the meeting as it progresses; 3) make more frequent use of "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous;" 4) carry the message through calls or personal contacts to professionals, in addition to mailings; 5) cooperate with other service committees to reach professionals in all fields.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities reconsider development of a Conference-approved pamphlet similar to the local flyers entitled "So the Court Sent You to A.A. and You Hate the Idea," and that the committee's secretary seek wider input from the delegate areas on the need for such a pamphlet.

- The committee requested that the secretary convey their concerns regarding certain editorial corrections to the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to the secretary to the trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee accepted with appreciation the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' suggestion to combine the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook in a single three-ring binder format with the suggested title of "Correctional Facilities Kit;" and that the Workbook also be available as a separate item.

- The committee unanimously suggested that the pamphlet "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" (P-43) be added to the Correctional Facilities Kit.

- The committee reviewed the draft statement of purpose developed by the trustees' Committee for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and took no action.

- The committee reviewed the draft statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and requested that this topic be considered by the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities because the statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose is under review by another 2003 Conference committee.

- The committee also considered a request that a pamphlet

about "bridging the gap between prisons and A.A." be published to encourage A.A. contact for newly-released members, and took no action.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities gather examples of local A.A. pre-release brochures and/or forms and develop generic samples to be considered by the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for possible inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Committee and amended item 1 under the Scope to read "Reviews the A.A. World Services/General Service Board budget and financial reports" (it had read only the A.A. World Services budget).

- The committee reviewed the reporting of International Convention accounting on the 2002 financial statements and looked favorably on the balance sheet treatment (a separate column for an International Convention Fund). However, it felt that the footnote listing all prior conventions with profits and losses was too detailed. The committee indicated an abbreviated footnote was more appropriate, for example:

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the Balance Sheet represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include such items as site selection costs, deposits on facilities, and professional management expenses. Following established Policy, funds not needed for current operations reside in the Reserve Fund.

- The committee reviewed the draft of the "Simplified Reserve Fund" document forwarded by the trustees' Finance Committee.

- The committee then reviewed the current A.A. Finance Guidelines as well as the current version of *The A.A. Service Manual*, and felt those descriptions better fulfilled the intent of last year's committee for a simplified description of the Reserve Fund.

- The committee also suggested that the document forwarded by the trustees' Finance Committee be available if a request for more detailed information is requested by a member of the Fellowship.

- After considerable discussion on the topic of self-support, the committee feels that sponsorship is the key. The committee urges the delegates to discuss financial responsibility within their areas.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for Grapevine items to be produced in the year 2004 or later and unanimously agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the following items to be developed: Victor E. posters in English, French, and Spanish, celebrating the A.A. Grapevine's 60th anniversary, and a Spanish-language edition of *The Best of Bill*.

- By a substantial majority, the committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board suggestions that the following items be developed: French, Spanish, and English-language editions of a pocket-sized soft-cover collection of Grapevine stories focusing on A.A.'s Responsibility Declaration, titled *I Am Responsible*; and a new Spanish-language audio CD of stories previously published in La Viña.

- The committee expressed deep concern about information from the Grapevine Board received during the committee meeting that the board had failed to observe the 1993 Conference Advisory Action stating: "The Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."

Following lengthy discussion, the committee strongly suggests that the Grapevine Corporate Board:

1. Establish a one-year moratorium on initiating the sale of Grapevine items, including the Grapevine magazine, to any enterprise not identified as an A.A. entity.
2. Outline the sequence of events, meetings and decisions, as well as the rationale, that led to the Grapevine magazine being sold through an enterprise not identified as an A.A. entity.
3. Provide a full report on the history of the 1993 Advisory Action, including the concerns that led to that Action, as well as the meaning and intent of that Action.
4. Provide to the committee an interim report on the three points above no later than September 30, 2003, followed by a final report to be sent as background to the 2004 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.

- The committee also strongly suggests that the Grapevine Corporate Board carefully review Conference Advisory Actions prior to implementing a practice or policy.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed data collecting of personal information of A.A. members who attend conventions and strongly suggested that, in order to protect A.A.'s principle of anonymity, G.S.O. direct hotels contracted for Regional Forums and International Conventions not to use the list of A.A. hotel guests in conjunction with the words "Alcoholics Anonymous" or "A.A." for any mailing lists including outside marketing campaigns.

- The committee discussed ways to improve and encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested:

Continue providing simultaneous translations into Spanish and/or French to increase participation of Spanish- and French-speaking A.A. members.

Have presentations at Forums in Spanish and French as well as English.

Seek better ways to encourage members, groups, districts and areas in organizing various means of transportation to Regional/Special Forums.

Encourage attendees to share their Forum experience more widely with other members, (e.g. articles in local newsletters, reports at group conscience or business meetings, etc.).

LITERATURE

- The committee encourages full Conference discussion of the A.A. World Services Board's "intent to place the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the G.S.O. Web site."

- After lengthy discussion, the committee considered the request to edit the following Fourth Edition Big Book stories to restore their Third Edition Big Book content: "The Housewife Who Drank At Home," "Me An Alcoholic?," "Another Chance" and "Freedom From Bondage," and agreed to accept the Fourth Edition Big Book editorial changes and agreed to take no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the request to form a secondary General Service Conference Committee to review all aspects of G.S.O. Internet usage and make recommendations for additions, changes and/or improvements, and agreed there was no widely expressed need for such a committee.

- The committee discussed the request to establish an ad hoc committee of trustees, delegates and staff to outline the means and criteria for examining material submitted for Conference approval and took no action.

- The committee discussed the request to form a Conference Committee on Special Needs and agreed that Special Needs in the Fellowship are currently being met by the existing services provided by A.A. World Services and the General Service Office.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook. They suggested that the pamphlets "Is A.A. for Me?" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic" be added to the Kit.

- The committee also considered the request that the Workbook (service material) be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee; that changes to the Workbook be approved by the trustees' committee; that any changes to the Workbook be reported annually to the Conference Committee, and distributed as background material and took no action.

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "Reach Out" P.S.A.

- The committee requested that a copy of the updated version of the Compilation Video of PSAs (VS-28) be mailed to all area P.I. Committee chairs.

- The committee suggested that television public service announcement inventory item #TV-17 ("Female" and "Information") be removed from inventory. Inventory item #TV-17 has the lowest circulation of all current P.S.A.s.

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered that Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. on page S23 be returned to the text on pages S45-49 in the 1991-1992 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* that includes the sections "How Elected," "What is an A.A. Group," "How the A.A. Group Fits into the Structure of the Fellowship," "The A.A. Group – the Final Voice of the Fellowship," "Why Do We Need Service Entities Other Than the A.A. Group," "How Much Organization Should an A.A. Group Have?" and "The Home Group," and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the updated chart of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. to replace the chart on page S80 and other editorial updates to include language on the Grapevine Representative (GvR), La Viña Representative (RLV) and La Viña.
- The committee considered the request that the trustees conduct an audit of all reported Conference Advisory Actions to ensure that they have been and will be reported accurately and took no action.
- The committee discussed the purpose and usefulness of the Eastern and Western, Canada A.A. Directories, and International A.A. Directory and agreed that the directories continue to be useful and serve the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee expressed appreciation for the work of the trustees' Committee and the Publications Department on combining the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit, and unanimously requested that:

The Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit be available as a single unit in a 3-ring binder, with the suggested title "Treatment Facilities Kit";

The reformatted soft-cover Treatment Facilities Workbook, bound in 8 ½ X 11 format and 3-hole punched be included in the Kit; and, that the reformatted Workbook also be available as a separate item.

- The committee requested that the combined Treatment Facilities Kit continue to be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, the trustees' Committee review changes in content, and the Conference Committee continue to be advised of any changes.
- The committee also reviewed the contents of the reformatted Treatment Facilities Kit, and suggested streamlining the divider tabs, as well as reducing the pamphlets and service material to be included.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/Canada.
- The committee discussed various ways to encourage qualified and willing nonalcoholic "friends of the Fellowship" to serve as Class A trustees, including posting vacancy announcements in area, district and intergroup newsletters, as well as on local A.A. Web sites. The committee also suggested that A.A. members work closely with potential candidates to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous and the role and responsibilities of Class A trustees.

- The committee reviewed a request that the Conference examine the role and responsibilities of regional trustees, and develop a means for their selection to provide substantially more input from the areas within a given region. Following a lengthy discussion on the roles and responsibilities of regional trustees, the committee unanimously agreed that no changes to the current procedures be made.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- That changes to the Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit shall be reported annually to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities and distributed as background material. The Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit will continue to be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.

LITERATURE

- That the following changes to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be approved:

1. On page 23, in the section "*What trusted servants (officers) do we need?*", the word "jobs" in the first sentence of the first paragraph be replaced with the word "service" and the word "jobs" in the first sentence of the third paragraph be replaced with "service positions."

2. The sentence "See the chart of *suggested group officers*," which introduces the Group Service Structure Chart on page 24 be replaced by the sentence "The chart below offers possibilities for service at the group level."

3. The sentence "Some groups have positions that do not appear on this chart such as greeter, archivist, special needs representative and liaison to meeting facility" be added immediately after the chart on page 24.

4. The reference to "Archives Representative" be deleted in the Group Service Structure Chart on page 24.

- That the Third Edition Big Book punctuation in "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" be restored based on the 1995 Conference Advisory Action: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices remain as is."

REPORT AND CHARTER

- To add the words "and a sponsor" to the sentence of the second bullet under the section titled "Qualifications" in Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. in *The A.A. Service Manual* to read: "Usually, prospective G.S.R.s have at least two years of continuous sobriety and a sponsor."

Jutta Matthews (Alabama/NW Florida), on the Conference Grapevine Committee, brought special necklaces, sporting bunches of grapes, for each member of the committee.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 2002 (with comparative totals for 2001)

	General Service Board of A.A.							
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2002	Consolidated 2001
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 659,370	\$ 862,286			\$ 1,081,905	\$ 226,124	\$ 2,829,685	\$3,396,375
Accounts and interest receivable	5,000	125,873			284,554	65,369	480,796	557,737
Intercompany balances	(760,526)	(1,517,953)		\$(205,469)	951,359	1,532,589	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,916,642	129,121	2,045,763	1,763,041
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					253,874	31,627	285,501	197,099
Investments - at fair value								
U.S. Treasury Notes and Bills due 2003/2012 (Cost: 2002 - \$10,219,376, 2001 - \$10,497,533)		10,856,724					10,856,724	10,897,817
Property and Equipment								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 2002 - \$3,058,249; 2001 - \$2,948,836)			\$410,990				410,990	520,403
Deferred charges and deposits	191,054				77,504	85,666	354,224	186,785
Prepaid conventions - 2005/2010/2015				205,469			205,469	140,487
Prepaid pension cost							-	1,596,107
Total Assets	<u>94,898</u>	<u>10,326,930</u>	<u>410,990</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>4,565,838</u>	<u>2,070,496</u>	<u>17,469,152</u>	<u>19,255,851</u>
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable	\$ 37,885				\$ 975,021	\$ 123,089	\$ 1,135,995	\$ 1,651,497
Accrued royalties					34,587		34,587	68,354
Deferred income								
Orders and subscriptions					87,333	1,528,222	1,615,555	1,604,113
Accrued postretirement health benefit		\$ 3,698,152					3,698,152	2,892,956
Accrued pension benefits		<u>\$ 1,267,255</u>					<u>1,267,255</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Liabilities	<u>37,885</u>	<u>4,965,407</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>1,096,941</u>	<u>1,651,311</u>	<u>7,751,544</u>	<u>6,216,920</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>5,361,523</u>	<u>410,990</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>3,468,897</u>	<u>419,185</u>	<u>9,717,608</u>	<u>13,038,931</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>94,898</u>	<u>10,326,930</u>	<u>410,990</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>4,565,838</u>	<u>2,070,496</u>	<u>17,469,152</u>	<u>19,255,851</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2002 (with comparative totals for 2001)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 2002	Consolidated 2001
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund		English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 10,798,951	\$ 2,304,946	\$ 70,084	\$ 13,173,981	\$ 13,875,742
Less: Discounts				313,034	16,627		329,661	328,912
Net Sales				10,485,917	2,288,319	70,084	12,844,320	13,546,830
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(4,027,626)	(424,522)	(35,788)	(4,487,936)	(4,551,379)
Royalties on books				(156,770)	-	-	(156,770)	(197,294)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(1,359,242)	(459,760)	(23,458)	(1,842,460)	(1,620,028)
Gross Profit from Literature				4,942,279	1,404,037	10,838	6,357,154	7,178,129
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 5,097,810						5,097,810	4,688,831
INVESTMENT INCOME	1,528	\$ 689,551		6,235	70,699	-	768,013	790,318
Total Income	5,099,338	689,551		4,948,514	1,474,736	10,838	12,222,977	12,657,278
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	4,531,575			1,531,079	1,085,379	114,653	7,262,686	7,163,943
Supporting services	2,650,139	3,668,558	\$ 109,413	1,452,350	401,154	-	8,281,614	4,919,458
Total Expenses	7,181,714	3,668,558	109,413	2,983,429	1,486,533	114,653	15,544,300	12,083,401
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,082,376)	(2,979,007)	(109,413)	1,965,085	(11,797)	(103,815)	(3,321,323)	573,877
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS								
GSB La Viña support	(103,815)			-	-	103,815	-	-
Other Transfer	2,186,191	(700,000)	-	(1,486,191)	-	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	(3,679,007)	(109,413)	478,894	(11,797)	-	(3,321,323)	573,877
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	9,040,530	520,403	2,990,003	430,982	-	13,038,931	12,465,054
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	5,361,523	410,990	3,468,897	419,185	-	9,717,608	13,038,931

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2002 (with comparative totals for 2001)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	2002 Total	2001 Total
Salaries	\$ 624,816	\$ 798,244	\$ 122,885	\$ 630	\$ 130,312	\$ 925,815	\$ 467,102	\$ 31,141	\$1,928,689	\$ 5,029,634	\$ 5,011,665
Payroll taxes	45,225	58,116	8,653		9,727	64,624	38,788	2,805	142,554	370,492	356,595
Health and group insurance	117,725	121,435	15,184		15,199	136,737	96,059	6,300	448,367	957,006	912,862
Retirement expense - funding	35,680	40,409	6,032		7,197	50,772	2,708		94,262	237,060	159,089
Other program printing	278,714	65,402	61,182	9,225	16,330	846			758	432,457	391,966
Mailing labor	138,482	3,009			11,823		7,769	7,651	882	161,847	153,040
Postage and express	273,111	82,098	42,618		32,634	11,427		91	35,859	485,607	474,916
Writers fees	4,818	77,351	8,780	1,687	4,258	41,689			504	139,087	110,306
Other literature assistance		207,261				104,260	186,806	7,557		207,261	237,469
Selling expenses										298,623	261,545
Professional fees								209	288,539	288,748	319,771
Contracted services	12,266	143,702	6,773	12,439	24,932	29,837	122,573	55,949	61,744	470,215	401,590
Occupancy	72,188	97,457	7,559		8,261	118,815	84,687		266,456	655,423	612,111
Telephone	16,353	13,997	2,522		1,796	17,927	13,024		45,661	111,280	131,163
Equipment maintenance						372			81,508	81,880	70,115
Furniture and equipment	1,139	75				6,964		1,123	81,649	90,950	99,602
Stationery and office supplies	68,240	10,895	12,482	2,098	12,833	4,161	32,932		92,292	235,933	220,831
Office service and expense	5,135	16,138	15,430	6,948	1,745	8,739	32,931	1,410	343,774	432,250	443,062
Travel, meals and accommodations	2,824	74,804	425,284	144,015	62,409	8,094			380,010	1,097,440	937,096
Bad debts								417	23,784	24,201	28,186
Mailing 4th edition to groups										-	241,405
Delegate fees			(121,063)	(106,353)						(227,416)	(112,212)
Total Operating Expenses	<u>1,696,716</u>	<u>1,810,393</u>	<u>614,321</u>	<u>70,689</u>	<u>339,456</u>	<u>1,531,079</u>	<u>1,085,379</u>	<u>114,653</u>	<u>4,317,292</u>	<u>11,579,978</u>	<u>11,462,173</u>
Postretirement health benefits									805,196	805,196	(64,885)
Retirement expense adjustment									2,863,362	2,863,362	(252,686)
Early retirement severance benefits									186,351	186,351	345,831
Depreciation									109,413	109,413	237,738
Conversion and restructuring charges											355,230
Total Expenses	<u>1,696,716</u>	<u>1,810,393</u>	<u>614,321</u>	<u>70,689</u>	<u>339,456</u>	<u>1,531,079</u>	<u>1,085,379</u>	<u>114,653</u>	<u>8,281,614</u>	<u>15,544,300</u>	<u>12,083,401</u>
Allocation of supporting services to activities	<u>2,406,817</u>	<u>2,568,072</u>	<u>871,424</u>	<u>100,273</u>	<u>481,524</u>	<u>1,452,350</u>	<u>401,154</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(8,281,614)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Allocated Expenses	<u>4,103,533</u>	<u>4,378,465</u>	<u>1,485,745</u>	<u>170,962</u>	<u>820,980</u>	<u>2,983,429</u>	<u>1,486,533</u>	<u>114,653</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>15,544,300</u>	<u>12,083,401</u>
Services	\$4,103,533	\$4,378,465	\$1,485,745	\$170,962	\$820,980					\$ 10,959,685	\$ 7,012,692
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 2,983,429				2,983,429	3,134,208
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-		\$1,486,533	\$114,653		1,601,186	1,936,501
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2001	<u>\$2,695,084</u>	<u>\$2,919,779</u>	<u>\$ 984,970</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>\$412,859</u>	<u>\$3,134,208</u>	<u>\$1,808,923</u>	<u>\$127,578</u>			

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
Year Ended December 31, 2002
(with comparative totals for 2001)

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2002</u>	<u>2001</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ (3,321,323)	\$ 573,877
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(240,290)	(178,176)
Amortization of bond premiums	10,002	16,672
Depreciation	109,413	237,738
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	76,941	(109,267)
Inventories	(371,124)	(220,105)
Deferred charges and other assets	(232,421)	(53,260)
Accounts and accruals payable	(549,269)	841,250
Deferred income	11,442	55,607
Accrued pension benefits	2,863,362	(252,686)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	805,196	(64,885)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>(838,071)</u>	<u>846,765</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Proceeds from sales of investments	4,241,020	2,500,000
Purchases of investments	(3,969,639)	(4,514,204)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>271,381</u>	<u>(2,014,204)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	(566,690)	(1,167,439)
Cash, beginning of year	<u>3,396,375</u>	<u>4,563,814</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>2,829,685</u></u>	<u><u>3,396,375</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

February 27, 2003

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2002 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2001 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated February 26, 2002, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2002 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 2002**

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of International A.A. Conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the consolidated statement of financial position represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include site selection expenses, deposits on facilities and professional convention management expenses.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all Conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$755,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund. Results by convention are as follows:

2000	Minneapolis	\$ 997,580
1995	San Diego	(632,027)
1990	Seattle	181,029
1985	Montreal	315,940
1980	New Orleans	(202,950)
1975	Denver	82,991
1970	Miami	15,809
1965	Toronto	12,948
1960	Long Beach	(456)
1955	St. Louis	(15,994)
		<u>\$754,870</u>

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit

pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements. Amounts reported by A.A. World Services include Services Mondiaux Des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc., "S.M.A.A.", a controlled non-profit Canadian corporation.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2002 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,105,871	\$ 48,042	\$1,817,623
Furniture	8 Years	689,598		689,598
Computer - hardware	5 Years	402,099	61,371	279,357
- software	5 Years	271,671		271,671
		<u>3,469,239</u>	<u>109,413</u>	<u>3,058,249</u>

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 2002 and 2001 is comprised of the following:

	2002	2001
Interest	\$532,789	\$616,801
Realized gains on redemptions	3,226	859
Change in unrealized appreciation	237,064	177,317
Investment expenses	(5,066)	(4,659)
	<u>768,013</u>	<u>790,318</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services." Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 4-5-9 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French-speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives, loners and overseas services and the international convention staff assignment.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and other miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2002:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 10,384,417
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	14,345,128
Funded status	<u>(3,960,711)</u>

Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 1,267,255</u>
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The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized pension benefit liability is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87, as well as unrecognized actuarial losses.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	6.75%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.5%

A discount rate of 7.5% was used in the prior year.

Benefit cost	\$3,057,733
Employers' contributions	\$ 194,371
Benefits paid	\$ 751,107

The benefit cost for 2002 included \$1,156,159 for the one-time pension cost of the early retirement program (described below), and \$1,267,255 to recognize the excess of the accumulated benefit obligation over the plan assets.

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 194,371
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>2,863,362</u>
	<u>3,057,733</u>

Plan assets at December 31, 2002 were composed as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 172,527
Common stocks	4,901,399
Government bonds	2,918,150
Corporate and other bonds	<u>2,392,341</u>
	<u>10,384,417</u>

Employees of S.M.A.A. in Canada participate in a separate retirement plan under which 5% of their annual salaries are contributed by that Organization.

Effective September 4, 2001 the General Service Board approved an early retirement "window" for A.A.W.S. and General Service Board employees. Employees age 55 or older with combined age and service of 70 or more are eligible. Participating employees receive a higher pension benefit by adding five years of age up to age 65, and a temporary Social Security supplement up to age 62. Severance pay was also provided based on years of service, and was borne by the General Service Board.

The program was voluntary. The expiration date of the window was March 29, 2002.

Severance benefits under this program of \$186,351 and \$345,831 were incurred in 2002 and 2001 respectively.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2002, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

In addition to the above lease commitments, S.M.A.A. was subject to a lease for office space in Montreal, Canada. The lease is effective through December 31, 2004. The current rent for 2002 was \$24,897, with annual escalations of 3%.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2002 is \$3,466,000.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 6.75% (7.5% in 2001) has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2002:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$3,698,152
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 984,217</u>
Benefits paid	\$ 179,021

The excess of cost of benefits over the payments for benefits of \$805,196 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Note 7 Conversion and Restructuring Charges: During 2001, the A.A. Grapevine incurred one-time charges of \$355,230 in connection with the restructuring of the Grapevine office and the outsourcing of certain fulfillment functions. Inasmuch as these costs are not expected to recur, this expense has been shown as a nonoperating item on the consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C).

The Budget Highlights

2003 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2003 sales budget of \$10,443,300 is approximately \$350,000 less than the 2002 actual results as a direct result of the leveling off of sales of the 4th edition Big Book. It does however include estimated sales of the Anthology of stories dropped from the first three editions, "Experience, Strength and Hope." Other unit sales are approximately even. Net sales after discounts allowed are projected at \$10,160,000.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately \$200,000 greater than 2002, again allowing for a mix of costs resulting from the expected leveling of 4th edition sales, introduction of the "Anthology," and some inflationary adjustments. Royalties are budgeted at \$160,000.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted less than 2002. In addition to the expected leveling of 4th edition sales noted previously, the primary reason for the reduction is the closing of the SMAA office in Montreal. Effective January 1, 2003 the French-speaking A.A. members are being serviced from G.S.O. New York through existing facilities and fulfillment channels.

Gross profit from literature is budgeted at \$4,606,000, approximately \$336,000 less than 2002. As noted last year, it is important to remember that the introductory price of the 4th edition was set at \$5.00 vs. \$6.00, thereby allowing reduced revenue on this new product, and we still feel the effect of the reduced revenue effort.

Contributions for 2003 have been budgeted at \$5,125,000. The year 2002 saw the fifth year in a row that contributions received have exceeded the prior year. During 2002, contributions from groups and individuals of \$4,990,200 were \$196,000 (4%) greater than budgeted and \$301,000 (6.5%) greater than last year. For 2002, contributions had been budgeted to increase by about 2%. During the year, we were obligated to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meetings International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O., therefore total contributions of \$5,097,800 are reflected on our financial statements and include approximately \$107,500 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$9,735,940, approximately 2% more than the 2002 budget.

Total Operating Expenses for 2003 have been budgeted at \$10,626,300, approximately \$460,000, 4.5% higher than 2002 but only \$309,000 or 3% more than the 2002 budget. This just about levels out last year's small increase in budgeted expenses which offset the prior year's larger than usual increase and includes expenditures to help carry the message worldwide as well as at home.

For 2003 G.S.O. has budgeted excess of expenses over revenue of \$890,345. This compares with the \$780,450 loss budgeted for 2002. This compares with a \$381,979 net income for 2001, a \$983,211 net income for 2000, \$877,700 in 1999, \$139,600 in 1998, a \$245,000 loss for 1997, \$1,264,000 loss for 1996, a \$1,147,000 loss for 1995. The three years of losses, followed by succeeding profits, have resulted in a Reserve Fund balance of 11.2 months at 12/31/2002. In fact the better than expected results for 2002 will allow the Reserve Fund to inch up just a bit.

2003 Grapevine Budget

The 2003 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation 115,000 approximately 500 copies less than the 2002 budget and just slightly less than the 2002 paid circulation number of 115,753. Circulation for 2001 was 115,034, 115,734 in 2000, 116,000 in 1999 and 117,300 in 1998.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,757,800 is expected, about \$6,000 more than 2002. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$618,000, approximately \$81,000 higher than 2002. The increase in the "other items" category anticipates sales of new products.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,566,000 is budgeted compared to \$1,404,000 achieved for 2002 and the 2002 budget of \$1,356,300.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2003 are budgeted at \$1,630,200, approximately \$144,000 more than the 2002 actual of \$1,486,500.

Net Income: For 2003 the Grapevine anticipated a slight profit of \$4,358. This compares with a 2002 budgeted profit of \$188 and an actual loss of \$9,500 from operations. Total loss of \$11,797 included the Grapevine expenses associated with SMAA in Montreal.

2003 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The Board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the Spanish magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but funded by the General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2003 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$10,693, compared with a \$10,838 gross profit for 2002. Circulation for 2003 is estimated at 9,500, slightly higher than the 2002 average of 8,999. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$136,502 for 2003, compared with \$114,653 in 2002, \$127,578 in 2001, and \$62,137 in 2000. The 2003 budget projects a net loss of \$125,809 compared with a loss of \$103,815 in 2002, a \$119,385 loss for 2001 and a 2001 budgeted loss of \$63,116.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$668,100 as follows: \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999, \$49,570 in 2000, \$119,385 in 2001, and \$103,815 in 2002.

The General Service Office 2003 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	<u>2002 Budget</u>	<u>2002 Actual</u>	<u>2003 Budget</u>
GROSS SALES	\$9,706,295	\$10,798,951	\$10,443,300
Discounts allowed	250,000	313,034	282,600
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,456,295	10,485,917	10,160,700
 Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,506,125	4,027,626	4,242,200
Royalties	135,000	156,770	160,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	5,815,170	6,301,521	5,758,500
 DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,074,296	1,359,242	1,152,060
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	4,740,874	4,942,279	4,606,440
Contributions Received	4,794,000	5,097,810	5,125,000
Interest Income	2,000	7,763	4,500
<u>Total Revenue</u>	9,536,874	10,047,852	9,735,940
 OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	4,515,000	4,360,340	4,698,000
Payroll taxes	315,700	314,786	324,000
Insurance	871,600	811,034	888,000
Retirement expense	177,800	232,901	239,800
Other program printing	423,750	432,457	418,900
Mailing, labor, etc.	153,700	154,196	163,700
Postage & express	478,499	477,747	478,600
Writers' fees	199,000	139,087	141,500
Other literature assist	208,000	207,261	306,060
Selling expenses	117,800	104,260	107,500
Professional fees	216,000	260,841	225,000
Contracted services	322,550	291,693	329,100
Occupancy	531,200	546,361	564,600
Telephone	115,500	94,947	109,200
Equipment maintenance	93,600	81,880	102,750
Furniture & equipment	54,000	74,487	56,500
Stationery & office expense	190,550	203,001	218,600
Office service & expense	349,275	376,817	384,275
Travel, meals, & accommodations	848,800	810,495	860,200
Bad debts	10,000	4,202	10,000
Early retirement severance	125,000	186,350	— 0 —
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	10,317,324	10,165,143	10,626,285
 INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>(780,450)</u>	<u>(117,291)</u>	<u>(890,345)</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2003 BUDGET

	ENGLISH			SPANISH		
	2002 Budget	2002 Actual	2003 Budget	2002 Budget	2002 Actual	2003 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>115,500</u>	<u>115,753</u>	<u>115,000</u>	<u>9,000</u>	<u>8,999</u>	<u>9,500</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,704,780	\$1,710,450	\$1,706,160	\$65,977	\$66,514	\$69,169
Single copies and back issues	50,000	40,853	51,600	9,000	3,570	9,000
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,754,780</u>	<u>1,751,303</u>	<u>1,757,760</u>	<u>74,977</u>	<u>70,084</u>	<u>78,169</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>745,004</u>	<u>684,495</u>	<u>578,200</u>	<u>63,390</u>	<u>59,246</u>	<u>67,476</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,009,776</u>	<u>1,066,808</u>	<u>1,179,560</u>	<u>11,587</u>	<u>10,838</u>	<u>10,693</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	510,575	537,016	617,979			
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>164,019</u>	<u>199,787</u>	<u>231,546</u>			
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>346,556</u>	<u>337,229</u>	<u>386,433</u>			
Total Gross Profit	<u>1,356,332</u>	<u>1,404,037</u>	<u>1,565,993</u>			
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	250,562	255,326	279,000	49,000	55,949	68,000
Payroll taxes and benefits	65,030	64,345	67,444	10,013		
Occupancy costs	63,300	63,462	68,052	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	21,284	19,388	23,500	2,000	1,000	2,000
Product development	12,000	8,259	20,000	0	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>412,176</u>	<u>410,780</u>	<u>457,996</u>	<u>61,013</u>	<u>56,949</u>	<u>70,000</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	375,738	382,829	421,978	31,065	31,141	32,616
Payroll taxes and benefits	135,495	132,387	127,261	9,326	9,105	8,726
Kable fulfillment	120,439	114,314	123,000	17,400	7,651	8,100
Occupancy costs	63,600	61,933	67,752	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	36,364	46,475	43,180	0	0	0
Subscriber services	11,700	5,009	2,000	0	0	0
Selling expense-regular	120,000	153,022	125,000	6,000	7,557	13,000
-GvR program	27,957	28,775	50,000	0	0	0
Postage	16,320	7,769	9,000	0	90	0
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>907,613</u>	<u>932,513</u>	<u>969,171</u>	<u>63,791</u>	<u>55,544</u>	<u>62,442</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
One-time charges	0	0	0	0	0	0
Indexing Project	0	0	0			
Leasehold Improvements	0	0	0			
Insurance	5,149	4,157	4,920	360	410	360
Professional fees	27,300	27,698	59,508	600	210	600
Meetings and conferences	49,106	59,528	65,000	0	0	0
Furniture and equipment	10,000	15,340	40,000	0	1,123	2,500
Canadian exchange and other	10,000	9,221	10,000	0	0	0
Bank service charges	3,600	7,714	3,600	0	0	0
Bad debts	15,000	19,582	20,000	600	417	600
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>120,155</u>	<u>143,240</u>	<u>203,028</u>	<u>1,560</u>	<u>2,163</u>	<u>4,060</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,439,944</u>	<u>1,486,533</u>	<u>1,630,195</u>	<u>126,364</u>	<u>114,653</u>	<u>136,502</u>
Interest earned	83,800	70,699	68,560			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>188</u>	<u>(11,797)</u>	<u>4,358</u>	<u>(114,777)</u>	<u>(103,815)</u>	<u>(125,809)</u>

2002 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS	SPECIAL MEETINGS	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	401	223	55.6%	37,287.32	7,859	\$4.73	362.65	40.00	1,469.97	20.00	\$39,179.94	\$4.99
2.	Alaska	190	84	44.2	14,205.20	3,463	4.10	806.30		85.00	9.79	\$15,106.29	\$4.36
3.	Arizona	817	374	45.7	84,768.35	19,117	4.43	5,127.73	20.00	2,590.09	354.84	\$92,861.01	\$4.86
4.	Arkansas California	240	140	58.2	15,957.94	4,452	3.57	225.00	0.00	1,165.79	25.00	\$17,373.73	\$3.90
5.	Southern	1,122	383	34.0	92,622.36	39,471	2.34	12,591.01	0.00	2,989.62	1,052.54	\$109,255.53	\$2.77
6.	N. Coastal	1,716	1,046	60.9	235,618.19	50,930	4.63	13,538.23	50.00	3,495.37	996.45	\$253,698.24	\$4.98
7.	N. Interior	749	374	49.8	66,023.82	20,537	3.21	2,082.04	91.00	1,212.00	616.75	\$70,025.61	\$3.41
8.	San Diego/Imp.	784	352	44.8	68,497.86	23,770	2.88	10,423.24	2,045.00	1,721.83	265.83	\$82,953.76	\$3.49
9.	Mid-South.	1,819	760	41.8	148,433.71	58,535	2.54	4,955.70	150.00	4,586.80	1,485.89	\$159,612.10	\$2.73
10.	Colorado	623	362	58.1	71,726.01	14,584	4.91	5,943.39	0.00	21,281.68	327.18	\$99,278.26	\$6.81
11.	Connecticut	1,475	588	39.8	87,562.85	35,591	2.46	5,400.99	299.00	12,014.00	815.00	\$106,091.84	\$2.98
12.	Delaware	199	128	64.2	29,921.30	3,207	9.33	106.30		2,000.00		\$32,027.60	\$9.99
13.	D.C. Florida	473	224	47.3	46,700.16	15,798	2.96	262.90	25.00	0.00		\$46,988.06	\$2.97
14.	North	706	362	51.2	70,654.57	15,835	4.45	2,859.40	550.00	28,104.11	20.10	\$102,188.18	\$6.45
15.	South/	1,617	849	52.5	166,405.83	36,236	4.59	13,377.25	1,225.00	63,490.87	1,499.20	\$245,998.15	\$6.79
16.	Georgia	689	443	64.3	78,005.83	15,702	4.97	1,943.49	662.00	968.02	87.86	\$81,667.20	\$5.20
17.	Hawaii	291	165	56.6	30,659.32	5,203	5.88	1,623.58		723.71	30.00	\$33,036.61	\$6.35
18.	Idaho Illinois	195	93	47.7	13,085.18	3,537	3.69	221.62		1,068.55	0.00	\$14,375.35	\$4.06
19.	Chicago	1,190	313	26.3	63,128.72	29,333	2.14	1,570.69	320.00	5,953.18	231.30	\$71,203.89	\$2.43
20.	North	1,089	436	40.0	58,686.43	22,041	2.65	3,631.10	150.00	42,567.09	125.00	\$112,610.54	\$5.11
21.	South Indiana	440	179	40.6	24,298.48	7,519	3.22	2,150.96		2,158.10	633.80	\$29,241.34	\$3.89
22.	North	642	278	43.3	36,592.86	9,296	3.94	1,346.30	120.00	3,035.88	0.00	\$41,095.04	\$4.42
23.	South	566	269	47.5	35,356.60	10,674	3.31	320.68	0.00	5,882.98	272.98	\$41,833.24	\$3.92
24.	Iowa	643	290	45.1	37,309.72	13,361	2.78	316.65	0.00	556.00	0.00	\$38,182.37	\$2.86
25.	Kansas	369	187	50.7	27,950.94	9,420	2.96	513.00	100.00	3,751.68	19.00	\$32,334.62	\$3.43
26.	Kentucky	655	305	46.5	63,751.53	10,453	6.10	1,962.97		1,489.94	209.80	\$67,414.24	\$6.45
27.	Louisiana	550	181	32.8	32,513.77	11,588	2.80	600.30	25.00	1,462.26		\$34,601.33	\$2.99
28.	Maine	454	149	32.7	17,138.40	7,677	2.22	2,463.11	0.00	6,651.08		\$26,252.59	\$3.42
29.	Maryland Massachusetts	920	398	43.2	74,066.57	14,784	5.00	6,159.40	50.00	38.06	85.00	\$80,399.03	\$5.44
30.	East	1,448	516	35.5	108,374.15	49,188	2.19	5,412.58	85.00	536.11	633.00	\$115,040.84	\$2.34
31.	West Michigan	252	144	57.0	19,366.79	4,727	4.09	932.86	2,000.00	86.00	0.00	\$22,385.65	\$4.74
32.	Central	576	263	45.6	43,186.93	13,582	3.18	4,176.12	310.00	1,961.42		\$49,634.47	\$3.65
33.	Southeast	740	303	40.8	67,139.33	18,292	3.67	1,074.00	200.00	1,547.37	0.00	\$69,960.70	\$3.82
34.	West Minnesota	481	219	45.4	42,525.07	10,524	4.03	2,187.82	500.00	1,105.00		\$46,317.89	\$4.40
35.	North	549	245	44.6	24,263.61	8,344	2.90	1,477.07	0.00	0.00	0.00	\$25,740.68	\$3.08
36.	South	959	423	44.1	61,619.29	22,431	2.75	1,993.35	25.00	884.50	200.91	\$64,723.05	\$2.89
37.	Mississippi Missouri	237	93	39.2	13,362.53	4,526	2.95	1,569.95		0.00		\$14,932.48	\$3.30
38.	East	529	267	50.4	49,309.49	8,871	5.56	5,983.13		4,894.16	116.49	\$60,303.27	\$6.80
39.	West	209	109	52.1	18,437.69	6,228	2.96	287.95	50.00			\$18,775.64	\$3.01
40.	Montana	279	126	45.1	16,416.31	4,645	3.53	153.65		1,335.00	0.00	\$17,904.96	\$3.85
41.	Nebraska	645	314	48.6	48,217.28	14,215	3.38	791.15		10,130.00	0.00	\$59,138.43	\$4.16
42.	Nevada	461	188	40.8	26,022.27	10,556	2.46	1,139.80	0.00	1,170.52	61.94	\$28,394.53	\$2.69
43.	New Hampshire New Jersey	562	237	42.2	33,713.65	10,037	3.36	1,424.15	0.00	1,275.67	73.81	\$36,487.28	\$3.64
44.	North	1,257	493	39.2	85,487.42	31,362	2.72	3,910.20	1,150.00	1,406.56	175.00	\$92,129.18	\$2.94
45.	South	505	261	51.7	56,661.05	8,670	6.54	2,998.63	1,000.00	100.00	732.00	\$61,491.68	\$7.09
46.	New Mexico New York	309	168	54.3	30,102.53	5,843	5.14	735.85	53.00	138.16	90.00	\$31,119.54	\$5.33
47.	Central	693	259	37.3	45,175.42	11,122	4.05	2,744.26	1,610.00	5,668.88	160.12	\$55,358.68	\$4.98
48.	H.M./B.	737	285	38.7	30,821.24	11,460	2.69	1,534.06	25.00	2,556.25	185.00	\$35,121.55	\$3.06
49.	Southeast	1,763	738	41.8	208,195.51	57,368	3.63	8,208.48	3,660.00	1,600.00	4,883.76	\$226,547.75	\$3.95
50.	West	323	103	31.8	12,262.40	5,998	2.03	4,233.65	325.00	1,312.00	0.00	\$18,133.05	\$3.02
51.	N. Carolina	883	458	51.8	95,593.95	14,648	6.52	1,511.14	205.00	1,744.90	31.50	\$99,086.49	\$6.76
52.	North Dakota Ohio	152	64	42.0	9,736.11	3,047	3.19	75.00		1,272.58		\$11,083.69	\$3.64
53.	Cent. & S.E.	623	222	35.6	29,105.37	9,388	3.10	687.06	125.00	262.00	163.00	\$30,342.43	\$3.23
54.	Northeast	1,395	324	23.2	41,080.63	22,919	1.78	1,049.15	580.58	1,357.19	60.00	\$44,127.55	\$1.93
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	275	106	38.4	12,343.42	4,100	3.00	63.70		3,000.00	50.00	\$15,457.12	\$3.77
56.	S.W. Ohio	538	226	41.9	38,154.65	11,018	3.45	1,276.50		1,543.20		\$40,974.35	\$3.72
57.	Oklahoma	396	195	49.1	32,572.39	6,791	4.79	2,544.78	65.00	1,156.56	146.25	\$36,484.98	\$5.37
58.	Oregon	841	393	46.7	57,003.81	16,618	3.42	2,193.90	0.00	2,079.97	25.00	\$61,302.68	\$3.69

	Pennsylvania												
59.	East	1,390	722	51.9	142,285.52	32,039	4.43	3,408.80	10.00	7,329.65	539.45	\$153,573.42	\$4.79
60.	West	785	398	50.7	53,160.25	11,092	4.78	3,200.35	115.00	8,585.48	149.00	\$65,210.08	\$5.88
61.	Rhode Island	246	116	47.1	19,157.30	5,089	3.75	1,308.41	500.00	5,836.69		\$26,802.40	\$5.27
62.	South Carolina	310	181	58.3	40,084.31	7,033	5.69	255.00		4,267.71		\$44,607.02	\$6.34
63.	South Dakota	159	56	35.2	6,315.73	3,742	1.68	80.50		741.30		\$7,137.53	\$1.91
64.	Tennessee	466	233	49.9	43,522.24	11,109	3.92	1,778.52	1,000.00	2,516.73	0.00	\$48,817.49	\$4.39
	Texas												
65.	Northeast	441	199	45.0	56,843.40	18,411	3.09	1,868.60	127.00	6,932.35	541.00	\$66,312.35	\$3.60
66.	Northwest	219	74	33.7	16,506.60	5,347	3.08	379.65	500.00	1,722.72	44.10	\$19,153.07	\$3.58
67.	Southeast	520	234	45.0	44,207.40	15,371	2.87	1,522.30		1,007.91	0.00	\$46,737.61	\$3.04
68.	Southwest	487	200	41.0	39,167.34	11,619	3.36	930.00		2,273.70		\$42,371.04	\$3.65
69.	Utah	276	152	55.0	24,322.45	5,713	4.26	1,798.24		125.00	484.64	\$26,730.33	\$4.68
70.	Vermont	245	126	51.3	14,720.91	4,583	3.21	4,424.67	200.00	1,190.00	25.50	\$20,561.08	\$4.49
71.	Virginia	1,136	600	52.7	110,770.63	21,663	5.10	8,663.45	210.00	4,762.10	336.60	\$124,742.78	\$5.76
72.	Western Washington	1,168	538	46.1	97,949.36	25,287	3.86	4,656.48	50.00	10,038.94	19.00	\$112,713.78	\$4.46
73.	West Virginia	299	137	45.8	12,175.93	3,489	3.49	330.30	0.00	178.26	50.00	\$12,734.49	\$3.65
	Wisconsin												
74.	N. Wis./Upper	653	272	41.7	27,397.78	10,761	2.54	611.00	225.00	36.07	60.00	\$28,329.85	\$2.63
	Pen. Mich.												
75.	South	948	450	47.5	49,727.75	18,154	2.74	857.53		3,905.21	69.72	\$54,560.21	\$3.01
76.	Wyoming	111	56	50.5	9,448.13	1,956	4.82	56.00		785.05		\$10,289.18	\$5.26
77.	Puerto Rico	131	67	51.1	5,791.66	1,544	3.75	301.10		205.53		\$6,298.29	\$4.08
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	495	225	45.5	34,779.32	8,033	4.33	3,719.08	0.00	264.02	96.06	\$38,858.48	\$4.84
79.	B.C./Yukon	710	359	50.6	51,646.45	13,837	3.72	1,047.07	328.65	3,790.16	127.74	\$56,940.07	\$4.12
80.	Manitoba	146	54	37.0	5,540.40	3,781	1.47	100.74		227.99		\$5,869.13	\$1.55
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	192	77	40.0	8,104.25	3,454	2.35	31.69		80.85		\$8,216.79	\$2.38
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	254	89	35.0	5,695.48	3,350	1.70	124.47	0.00	448.38	12.77	\$6,281.10	\$1.87
	Ontario												
83.	East	584	264	45.1	35,758.61	14,699	2.42	816.68	2,000.00	2,843.26	414.93	\$41,833.48	\$2.85
84.	Northeast	164	53	32.2	8,789.72	2,148	4.09	12.65	0.00	2,468.37	0.00	\$11,270.74	\$5.25
85.	Northwest	74	15	20.3	1,697.92	1,241	1.36	257.06		827.24		\$2,782.22	\$2.24
86.	West	523	179	34.2	28,631.14	9,842	2.91	178.48	638.70	5,689.30		\$35,137.62	\$3.57
	Quebec (1)												
87.	Southwest	729	484	66.3	9,301.90	15,053	0.61	388.11	25.00	16,859.90	157.93	\$26,732.84	\$1.78
88.	Southeast	195	173	88.7	288.63	3,166	0.08	310.21	0.00	13,368.92		\$13,967.76	\$4.41
89.	Northwest	343	313	91.2	1,163.89	6,746	0.16	225.50		15,077.98		\$16,467.37	\$2.44
90.	Northwest	388	338	87.0	4,395.48	7,154	0.60	167.79		23,379.78	0.00	\$27,943.05	\$3.91
91.	Saskatchewan	295	102	34.6	7,714.61	3,596	2.15	408.62	0.00	910.17		\$9,033.40	\$2.51
92.	Washington East	476	165	34.7	16,049.17	6,478	2.47	20.00				\$16,069.17	\$2.48
93.	Central Calif	830	383	46.1	62,328.15	22,019	2.82	3,761.48		1,874.68	590.40	\$68,554.71	\$3.11
	Total U.S./	56,629	25,761	45.5	\$4,280,619.92	1,265,090	3.38	\$213,256.45	\$23,819.93	\$423,189.06	\$20,689.93	\$4,969,026.21	\$3.93
	Canada												
	Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				257,766.31								
	Specials				430,639.98								
	Total for U.S. & Canada				4,969,026.21								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
	On Line Meetings				372.20							\$372.20	
	Correctional & Hospital facility groups				28.00							28.00	
	Foreign				127,082.29							\$127,082.29	
	Internationalists				50.00							\$50.00	
	Loners				662.15							\$662.15	
	Birds of a Feather				25.00							\$25.00	
	International Doctors in A.A.				565.00							\$565.00	
	International Lawyers in A.A.											\$0.00	
	Grand Total				\$5,097,810.85							\$5,097,810.85	

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2002-2001 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC
U.S. & Canada							
2002	56,629	25,761	45.5%	\$4,280,619.92	1,265,090	\$3.38	\$3.93
U.S. & Canada							
2001	56,210	25,361	45.1%	\$4,110,520.28	1,257,775	\$3.27	\$3.71
Increase (Decrease)	419	400	0.4%	\$170,099.64	7,315	\$0.11	\$0.22

Average cost of services per member
(7,181,714/1,265,090) = \$5.68

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas)

2003 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Clarke Brown
Earl Fink
Corliss Gibbons
Jim Irwin
Joe Lopez
Amy O'Mara
²Walter Norrad
¹David Steiner

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Cooperation With the Professional Community

²Miles Brookes
Tim Calhoun
Irving Doucet
¹Mike Glassmann
Claude Lieutenant
Paul C. Mijares
Jeanine Rios
Patty Tennant

Secretary: Gayle Solheim Riese

Correctional Facilities

Eric Bothan
²Gene Davis
John DeLoach
Terry Flynn
¹Tom Kerner
Jo A. McLaughlin
Joe Pineda
Mary Alice Sanderson

Secretary: Julio Espailat

Finance

¹John Evans
Mike Foster
Teresa Frohock
Marco García
Dick Grunloh
Eddie Harris
²Rita Lambert
Gale Plancon
Jim Schmitz

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

²Pete Bartlett
Clay Cutten
Mike Lewis
¹Sally McAuley
Sonny McCord
Jutta Matthews
Jose Antonio Mejias
Jim Parili
Andy Talbert

Secretary: Robin Bromley

Literature

Doug Grude
Charles Hollins
Glen Hope
²Tom LeDoux
Brenda Lindgren
Dan Mix
Janet Neri-Kafel
¹Madeleine Parmley
John Warren

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Policy/Admissions

²Betty Barnett
Réal Laforest
Duncan MacAuley
Curt Melton
Enna Rodas
¹Ray Romero
Kathy Smith
Dennis Soto
Duane Talbot

Secretary: Doug Richardson

Public Information

Don Bennitt
²Bill Graham
Marc-Andre Grenier
Darlene Grisham
Maureen Maguire
Paul Walker
¹Bob Wilcox
Mary Pat Yater

Secretary: Rick Walker

Report and Charter

Barbara Bridges
²Kathy Cholewinski
Mark Greider
Paul Haynes
¹Victor Long
Jerry Moore
Jack Ottinger
Dan Stasinski

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Treatment Facilities

Beth Davidson
Jodi Ericson
Jim Holt
Nancy Keohane
Torv Theisen
¹Jo-Anne Lowenberger
Joe O'Neill
Roy Robertson

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Trustees

Don Anderson
Ruth Barth
Chuck Barry
Bob Carpenter
¹Dorothy Dayton
Wanda Halverson
Marie Hamilton
²Warren Jefsen
Denis Vézina

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Archives

Chuck Berry
Beth Davidson
¹Darlene Grisham
John Evans
Glen Hope
Brenda Lindgren
Roy Robertson
²Patty Tennant
Paul Walker

Secretary: Judit Santon

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Don Bennitt
Jodi Ericson
Wanda Halverson
²Warren Jefsen
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
¹Curt Melton
Jim Parili
Ray Romero

Co-Secretaries:
Adrienne Brown
Doug Richardson

2004 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Earl Fink, Montana	Clarke Brown, W. Missouri
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Paul Mijares, SE Texas	Irving Doucet, Louisiana
Correctional Facilities	Joe Pineda, NE Texas	Terry Flynn, SE New York
Finance	Dick Grunloh, S. Illinois	Teresa Frohock, North Carolina
Grapevine	Mike Lewis, Iowa	Jim Parili, E. Massachusetts
Literature	Brenda Lindgren, S. Minnesota	Doug Grude, Calif., Northern Coastal
Policy/Admissions	Kathy Smith, Nevada	Réal Laforest, NE Quebec
Public Information	Maureen Maguire, BC/Yukon	Paul Walker, Central New York
Report and Charter	Jack Ottinger, No. Indiana	Barbara Bridges, No. New Jersey
Treatment Facilities	Jodi Ericson, Utah	Nancy Keohane, E. Pennsylvania
Trustees	Chuck Berry, Oklahoma	Ruth Barth, Virginia
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Don Bennitt, Illinois, Chicago	Wanda Halverson, Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador
³ Archives	Paul Walker, Central New York	Beth Davidson, S. Florida/Bahamas/V.I./Antigua

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2003 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 53rd General Service Conference.

2003 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Leonard Blumenthal, *chairperson*
Linda Chezem
Paul Cleary
Ric Downey
Robert Miller
Arnold Ross
Tony Taschner
Judith Santon, *secretary*

Conference

Ted Stoa, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
Susan Campbell
Paul Cleary
David Every
Ron Gauthier
Alex Palmer
Robert Pelot
Arnold Ross
Warren Stafford, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Dorothy May, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
Ric Downey
Alex Palmer
*Irene Meisel
Robert Miller
George Vaillant
Gayle Solheim Riese,
secretary — C.P.C.
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*
— Treatment Facilities

Correctional Facilities

Allen Ault, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal
Linda Chezem
Paul Cleary
*William Herold
*Jane Starke Lobdell
Dorothy May
Don Miller
Rober Pelot
Julio Espallat, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*
Susan Campbell
Dick Gallagher
Ron Gauthier
John Koster
Don Miller
Jane Sheppard
Ted Stoa
Gregory Tobin
Dennis Manders,
senior advisor
Kevin Sunkel
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Alex Palmer, *chairperson*
Charles Bartell
Susan Campbell
David Every
Ron Gauthier
Phyllis Halliday
Raymond Massey
Dorothy May
George E. Vaillant
Bill Archer, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Beth Rabren, *chairperson*
Charles Bartell
Leonard Blumenthal
Phyllis Halliday
Vince Keefe
Ray Massey
Don Miller
Jane Sheppard
Tony Taschner
Doug Richardson, *secretary*
— International Convention
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*
— Regional Forums

Literature

David Every, *chairperson*
Charles Bartell
Dick Gallagher
Ray Massey
Robert Pelot
*Ray Reese
*David Sahatdjian
Jane Sheppard
George E. Vaillant
Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Nominating

Tony Taschner, *chairperson*
Linda Chezem
Vince Keefe
John Koster
Beth Rabren
Ted Stoa
Gregory Tobin
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Public Information

Ric Downey, *chairperson*,
*Martin Clancy
*Burke Dykes
Dick Gallagher
Phyllis Halliday
*Don McGouirk
Robert Miller
Beth Rabren
Arnold Ross
Rick Walker, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Ron Gauthier, *chairperson*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Elaine McDowell
First vice-chairperson
Linda Chezem
Second vice-chairperson
Robert Miller
Secretary
Tony Taschner
Treasurer
Vincent Keefe
Assistant secretary
Doug Richardson
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 38

* Denotes appointed committee members

** Elaine McDowell and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2003 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected chair of the board in April 2001. She has served as a member of the board since 1992. Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is a former professor of social work at Morgan State University. For eight years she served as the director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, and was the former acting administrator of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services.

Allen L. Ault, Ed.D., (College of Justice and Safety, 354 Stratton Bldg., 521 Lancaster Ave., Richmond, KY 40475-3102) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen is Dean of the College of Justice and Safety, University of Eastern Kentucky, Richmond, KY. Prior to this position he served as Chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. He has also served as a director of corrections for five governors, most recently in that capacity in Georgia. During his career, Allen has been a Rehabilitation Counselor, Director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, Warden of a maximum security prison and President of a national criminal justice consulting firm. He received a Doctorate in Counseling Psychology from the University of Georgia. Allen chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and the Conference Committees.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D. (Rolly View, Alberta TOC 2K0, Canada), was elected a Class A trustee in 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person. Leonard chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Linda L. Chezem, J.D. (530 Denny Dr., Mooresville, IN 46158) was elected to the board in April 1997. A graduate of Indiana University School of Law, Linda is a former judge, Court of Appeals of Indiana. She started the first certified court alcohol and drug program in Indiana, and has conducted seminars and written articles on such subjects as DWI, family and addiction. Linda is a professor at Purdue University, with a part-time appointment at Indiana University School of Medicine. She serves on the Nominating, Correctional Facilities and Archives Committees.

Vincent E. Keefe (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and presently serves as a director of seven companies. Vince chairs the Finance and Budgetary Committee and also serves on the International

Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (2104 Vestavia Lake Dr., Birmingham, AL 35216) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama in 1988, Bob has served as deacon and rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal Church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees. Bob serves on the Archives and Public Information Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

George E. Vaillant, M.D. (355 Garey Rd., East Thetford, VT 05043) was elected to the board in 1998. He is a graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute.

George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and director, The Study of Adult Development. He has lectured widely and is the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction. George serves on the Literature, International, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.



ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Charles Bartell (3935 Lennox Boulevard, New Orleans, LA 70131) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2001. A Panel 45 delegate, he continues to participate in treatment and correctional service in his area. Charles, whose background is in psychology, is a retired university professor. He serves on the International, Literature and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

R.J.M. (Ric) Downey (PH4-9541 Erickson Dr., Burnaby, BC V3J 7N8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2000. A Panel 47 delegate, where he chaired the Policy Admissions Committee, Ric has remained active in his area. He retired after 35 years with the same firm. Ric chairs the Public Information Committee, serves on the Archives and Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees and is a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

David V. Every (150 Hauoli Street, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. A Panel 41 delegate, David served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He is the publisher of a local magazine and a partner in an advertising and public relations firm. David chairs

Time often seems to pass slowly at Conference. Jim Parilli (Eastern Massachusetts) began his Area Highlights with, "It's been a wonderful two weeks, so far."

¹Rotating at the close of the 2003 Conference.

the Literature Committee and serves on the Conference, and International Committees and on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Richard Gallagher (410 Spring Valley Lane, Altamonte Springs, FL 32714) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2001. A Panel 47 delegate, Dick remains active in his home group and in area activities. A.C.P.A. in private practice, he is also involved with various professional organizations. Dick serves on the Literature, Public Information and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Ronald Gauthier (81 Lake Drive, South Hamilton, MA 01982) was elected general service trustee in April 2002. A Panel 41 delegate from Eastern Massachusetts, he has served as an A.A.W.S. director for the past five years. His background is in banking and finance; for the past 20 years he has worked as a commercial lender at various banks in the Boston area. Ron chairs the General Sharing Session and serves on the Conference, International, and Finance & Budgetary Committees. He is also a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

Phyllis Halliday (3805 Cortez Loop SW, Olympia, WA 98512) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2002. As a Panel 47 delegate, Phyllis chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Her professional background is in human resource management and she is an agency Human Resource director for the state of Washington. Phyllis serves on the International, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

John Koster (19 East 65th Street, New York, NY 10021-6587) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. John has been an A.A.W.S. director since 1997. He is an attorney in New York specializing in maritime and international commercial law. John serves as an editor or contributing author to a number of professional publications. John serves on the Nominating and Finance & Budgetary Committees and chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

Dorothy May (9046 Pine Cone Way, Indianapolis, IN 46268) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2001. Dorothy was a Panel 40 delegate. Her professional background is in education, as teacher, administrator and writer. Dorothy chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee, serves on the International and Correctional Facilities Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Alex D. J. Palmer (33439 Huggins Ave., Abbotsford, BC, V2S 2R8, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada, April 1999. A Panel 45 delegate from BC/Yukon, Alex has held many service positions in his area. He has been a CGA (certified general accountant) and controller for different organizations and small businesses, and is currently business director of an alcohol and drug program for youth. Alex chairs the International Committee and serves on the Conference, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

Robert Pelot (1020, Louis Ritchie, St-Jérôme, Québec, Canada J5L-1X6) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2002. Bob, a former Panel 46 delegate, is active in his area with remote communities and in correctional service. Now retired, Robert worked for 25 years for a large corporation in various supervisory positions. Bob serves on the Conference, Correctional Facilities and Literature Committees.

Beth Rabren (224 First St., Brazoria, TX 77422) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 1999. As a Panel 39 delegate, she chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Beth continues to be active in her home group, area and region. Her profes-

sional background is in education, as teacher and administrator, and in treatment as a licensed counselor and administrator. Beth chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Public Information and Nominating Committees.

Ted Stoa (39953 340th Ave., Climax, MN 56523) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2000. Ted was a Panel 42 delegate. His background is in restaurant management and he has owned and operated several restaurants, as well as the family farm. Ted chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nomination Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Tony Taschner (16 Cindy Lane, Berlin, CT 06037) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 1999. Tony served as a Panel 45 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, and has held many service positions in his district and area. He is a retired assistant vice president in Data Management of a large financial service company. Tony chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Archives and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Gregory Tobin (64 Duffield Dr., South Orange, NJ 07079) was elected general service trustee in April 1999, after serving for three years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He has been active in various service committees in his home area and district. Gregory has had a long career in the book-publishing industry, was the editor-in-chief of a large publishing house, and has written five books in the last four years. Greg serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees and chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2003 Conference

Herbert I. Goodman (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international corporation involved with petroleum products and energy conservation.

Gary Kluksdahl (11187 Tamarron Place, Parker, CO 80138) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2003. A former Panel 43 delegate, Gary is active in local, area and regional A.A. He has been in the oil and gas exploration and production industry for 28 years.

Murray McIntosh (426 Cuyler Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 1B2, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2003. A Panel 49 delegate from Northwest Ontario, Murray is active in group and area activities. Now retired, he was a professor in human services at a local college.

Michael D. Perry (11 Mechanic Street, Fair Haven, VT 05743) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2003. A Panel 50 delegate, Mike has continued to serve his area as the convention chair on the area committee. He has taught high school biology for over 30 years.

Arnold L. Ross (227-M East Northern Parkway, Baltimore, MD 21212) became a general service trustee in May 2003, after having served three years as a director on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board. A former Panel 46 delegate, Arnold is director of financial administration for a nonprofit organization.

¹Rotating at the close of the 2003 Conference.

A.A. World Services Directors

John Koster, *chairperson*,
general service trustee
 Paul Cleary, *director*
 Ric Downey, *regional trustee*
 Ron Gauthier, *general service trustee*

Dorothy May, *regional trustee*
 Don Miller, *director*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jane Sheppard, *director*
 Doug Richardson, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Gregory Tobin, *chairperson*,
general service trustee
 Susan Campbell, *director*
 David Every, *general service trustee*
 Dick Gallagher, *regional trustee*

Raymond Massey, *director*
 Robert Miller, *Class A trustee*
 Arnold Ross, *director*
 Ted Stoa, *regional trustee*
 Desmond Towey, *executive editor*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper,
senior adviser to general manager
 Bill Archer
 Adrienne Brown
 Julio Espallat
 Mary Clare Lynch

Joanie Moncrief
 Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Desmond Towey, *executive editor*
 Charles McGovern, *managing editor*

Robin Bromley, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Nicole Bacchus, *staff assistant*
 Daniel Brown, *designer/typesetter*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./admin. asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Angel Calvillo, *translator*
 Hope Cartelli, *staff assistant*
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*
 Sheila Copin-Thomas, *staff assistant*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennan, *staff assistant*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Rafael Hidalgo, *staff assistant*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV website manager/special projects*
 John Kirwin Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*
 Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*
 Dennis Manders, *senior advisor, finance committee*
 Donald Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Lillianna Murphy, *information services manager*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Miguel Rodriguez, *general office clerk*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Judit Santon, *archivist*
 Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*
 Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Stephen Turchyn, *data processing supervisor*
 Gerald Walker, *technology implementer*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn
 Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 53rd Conference includes Panel 52 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 53 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	53	Jutta (Utah) Matthews 1906 Helmsdale Circle SE Huntsville, AL 35803-1766
Alaska	2	52	Amy O'Mara Box 33338 Juneau, AK 99803
Arizona	3	52	Mike Glassmann 2926 N. 54th Lane Phoenix, AZ 85031
Arkansas	4	53	Clay Cutten 1606 W. Gum St. Rogers, AR 72758
California Southern	5	53	Jim Irwin 13904 Fiji Way, #231 Marina Del Ray, CA 90292
Central	93	53	Jeanine Rios 101 Civic Center Plaza Suite A Lompoc, CA 93436
Northern Coastal	6	53	Douglas (Doug) Grude 1309 Pedro St. San Jose, CA 95126-3841
Northern Interior	7	52	Kathy Cholewinski 1339 Molly Ave. Woodland, CA 95776
San Diego/Imperial	8	52	Jim Holt 3451 Celinda Dr. Carlsbad, CA 92008
Mid-Southern	9	52	Pete Bartlett PMB 459, 23010 Lake Forest Suite D, Laguna Hills, CA 92653
Colorado	10	53	Mark Greider 6013 S. Cherrywood Circle Centennial, CO 80121
Connecticut	11	53	Gale Plancon Box 1090 Branford, CT 06405
Delaware	12	52	Dorothy Dayton 358 Locust Lane Lewes, DE 19958
District of Columbia	13	53	*Enna Rodas 4900 Battery Lane, #303 Bethesda, MD 20814
Florida North	14	53	Corliss Gibbons 927 SW 51st Way Gainesville, FL 32607
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I./ Antigua	15	53	Beth Davidson 11240 N.W. 41 Court Coral Spring, FL 33065
Georgia	16	52	John DeLoach 125 Alfred St. Savannah, GA 31408
Hawaii	17	53	Don Anderson 6370 Hawaii Kai Dr., #27 Honolulu, HI 96825
Idaho	18	52	Madeleine Parmley 9242 N. Sunset Dr. Pocatello, ID 83201

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	53	Earl Fink Box 852 Ennis, MT 59729
Chicago	19	53	Don Bennitt 7509 Hickory Creek Dr. Frankfort, IL 60423	Nebraska	41	52	Curt Melton 7426 Ernst St. Omaha, NE 68122-1771
Northern	20	52	Hugh (Sonny) McCord 1115 N. Raynor Ave. Joliet, IL 60435-4548	Nevada	42	53	Cherie (Kathy) Smith 716 Emnden St. Henderson, NV 89015
Southern	21	53	Richard (Dick) Grunloh 810 Park Hills Dr. Effingham, IL 62401-3124	New Hampshire	43	52	Tom Kerner 22 Walden Pond Dr. Nashua, NH 03064
Indiana				New Jersey			
Northern	22	53	Jack Ottinger 1620 Oakhill Rd. Kokomo, IN 46902	Northern	44	53	Barbara Bridges 73 Elm St., #1 Montclair, NJ 07042
Southern	23	52	Marco Garcia 17749 Captiva Way Noblesville, IN 46060	Southern	45	52	Joseph (Joe) O'Neill 6 Mercer Place Ocean City, NJ 08226
Iowa	24	53	Mike Lewis 1902 South 17th Omaha, NE 68108	New Mexico	46	52	Ray Romero 2908 El Tesoro Escondido NW Albuquerque, NM 87120
Kansas	25	52	Thomas (Tom) LeDoux 5806 Reeder Rd. Shawnee, KS 66203	New York			
Kentucky	26	52	James (Jim) Schmitz 5703 Renada Dr. Crestwood, KY 40014	Central	47	53	Paul Walker 49 Troup St., #36 Rochester, NY 14608
Louisiana	27	53	Irving Doucet Box 271 Rosedale, LA 70772	Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire	48	52	Dave Steiner 9140 Meadowbrook Dr. Lee Center, NY 13363
Maine	28	52	Miles Brookes Box 935 Jefferson, ME 04348	Southeast	49	53	Terrance (Terry) Flynn 86 E. 4th St., #9 New York, NY 10003
Maryland	29	52	Victor Long 5011 Campground Rd. Eden, MD 21822	Western	50	52	Janet Neri-Kafel 6022 Baer Rd. Sanborn, NY 14132
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	53	Teresa Frohock Box 777 Reidsville, NC 27323
Eastern	30	53	Jim Parili Box 4111 Brockton, MA 02303-4111	North Dakota	52	53	Eric Bothun Box 155 109 2nd St., NW Beulah, ND 58523
Western	31	52	Bob Wilcox 66 East Glen Dr. Westfield, MA 01085	Ohio			
Michigan				Central Southeast	53	53	Andrew (Andy) Talbert, Jr. 220 Fox Hall Dr. Pataskala, OH 43062
Central	32	53	Dennis Soto 935 S. Knight Rd. Bay City, MI 48708-9659	Northeast	54	53	Dan Mix Box 173 Chardon, OH 44024
Southeast	33	53	Dan Stasinski 15258 Elderwood Roseville, MI 48066	NW Ohio/SE Mich.	55	52	Robert (Bob) Carpenter 30630 Drouillard, Rd., Lot 6 Walbridge, OH 43465
Western	34	52	Warren Jensen 1266 W. US #2 St. Ignace, MI 49781	Southwest	56	52	Mary Pat Yater 425 Home Ave. Hamilton, OH 45013
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	53	Charles (Chuck) Berry 7341 E. 75th St. Tulsa, OK 74133
Northern	35	52	Timothy (Tim) Calhoun 18696 Grouse Rd. Little Falls, MN 56345	Oregon	58	52	Darlene Grisham 460 23rd St. Springfield, OR 97477
Southern	36	53	Brenda Lindgren 3020 Casco Point Rd. Wayzata, MN 55391	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	52	Charles Hollins 113 N. Island View Long Beach, MS 39560	Eastern	59	53	Nancy Keohane 114 William Penn Dr. Norristown, PA 19403
Missouri				Western	60	53	John Warren 369 Bost Dr. W. Mifflin, PA 15122-2512
Eastern	38	53	Michael (Mike) Foster 17358 IL-RT 185 Coffeen, IL 62017				
Western	39	53	Clarke Brown 2704 E. Cragmont Springfield, MO 65804				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	52	Sally McAuley 52 Rounds Ave. Providence, RI 02907
South Carolina	62	52	Patty Tennant 5919 Murray Ave. Hanahan, SC 29406
South Dakota	63	52	John Evans Box 533 Black Hawk, SD 57718
Tennessee	64	52	Betty Barnette 32 Edenwood Dr. Jackson, TN 38301
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	53	Joe Pineda 14049 Janwood Lane Dallas, TX 75234
<i>Northwest</i>	66	52	Joe Lopez 4948 Meade El Paso, TX 79904
<i>Southeast</i>	67	53	Paul Mijares 14030 Rawlings Humble, TX 77396
<i>Southwest</i>	68	52	Rita Lambert 2713 Jorwoods Dr. Austin, TX 78745-5925
Utah	69	53	JoAnne (Jodi) Ericson 184 West 400 South Tooele, UT 84074
Vermont	70	52	Duncan MacAuley 435 Dorset St., #40 S. Burlington, VT 05403
Virginia	71	53	Ruth Barth 3383 Whipple Court Annandale, VA 22003
Washington			
<i>State East</i>	92	52	Clarence Eugene (Gene) Davis 1319 Elm St. Clarkston, WA 99403
<i>Western</i>	72	53	Edward (Eddie) Harris 1204 Queen Ave. NE Renton, WA 98056-3343
West Virginia	73	53	Gerald (Jerry) Moore R.R. 1, Box 172 Shepherdstown, WV 25443
Wisconsin			
<i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	52	*Torvin (Torv) Theisen 805 Houghton St. Ontonagon, MI 49953
<i>Southern</i>	75	53	Jo A. McLaughlin 1802 Sheridan Rd. Kenosha, WI 53140-1345
Wyoming	76	52	William (Bill) Graham 2405 Pennsylvania Blvd. Green River, WY 82935
Puerto Rico	77	52	José Antonio Mejias Calle Brazil 194 Urb Bunker Caguas, PR 00725

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	52	Duane Talbot 57 Martinridge Crest NE Calgary AB T3J 3M4
B.C./Yukon	79	53	Maureen Maguire 6139 Everest Way Duncan, BC V9L 5N5
Manitoba	80	52	Jo-Anne Lowenberger 303 Regal Ave. Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	52	Walter Norrad 84 Murray Ave. Fredericton, NB E3A 3Y8
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Lab.	82	53	Wanda Halverson 381 Truro Rd., R.R. #3 Westville, NS BOK 2A0
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	53	Roy Robertson 1211 Kentlow Court Mississauga, ON L5E 3C4
<i>Northeast</i>	84	53	Mary Alice Sanderson 507-4 East St. Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6A 6W9
<i>Northwest</i>	85	53	Marie Hamilton 106-630 Sherrington Dr. Thunder Bay, ON P7B 6A3
<i>Western</i>	86	52	William John Paul (Paul) Haynes 2-3 Burns Dr. Guelph, ON N1H 7C3
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	52	Denis Vézina 8245, boul. St-Laurent, #902 Brossard, PQ J4X 2A6
<i>Southeast</i>	88	53	Claude Lieutenant 100, chemin du Bassin Compton, PQ JOB 1L0
<i>Northeast</i>	89	53	Réal Laforest 20, rue Plourde Métabetchouan-Lac-A- La Croix, PQ G8G 1C 6
<i>Northwest</i>	90	52	Marc-Andre Grenier 420, RG St. Joseph Charette, PQ GOX 1E0
Saskatchewan	91	52	Glen Hope Box 1117 Gravelbourg, SK SOH 1X0



*Alternate delegate was seated.
Ted Lapine, delegate, was unable to attend.